

删不掉的光 II

在新时代中守住灵魂

The Light They Could Not Erase, Vol. 2
Keeping the Soul in a Restless Age



张崇助 Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang

删不掉的光 II：在新时代中守住灵魂
The Light They Could Not Erase, Vol. 2:
Keeping the Soul in a Restless Age

作者：张崇助

书名：删不掉的光 II：在新时代中守住灵魂
英文书名：The Light They Could Not Erase, Vol. 2: Keeping the Soul in a
Restless Age

作者：张崇助 (Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang)

体裁：中英文双语信仰随笔集

版本：第二册 校订稿

出版年份：2026

出版社：待定

ISBN：待定

封面设计：待定

内文排版：待定

Copyright © 2026 Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang. All rights reserved.

未经作者或出版方书面许可，不得以任何形式复制、转载、改编、储存或
传播本书任何部分，法律允许的合理引用除外。

No part of this book may be reproduced, stored, transmitted, or distributed in
any form without prior written permission from the author or publisher,
except for brief quotations permitted by law.

机构与会议说明：

本书中涉及的机构、会议和活动名称，仅用于作者个人经历与信仰反思的
叙述。除非特别说明，相关内容不代表任何机构、会议或组织的官方立
场。

Institutional and event note:

Names of organizations, conferences, and events mentioned in this book are
used only in connection with the author's personal experiences and reflections.
Unless otherwise stated, such references do not represent the official position
of any organization, conference, or institution.

经文版权声明：

- 中文经文统一采用《圣经和合本》。
- Scripture quotations marked NIV are taken from The Holy Bible, New International Version®, NIV®. Copyright © 1973, 1978, 1984, 2011 by Biblica, Inc. Used by permission of Biblica, Inc. All rights reserved worldwide.

出版前待确认事项：

- ISBN 与出版社信息。
- 中文《圣经和合本》所采用版本与版权说明。
- NIV 经文引用总量是否符合授权范围。

献词 Dedication	6
作者自序 Author's Preface	8
书名说明	16
第四辑：在新时代中守住灵魂	20
第一篇：捐赠和慷慨：别让外在风波冻结你的怜悯	20
第二篇：尊重所有权：从“不可偷盗”谈起	27
第三篇：尊重誓约：从“不可奸淫”谈起	36
第四篇：当信仰遇上科技	45
第五篇：当教会进入 AI 时代	53
第六篇：当代信徒如何在忙碌中守住“灵魂的空间”？	62
第七篇：如何让你的家庭成为一个“情绪健康的属灵共同体”？	70
第八篇：如何在情绪世代成为一个情绪成熟的信徒？	80
第九篇：灵魂的复原力	88
第十篇：在动荡中保持稳固	96
第十一篇：在破碎的世界里做一个完整的人	104
第十二篇：从孤单到共同体	111
第五辑：教会的未来与使命	119
第十三篇：教会如何面对多元社会？	119
第十四篇：当教会与社会边界模糊	127

第十五篇：当下一代离开教会	135
第十六篇：家庭、教会与使命	144
第十七篇：教会的未来不是规模，而是深度	151
第十八篇：中国教会的未来领袖	158
第十九篇：在焦虑时代牧养人心	166
第二十篇：当教会进入新时代	173
第二十一篇：当讲道成为危险	181
第二十二篇：被呼召的一代	188
第二十三篇：当教会面对苦难	194
第二十四篇：一个健康的教会长什么样？	201
第二十五篇：当信仰被削弱时	208
第六辑：使命现场与领袖警醒	215
第二十六篇：又是一年一度的年议会	215
第二十七篇：在印第安纳 Gideons 牧者感恩晚宴的见证	223
第二十八篇：基甸的失败：从卑微的勇士到失落的士师	230
作者简介 · Author Bio	238

献词 Dedication



谨以此书献给我的妻子：

张素川 (Sue Zhang)

感谢你多年来的陪伴与支持。

在顺境中，你与我一同感恩；在艰难中，你与我一同承担。

当道路平坦的时候，你从不居功；当风雨来临的时候，你从未离开。

从中国到美国，从牧会到求学，从熟悉到陌生，从欢笑到眼泪，我们一起走过许多难忘的岁月。

感谢你为家庭的付出，感谢你为教会的摆上，感谢你在许多无人看见的地方默默服事。

许多时候，人们看见的是讲台上的牧者，却没有看见背后那位默默支持、代祷、鼓励和陪伴的人。

而你，正是那样的人。

这些年来，无论是在教会的事奉中，还是在人生的旅程里，你始终是上帝赐给我的恩典之一。

特别是在那些最艰难的日子里，当我们共同经历失去与等待，经历眼泪与沉默，你用信心扶持我，也用爱陪伴我继续前行。这本书所记录的许多故事，都有你的身影；这本书所见证的许多恩典，也都有你的参与。

愿上帝記念你的劳苦，赐福你的生命，并让我们继续携手同行，在未来的岁月里，一同见证那永不熄灭的光。

献给我深爱的妻子，Sue。

张崇助



To my beloved wife, Sue Zhang

Thank you for your faithful love, unwavering support, and steadfast companionship throughout our journey together.

Through seasons of joy and sorrow, through ministry and study, through familiar places and unfamiliar lands, you have walked beside me with grace and courage.

Many people see the pastor standing in front, but few see the faithful partner standing behind.

Your prayers, encouragement, sacrifices, and quiet acts of service have sustained both our family and our ministry in countless ways.

This book carries many stories from our journey, and your presence is woven through them all.

In moments of celebration, you rejoiced with me.

In moments of hardship, you remained beside me.

In seasons of loss, you shared my tears.

In seasons of hope, you strengthened my faith.

Thank you for being one of God's greatest gifts in my life.

May the Lord continue to bless you, strengthen you, and fill your days with His peace and joy.

With love and gratitude,

Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang

作者自序 Author's Preface



删不掉的光

如果有人问我，这本书是从什么时候开始写的？

我大概会说，它并不是从某一天开始写的。

它是从一个又一个平凡的日子里，慢慢长出来的。

2024 年，我开始认真经营自己的微信公众号。起初并没有宏大的计划，也没有想到要出版一本书。我只是想把一路走来的思考、感动、挣扎、学习和领受记录下来。

有时候，是一段生活感悟。

有时候，是一篇灵修默想。

有时候，是一次探访后的反思。

有时候，是一场风雨过后的记录。

更多的时候，只是在忙碌生活的缝隙里，为自己留下一点安静思考的空间。

于是，一篇、两篇、十篇、五十篇、一百篇……

不知不觉之间，公众号已经陪伴我走过一年多的时间。

当我重新翻看这些文章的时候，忽然发现，它们虽然写于不同的季节、不同的处境，却都在讲述同一个主题：

在人生最真实的日子，总有一些光，是删不掉的。

时代会过去。

平台会改变。

文章可能被遗忘。

账号甚至可能消失。

但那些曾经照亮过生命的恩典，那些在人生幽暗时刻给予力量的亮光，却不会轻易消失。

它们留在记忆里。

留在生命里。

也留在一个人继续前行的脚步里。

于是，我决定把这些散落在网络世界里的文字，重新整理、编辑、修订，汇集成册。

这套书，便有了一个名字：《删不掉的光》。

因为我深深相信，真正重要的东西，不会因为时间而消失，也不会因为环境而被抹去。

为什么从“日子里的恩典”开始

很多人以为，一个人的生命最重要的是那些轰轰烈烈的大事。然而，随着年龄增长，我越来越发现，人生真正发生的地方，其实是在日常。

不是高峰，而是平地。

不是掌声，而是安静。

不是传奇，而是日子。

我们记得毕业典礼，却常常忘记那些熬夜读书的夜晚。

我们记得成功的时刻，却忽略了无数默默坚持的过程。

我们记得生命中的转折点，却忘记了那些平凡日子对我们的塑造。

事实上，一个人的品格是在日常中形成的。

信心是在等待中成长的。

爱是在陪伴中学习的。

盼望是在黑夜中坚持的。

恩典也是如此。

它往往不是惊天动地的奇迹，而是一顿热饭、一句安慰、一位朋友、一条短信、一段陪伴、一扇重新打开的门。

因此，《删不掉的光》的第一册，我选择从“日子里的恩典”开始。

因为所有伟大的故事，都始于普通的日子。

而所有真实的生命，也都活在普通的日子。

为什么采用中英文双语

这本书采用中英文双语形式，并不是单纯为了翻译。

而是因为我的生命本身，已经同时生活在两种语言之中。

我出生在中国。

在那里成长、学习、牧会，经历人生的喜乐与苦难。

后来，我来到美国。

在陌生的语言和文化中重新开始学习，重新适应，也重新认识自己。

这些年，我越来越深刻地体会到：

语言不仅是一种工具，更是一座桥梁。

中文承载着我的过去。

英文连接着我的现在。

中文记录了我生命的根。

英文见证着我生命的路。

因此，我希望这些文字能够跨越语言的边界。

让华人的下一代能够读懂父母和祖父母的故事。

让不同文化背景的人能够彼此理解。

让生命中的信心、盼望与爱，可以被更多的人阅读与分享。

如果有一天，一位年轻人读英文版的时候，能够理解上一代华人走过的道路；如果有一天，一位英文读者透过这些文字，能够看见华人基督徒真实的人生故事，那么这本书的使命便已经实现了一部分。

写给正在阅读这本书的你

也许你正处在人生顺境。

也许你正在经历低谷。

也许你身在故乡。

也许你漂泊异乡。

也许你正在寻找答案。

也许你已经疲惫不堪。

无论你是谁，我都希望这本书能够成为一位安静同行的朋友。

它不会告诉你人生一定会一帆风顺。

它也不会假装所有问题都有简单答案。

但它愿意陪伴你一起相信：

在最普通的日子，恩典依然存在。

在最黑暗的夜晚里，光依然存在。

在最艰难的道路上，希望依然存在。

因为我自己的生命，就是这样一路走过来的。

我曾经历失去。

也曾经历等待。

曾面对风雨。

也曾看见彩虹。

我知道人生并不容易。

但我也知道，在许多以为走不下去的时候，总有一只看不见的手托住我们继续前行。

回首这些年，我越来越相信：

真正改变一个人的，不是惊天动地的时刻，而是那些持续不断临到生命中的恩典。

而这些恩典，就像夜空里的星光。

也许微弱，却从未熄灭。

也许遥远，却始终存在。

这正是《删不掉的光》想要讲述的故事。

愿这本书陪伴你走过一段路。

愿你在这些文字里，看见自己的影子。

也愿你在自己的生命里，发现那些从未被删除、从未被熄灭、始终照亮前路的光。

张崇助

于美国印第安纳州印第安纳波利斯

2026 年



The Light They Could Not Erase

If someone were to ask me when this book began, I would probably say that it did not begin on a single day.

It grew slowly out of one ordinary day after another.

In 2024, I began writing more intentionally on my WeChat public account. At first, I had no grand plan and no thought of publishing a book. I simply wanted to record the reflections, movements of the heart, struggles, lessons, and spiritual insights that came along the way.

Sometimes it was a reflection on daily life.

Sometimes it was a devotional meditation.

Sometimes it was a response after visiting someone.

Sometimes it was a record after a storm had passed.

More often, it was simply a way to create a small space of quiet thought in the middle of a busy life.

One article became two. Then ten. Then fifty. Then a hundred.

Almost without realizing it, this public account had accompanied me for more than a year.

When I later looked back through these writings, I suddenly realized that although they were written in different seasons and under different circumstances, they were all telling the same story:

In the most real days of life, there is always some light that cannot be erased.

Times will pass.

Platforms will change.

Articles may be forgotten.

Accounts may even disappear.

But the grace that once illumined a life, and the light that gave strength in dark moments, do not easily vanish.

They remain in memory.

They remain in life.

They remain in the steps by which a person continues forward.

So I decided to gather these scattered writings from the digital world, edit and revise them, and bring them together in book form.

This series was given the title:

The Light They Could Not Erase.

Because I deeply believe that what truly matters will not disappear with time, nor will it be erased by changing circumstances.

Why Begin With “Grace in Ordinary Days”

Many people assume that the most important parts of life are the dramatic moments.

But as I grow older, I increasingly realize that real life happens in the ordinary.

Not on the mountaintop, but on level ground.

Not in applause, but in quietness.

Not in legend, but in daily life.

We remember graduation ceremonies, but often forget the late nights of study.

We remember moments of success, but overlook the countless quiet acts of perseverance that led there.

We remember turning points, but forget how ordinary days shaped us.

In truth, character is formed in daily life.

Faith grows in waiting.

Love is learned through companionship.

Hope is strengthened in the night.

Grace is much the same.

It often does not come as a dramatic miracle, but as a warm meal, a comforting word, a friend, a message, a season of companionship, or a door that opens again.

That is why I chose to begin the first volume of *The Light They Could Not Erase* with “Grace in Ordinary Days.”

Every great story begins in ordinary days.

And every real life is lived there.

Why This Book Is Bilingual

This book is bilingual not merely for the sake of translation.

It is bilingual because my life now lives in two languages.

I was born in China.

There I grew up, studied, served in ministry, and experienced both joy and sorrow.

Later, I came to the United States.

In an unfamiliar language and culture, I had to learn again, adapt again, and understand myself again.

Over the years, I have come to feel more deeply that language is not only a tool. It is also a bridge.

Chinese carries my past.

English connects my present.

Chinese records the roots of my life.

English bears witness to the road I am now walking.

For this reason, I hope these writings can cross the boundaries of language.

I hope the next generation of Chinese families can understand the stories of their parents and grandparents.

I hope people from different cultural backgrounds can understand one another more deeply.

I hope the faith, hope, and love found in these ordinary stories can be read and shared by more people.

If one day a young person reading the English version can better understand the road walked by an earlier generation of Chinese believers, or if an English-speaking reader can glimpse the real life of a Chinese Christian through these pages, then part of this book's mission will already have been fulfilled.

To the Reader

Perhaps you are in a season of blessing.

Perhaps you are walking through a valley.

Perhaps you are living in your homeland.

Perhaps you are far from home.

Perhaps you are searching for answers.

Perhaps you are already weary.

Whoever you are, I hope this book can become a quiet companion on your journey.

It will not tell you that life will always be smooth.

It will not pretend that every problem has a simple answer.

But it is willing to walk with you and believe:

In the most ordinary days, grace still exists.

In the darkest nights, light still exists.

On the hardest roads, hope still exists.

My own life has been carried in this way.

I have known loss.

I have known waiting.

I have faced storms.

I have also seen rainbows.

I know life is not easy.

But I also know that in many moments when I thought I could not go on, an unseen hand was still holding me and helping me move forward.

Looking back, I believe more and more that what truly changes a person is not one dramatic moment, but grace that keeps coming to us again and again.

Such grace is like starlight in the night sky.

It may be faint, yet it has never gone out.

It may seem far away, yet it is still there.

This is the story *The Light They Could Not Erase* seeks to tell.

May this book accompany you for part of your journey.

May you see something of yourself in these pages.

And may you discover, in your own life, the light that has never been deleted, never been extinguished, and never stopped shining on the road ahead.

Chongzhu (Paul) Zhang

Indianapolis, Indiana, USA

2026

书名说明



我为什么把这套书命名为《删不掉的光》

很多朋友问我：为什么这套书要取名为《删不掉的光》？这个名字，其实来自我过去一年多经营微信公众号的真实经历。2024 年开始，我陆续把自己的一些文章发表在微信公众号上。刚开始的时候，我写得很直接。内容大多是圣经分享、神学思考、教会牧养、信仰见证，以及一些属灵反思。

然而，让我意想不到的是，许多文章发表之后不久便被下架。有时候三篇文章里面会有两篇被删除；有时候一连几天发表的内容，最后只剩下一两篇能够保留下来。

起初，我感到困惑。后来渐渐明白，其中许多内容触及了一些平台所关注的敏感词汇或表达方式。

那些被删除的文章，有些是关于信仰的思考，有些是关于人生价值的讨论，也有一些是关于教会牧养和属灵成长的分享。

每当收到“文章已被删除”的通知时，心里总会有一些失落。因为每一篇文章背后，都有时间的投入，也有生命的经历。

然而，随着时间推移，我开始意识到，这未必完全是一件坏事。它反而成为一种学习，一种训练，一种重新思考如何表达的机会。

我开始学习用更加含蓄的语言表达更深刻的内容，学习用生活故事讲述信仰，用人生经历承载神学思考，用普通日子的记录传递生命的信息。

渐渐地，我发现，许多原本需要用直接方式表达的内容，其实也可以通过更加温柔、更有文学性的方式呈现出来。而且有时候，这样的表达反而更容易进入人的内心。

于是，我的写作开始发生改变。

文章不再只是单纯的神学论述，而更多成为生活观察、生命反思、家庭故事、异乡经历和日常感悟。

在这些平凡的故事背后，我仍然努力保留那些最重要的价值与信念。

慢慢地，被删除的次数减少了。如今，我平均每周会发表四五篇文章。偶尔仍然会有文章被下架，但相比最初的阶段，已经少了许多。

然而，在这个过程中，我越来越深刻地意识到一件事：

文字可能被删除。

文章可能被下架。

平台可能会改变。

甚至有一天，整个账号都可能不再存在。

但是，那些曾经照亮过生命的东西，并不会因此消失。

一篇文章或许不见了，但它曾带给某个人的安慰还在。

一句话或许被删除了，但它曾带来的思考还在。

一个故事或许无法继续传播，但它所点燃的希望还在。

真正有力量的，从来不是文字本身，而是文字背后的光。

正因为如此，当我开始整理这些公众号文章，准备出版成书的时候，《删不掉的光》这个名字便自然浮现在我的心里。

因为我相信：有些文章会消失，有些文字会被遗忘，有些记录会被尘封，但那些真正照亮生命的恩典、盼望、真理与爱，永远删不掉。

这套书所要保存的，不仅仅是文字。

更是那些曾经照亮我，也曾经照亮他人的光。

而这，正是《删不掉的光》这个书名背后的故事。



Why I Named This Series The Light They Could Not Erase?

Many readers have asked me why I chose the title The Light They Could Not Erase.

The answer comes from a very personal experience.

Beginning in 2024, I started publishing articles regularly through my WeChat public account. At first, my writing was quite direct. Most of the articles focused on Scripture, theology, pastoral ministry, faith, testimony, and spiritual reflection.

To my surprise, many of those articles disappeared shortly after publication.

Sometimes two out of three articles would be removed.

Sometimes, after several days of writing and posting, only one or two articles remained visible.

At first, I felt confused. Over time, I gradually came to understand that some of the content had touched words or expressions that the platform regarded as sensitive.

Those removed articles included reflections on faith, discussions of life values, and writings on pastoral ministry and spiritual growth.

Every time I received a notice that an article had been removed, I felt a quiet sense of loss. Each article represented time, thought, prayer, and lived experience.

Yet as time passed, I began to see that this was not entirely a bad thing. It became a kind of learning, a kind of training, and an opportunity to rethink how I expressed what mattered most. I began to learn how to express deeper truths with quieter language, how to speak of faith through everyday stories, how to carry theological reflection through lived experience, and how to communicate life through ordinary days.

Gradually, I discovered that some truths did not always need to be stated directly. They could also be carried through gentler, more literary forms of expression. Sometimes, such writing entered the heart more deeply.

My writing began to change.

It was no longer only theological reflection. It became more and more a record of ordinary life, family stories, personal reflection, cross-cultural experience, and the lessons hidden in daily living. Yet beneath those ordinary stories, I still tried to preserve the convictions and values that mattered most.

Over time, fewer articles were removed. Today, I continue to write several articles each week. Occasionally, one is still taken down, but far less often than in the beginning.

Through this process, however, I came to realize something important:

Words can disappear.

Articles can be removed.

Platforms can change.

Even an entire account may one day no longer exist.

But the things that once brought light to a life do not disappear so easily.

An article may vanish, but the comfort it brought to a reader remains.

A sentence may be deleted, but the thought it awakened may continue.

A story may no longer be visible online, but the hope it kindled may remain.

The most powerful thing is not the words themselves.

It is the light behind the words.

That is why, when I began gathering these public-account articles into book form, the title *The Light They Could Not Erase* naturally came to mind.

I believe some articles may disappear, some words may be forgotten, and some records may be buried by time. But the grace, hope, truth, and love that truly illuminate a life cannot be erased.

This series is not merely preserving words.

It is preserving the light that once shone upon me and, I hope, upon others as well.

That is the story behind the title *The Light They Could Not Erase*.

第四辑：在新时代中守住灵魂

第一篇：捐赠和慷慨：别让外在风波冻结你的怜悯



在谨慎中保持柔软，在复杂中选择良善

这些年，很多人一提到“捐赠”，心里就会先紧一下。

怕被骗，怕被利用，怕好心变成笑话。

甚至有些外在事件，让人对公益、对机构、对募捐产生阴影。于是，原本柔软的心开始自我保护：不如不捐，不管，不碰。

这种反应可以理解。

但圣经给我们一个更深的提醒：谨慎可以有，怜悯不能失；方式可以调整，爱心不能关闭。

我们不能因为外在风波，就把“怜悯的门”一并锁死。否则最终受损的，不只是那些真正有需要的人，也包括我们自己灵里的温度。

一、慷慨不是冲动，而是内在生命的方向

圣经记载，亚伯拉罕把所得的十分之一献上。（参创世记 14:20）

那不是情绪性的冲动，而是对神的敬畏与感谢。

奉献与捐赠，本质上是把“主权”摆正：承认一切都是领受，也愿意把一部分交回神的旨意，成为祝福的管道。

箴言说：“你要以财物和一切初熟的土产尊荣耶和华。”（箴言 3:9，和合本）

这里强调的是“初熟”和“尊荣”：一个是优先次序，一个是敬拜态度。

换句话说，真正的慷慨，不是看环境顺不顺，也不是看人值不值得，而是看心是否仍然被爱引导。

二、不要让外在风波把你训练成冷漠的人

约翰一书给了一个很直接的检验：

“凡有世上财物的，看见弟兄穷乏，却塞住怜恤的心，爱神的心怎能存在他里面呢？”（约翰一书 3:17，和合本）

这句话并不是逼人盲目捐赠，而是在提醒我们：当我们一次次用“外在理由”合理化自己的冷漠，心会越来越硬。

久而久之，我们不只是对公益失望，也可能对人失去温柔；不只是对机构不信任，也可能对世界不再抱有盼望。

现实里确实可能有不透明、甚至不诚实的情况。

但圣经给出的道路，不是“从此不再怜悯”，而是“用更智慧的方式继续怜悯”。

因为神要保守的，不只是我们的钱包，更是我们的心。

三、谨慎与慷慨可以同时存在

圣经从不鼓励愚昧。

慷慨不是不分辨，而是在分辨中仍然选择爱。

如果你担心捐赠被滥用，可以从三个方向开始。

第一，选择更透明的渠道。

尽量支持你熟悉、可信、账目清楚、能追踪去向的项目。小额、多次、长期，往往比一次性大额更稳妥。

第二，优先看得见的人。

你可以把一部分慷慨用于身边真实需要的人：困难家庭、孤寡长者、暂时失业或生病的朋友。

很多时候，爱最真实的落点，就在你生活半径之内。

第三，把“给钱”扩展为“给时间与陪伴”。

慷慨不只是一笔转账。

探访、接送、陪同就医、帮助搬家、提供一顿饭、给一个机会，都是非常真实的给予。

金钱可能被误用，但爱心的行动很难被假冒。

四、慷慨是一种属灵操练

“施比受更为有福。”（使徒行传 20:35，和合本）

这句话之所以真实，是因为给予会释放人，把人从“只顾自己”的牢笼里带出来。

贪婪的逻辑是抓住。

慷慨的逻辑是流动。

当爱开始流动，心就重新活过来。

保罗也说：“捐得乐意的人，是神所喜爱的。”（哥林多后书 9:7，和合本）

神所喜悦的，不是被逼出来的奉献，而是出于喜乐与信靠的摆上。

当我们把资源交出去，其实也是在宣告：我的安全感不在数字上，而在神的同在里。

五、把怜悯守住

在这个信息爆炸、信任稀缺的时代，最容易的路是变冷淡：

不相信，不关心，不参与。

但福音给我们的路正好相反：

在谨慎中仍保持柔软，在复杂中仍选择良善。

我们可以不盲目，但不要冷漠。

我们可以做筛选，但不要关门。

愿我们都能这样祷告：

主啊，求你赐我智慧，使我不被欺骗；也赐我爱心，使我不被冷漠吞噬。让我在真实的需要面前，仍能打开手，打开家，也打开一颗怜悯的心。

愿我们成为这样的人：

谨慎，却不冰冷。

清醒，却不刻薄。

分辨，却仍慷慨。

让怜悯不被风波冻结，让爱心不被失望封住。



Giving and Generosity

Do Not Let External Scandals Freeze Your Compassion

In recent years, many people feel a quiet tension the moment they hear the word “donation.”

They fear being deceived, being used, or seeing good intentions turn into regret.

Public scandals and painful stories have created distrust toward charities, organizations, and fundraising. As a result, many people choose the safest path: do not give, do not get involved, do not touch it.

That reaction is understandable.

But Scripture gives us a deeper direction: we can be cautious without becoming cold; we can adjust our methods without closing the door of mercy.

If we lock the door of compassion because of external storms, the loss will not only affect those who are truly in need. It will also affect the warmth of our own souls.

1. Generosity Is Not Impulse, but a Direction of Life

Scripture records that Abraham gave a tenth of what he had. (See Genesis 14:20.)

This was not emotional impulse. It was a response of reverence and gratitude toward God.

At its core, giving is about putting lordship back in its proper place. It acknowledges that everything we have has first been received, and that part of what we hold can become a channel of blessing.

Proverbs says, “Honor the LORD with your wealth, with the firstfruits of all your crops.” (Proverbs 3:9, NIV)

The emphasis is on firstfruits and honor: priority and worship. True generosity, then, is not determined by whether circumstances feel safe, or whether people seem deserving. It is determined by whether the heart is still being led by love.

2. Do Not Let External Scandals Train You Into Coldness

First John gives us a direct test: if someone has material resources and sees a brother or sister in need, yet closes the heart, how can God's love remain there? (See 1 John 3:17.)

This is not a command to give blindly. It is a warning.

When we repeatedly use external reasons to justify our lack of compassion, the heart slowly hardens.

Over time, we may not only become disappointed with charities. We may lose tenderness toward people. We may not only distrust institutions. We may stop believing that goodness is still possible.

Yes, real life includes misuse, lack of transparency, and even dishonesty.

But Scripture does not guide us toward "never show mercy again." It guides us toward showing mercy with greater wisdom. God cares not only about our money. He also cares about our hearts.

3. Caution and Generosity Can Coexist

Scripture never praises foolishness.

Generosity is not the absence of discernment. It is choosing love while practicing discernment.

If you are concerned that your giving may be misused, begin in three practical ways.

First, choose more transparent channels.

Support people, groups, or projects you know and trust, especially those with clear reporting and accountable use of resources. Smaller amounts given consistently over time may be wiser than one large, impulsive gift.

Second, prioritize visible needs nearby.

Some of the most meaningful generosity is directed toward real people within reach: families in hardship, elderly people who are alone, friends facing illness or job loss.

Often, the most faithful place for love to land is within the radius of your ordinary life.

Third, expand giving money into giving time and presence. Generosity is more than a transfer.

Visiting, offering rides, accompanying someone to a medical appointment, helping with a move, providing a meal, or opening a door of opportunity are all real forms of giving.

Money may be misdirected, but love in action is difficult to fake.

4. Generosity Is a Spiritual Practice

“It is more blessed to give than to receive.” (Acts 20:35, NIV)

This is true because giving liberates us. It draws us out of the prison of self-centeredness.

Greed grasps.

Generosity releases.

When love begins to flow, the heart begins to live again.

Paul also writes, “God loves a cheerful giver.” (2 Corinthians 9:7, NIV)

God is not pleased by pressured giving, but by joyful and trusting generosity.

When we release resources, we are also declaring that our security is not in numbers, but in God’s faithful presence.

5. Guard Compassion

In a world flooded with information and short on trust, the easiest path is cold distance:

Do not believe.

Do not care.

Do not participate.

But the gospel calls us in the opposite direction:

Stay tender while being wise. Choose goodness even in complexity.

We do not need to be naive, but we must not become indifferent.

We may filter our methods, but we must not lock the door.

A simple prayer can guide us:

Lord, give me wisdom so I will not be deceived. Give me love so I will not be swallowed by coldness. When real needs appear before me, keep my hands open, my home open, and my heart compassionate.

May we become people like this:

Cautious, but not cold.

Clear-minded, but not harsh.

Discerning, yet still generous.

May compassion not be frozen by storms, and may love not be sealed shut by disappointment.

第二篇：尊重所有权：从“不可偷盗”谈起



“财产、劳动与托付都需要被尊重”

当神在西奈山赐下十诫时，其中一条简洁有力的诫命是：“不可偷盗。”（出埃及记 20:15，和合本）

这句话虽短，却涵盖了人类社会生活的根本秩序。它不仅禁止偷窃行为，也肯定并保护人的所有权、财产权、劳动成果与基本尊严。

一、生命与财产的尊严

圣经的世界观认为，人是照着神的形像被造的。

“神就照着自己的形像造人，乃是照着他的形像造男造女。”（创世记 1:27，和合本）

因此，每个人的生命和尊严都应当被尊重。而与生命紧密相关的，就是人生存所需的财产与资源。

在旧约律法中，我们清楚看见神设立各种条例来保护人的财产。例如，偷牛或羊的人要赔偿，被人损坏的田地或财物要得到补偿，拿了邻舍的东西却否认的人也要偿还。（参出埃及记 22:1、22:5-6；利未记 6:2-5）

这些律例说明，神非常看重财产权的保护。财产不是别人可以随意拿取的东西，而是与人的尊严、生存和责任紧密相连。

二、不可偷盗：尊重所有权的核心理念

“不可偷盗”的命令，不仅指夜里潜入别人家偷窃，也包括一切对他人合法所有物的侵犯。

最直接的偷盗，是偷钱、偷物、偷取资源。

这些行为破坏人与人之间最基本的信任。圣经警告说：

“从前偷窃的，不要再偷；总要劳力，亲手作正经事，就可有余，分给那缺少的人。”（以弗所书 4:28，和合本）

偷盗也可以是隐性的。

例如，不公平的天平与度量衡，就是商业上的偷窃。

“诡诈的天平为耶和华所憎恶；公平的法码为他所喜悦。”（箴言 11:1，和合本）

工人应得的工资若被拖延或克扣，也是对他人劳动成果的侵犯。律法说：

“雇工人的工价，不可在你那里过夜留到早晨。”（利未记 19:13，和合本）

在当今社会，知识、创意、文字、图像、代码和研究成果，也属于人的劳动成果。

写论文不注明出处、抄袭他人成果、盗版书籍和软件、未经授权使用他人的作品，都是现代形式的偷盗。

主耶稣说：“工人得工价是应当的。”（路加福音 10:7，和合本）

知识工作者的心血，同样应当被尊重。

还有一种不容易被察觉的偷盗，是时间与责任的偷盗。

雇员工作时长偷懒、浪费公司时间，是不诚实；领导者不负责任，却把团队成果据为己有，也是不义。

偷盗的本质，是不尊重他人，也不尊重神所设立的秩序。

三、圣经中的积极价值

禁止偷盗，不只是负面的限制，更有积极的呼召。

第一，是诚实守信。

箴言说：“行正直路的，步步安稳；走弯曲道的，必致败露。”（箴言 10:9，和合本）

尊重他人财产权的根基，是内心的诚实。

第二，是勤劳工作。

保罗劝勉说：“若有人不肯作工，就不可吃饭。”（帖撒罗尼迦后书 3:10，和合本）

偷盗常常源于懒惰、贪婪与不愿承担责任。勤劳则是一种尊重自己、尊重他人、尊重神托付的生活方式。

第三，是乐善好施。

禁止偷盗的更高境界，不只是“不拿别人的”，而是从索取转为给予。

以弗所书 4:28 不仅说不要再偷，也说要亲手作正经事，“就可有余，分给那缺少的人”。

尊重他人的所有权，并不排斥分享。真正的分享，必须建立在自愿、爱心和正当所有的基础上。

四、当代社会中的挑战

在现代社会，“偷盗”早已不限于实物，而有更复杂的表现。

知识产权的侵犯，是对创作者劳动成果的轻视。抄袭论文、盗版音乐、电影、软件，虽然不像传统偷窃那样显眼，却同样是不公义。

网络与数据安全，也属于“不可偷盗”原则的范围。黑客入侵、盗取隐私、非法使用个人数据、刷单造假，都是当代社会的新型偷盗。

经济与金融的不义，也可能是现代版的偷窃。金融欺诈、内幕交易、虚假广告，掠夺的不只是金钱，更是社会的信任。

公共资源的滥用，同样值得警醒。乱占公共空间、浪费能源、恶意占用他人时间，都是对公共利益和他人权益的侵犯。

五、属灵的角度

在更深的意义上，偷盗不仅是对人的冒犯，也是对神的冒犯。

玛拉基书说：

“人岂可夺取神之物呢？你们竟夺取我的供物。”（玛拉基书 3:8，和合本）

这让我们看见，“不可偷盗”的根源，是要人承认两件事：

第一，所有权的最终归属在于神。

第二，我们拥有的一切，都是神的托付。

因此，尊重别人的所有权，本质上也是尊重神的创造与托付。

六、如何实践尊重所有权

在个人层面，我们要做诚实正直的人，不贪图不义之财；在学术和写作中严格引用，避免抄袭与侵权；在日常生活中自律，不因小事轻视别人的权益。

在家庭层面，我们要教育孩子尊重他人物品，不随便拿别人的东西；也要在家庭中彼此尊重，共同承担责任，而不是互相占便宜。

在社会层面，我们要支持知识产权保护，尊重正版，鼓励创新；在工作中公平公正，按时支付工资，尊重劳动成果；在公共生活中守法守规，维护公共利益。

七、结语

“不可偷盗”是一条简洁却深远的诫命。

它不仅要求我们不侵犯他人财产，也提醒我们尊重所有权、尊重劳动、尊重创造、尊重神的托付。

在一个常常被贪婪和短视支配的社会，基督徒被呼召活出不同的见证：

不占不义之利，反而勤劳正直。

不掠夺他人成果，反而慷慨分享。

不侵犯别人的权利，反而尊重和成全。

因为我们深知，最终的主权属于神，我们不过是祂的管家。

愿我们都能在生活的每一个细节中，实践“不可偷盗”的诫命，成为诚实守信、尊重他人、荣耀神的子民。



Respecting Ownership

Reflections on “You Shall Not Steal”

When God gave the Ten Commandments at Mount Sinai, one command was brief and powerful:

“You shall not steal.” (Exodus 20:15, NIV)

Though short, this command touches the basic order of human society. It does not merely prohibit the act of theft. It also affirms and protects ownership, property, labor, creativity, and human dignity.

1. The Dignity of Life and Property

The biblical worldview teaches that human beings are created in the image of God.

“So God created mankind in his own image.” (Genesis 1:27, NIV) Because of this, every person’s life and dignity must be respected. Closely connected to life are the property, resources, and means by which a person lives.

In Old Testament law, we see many commands designed to protect property. A person who stole an ox or sheep had to make restitution. Someone who damaged another person’s field or property had to compensate the loss. A person who took what belonged to a neighbor and denied it had to repay what was taken. (See Exodus 22:1, 22:5-6; Leviticus 6:2-5.)

These laws show that God takes the protection of ownership seriously. Property is not something others may simply take at will. It is connected to dignity, survival, responsibility, and justice.

2. “You Shall Not Steal”: The Heart of Respecting Ownership

The command “You shall not steal” does not refer only to breaking into someone’s home and taking possessions. It includes every violation of what lawfully belongs to another person.

The most direct form of theft is taking money, objects, or resources.

Such actions destroy basic trust between people. Scripture warns: “Anyone who has been stealing must steal no longer, but must work.” (Ephesians 4:28, NIV)

Theft can also be hidden.

Dishonest scales and measurements, for example, are forms of theft in business.

“The LORD detests dishonest scales, but accurate weights find favor with him.” (Proverbs 11:1, NIV)

Withholding or delaying wages that workers deserve is also a violation of another person’s labor.

The law says, “Do not hold back the wages of a hired worker overnight.” (Leviticus 19:13, NIV)

In today’s world, knowledge, creativity, writing, images, code, and research are also the fruit of human labor.

Failing to cite sources, plagiarizing another person’s work, pirating books or software, and using someone’s creative work without permission are modern forms of theft.

Jesus said, “The worker deserves his wages.” (Luke 10:7, NIV)

The labor of knowledge workers must also be respected.

Another less visible kind of theft is the theft of time and responsibility.

An employee who consistently wastes work time is being dishonest. A leader who claims the results of a team while refusing responsibility is also acting unjustly.

At its root, theft is a failure to respect others and a failure to honor the order God has established.

3. The Positive Value Behind the Command

The prohibition against stealing is not only a negative restriction. It also carries a positive calling.

First, it calls us to honesty and trustworthiness.

Proverbs says, “Whoever walks in integrity walks securely.” (Proverbs 10:9, NIV)

The foundation of respecting another person's property is honesty in the heart.

Second, it calls us to diligent work.

Paul teaches, "The one who is unwilling to work shall not eat." (2 Thessalonians 3:10, NIV)

Theft often grows out of laziness, greed, and unwillingness to bear responsibility. Diligent work is a way of respecting ourselves, others, and the stewardship God has given us.

Third, it calls us to generosity.

The higher meaning of "Do not steal" is not only that we stop taking from others, but that we move from grasping to giving. Ephesians 4:28 not only says that the thief must stop stealing; it also calls him to work so that he may have something to share with those in need.

Respecting ownership does not oppose sharing. True sharing must be voluntary, loving, and rooted in what rightly belongs to the giver.

4. Contemporary Challenges

In modern society, theft is no longer limited to physical objects. It appears in more complex forms.

The violation of intellectual property is a disregard for the labor of creators. Plagiarizing papers, pirating music, films, or software may not look like traditional theft, but it is still unjust. Cybersecurity and data privacy also fall under the principle of "You shall not steal." Hacking, stealing private information, illegally using personal data, and manipulating online systems are new forms of theft in the digital age.

Economic and financial injustice can also become modern theft. Financial fraud, insider trading, and false advertising take not only money, but also public trust.

The misuse of public resources also deserves attention.

Occupying public space without regard for others, wasting energy, or carelessly consuming other people's time can become violations of shared responsibility and public good.

5. The Spiritual Dimension

At a deeper level, theft is not only an offense against people. It is also an offense against God.

Malachi asks:

“Will a mere mortal rob God? Yet you rob me.” (Malachi 3:8, NIV)

This shows us that the root of “You shall not steal” is the recognition of two truths:

First, ultimate ownership belongs to God.

Second, everything we possess is entrusted to us by God.

Therefore, respecting another person’s ownership is also a way of respecting God’s creation and stewardship.

6. Practicing Respect for Ownership

On a personal level, we must become honest and upright people, refusing dishonest gain. In academic work and writing, we must cite carefully and avoid plagiarism or infringement. In daily life, we must discipline ourselves not to dismiss other people’s rights as small matters.

In the family, we should teach children to respect what belongs to others and not to take things casually. We should also practice mutual respect at home, sharing responsibility instead of taking advantage of one another.

In society, we should support the protection of intellectual property, respect legitimate products, and encourage innovation.

In the workplace, we should act justly, pay wages on time, and honor the fruit of labor. In public life, we should obey laws, keep order, and protect the common good.

7. Conclusion

“You shall not steal” is a brief but far-reaching command.

It calls us not only to avoid taking another person’s property, but also to respect ownership, labor, creativity, and the stewardship entrusted by God.

In a society often shaped by greed and short-term thinking, Christians are called to bear a different witness:

Do not take unjust gain, but work diligently and honestly.

Do not seize the fruit of others, but share generously.

Do not violate the rights of others, but respect and build up.
We do this because we know that ultimate lordship belongs to
God, and we are only stewards.

May we practice the command “You shall not steal” in every
detail of life, becoming people of honesty, respect, and
faithfulness who glorify God.

第三篇：尊重誓约：从“不可奸淫”谈起



“婚姻不是短暂感觉，而是神圣盟约”

在西奈山上，神将十诫赐给以色列人，其中一句简洁而震撼人心的话是：

“不可奸淫。”（出埃及记 20:14，和合本）

这条诫命不仅是对个人行为的限制，更深层地揭示了神对婚姻的神圣设立，也显明祂对誓约的重视。

婚姻不只是两个人之间的契约，更是在神面前立下的庄严盟约。

奸淫的背后，本质上是对盟约的背叛，对配偶的伤害，对家庭的撕裂，也是对神所设立婚姻秩序的轻慢。

因此，“不可奸淫”所强调的，不只是性的边界，更是对誓约的尊重。

一、婚姻：神圣的设立

圣经清楚地告诉我们，婚姻不是人的发明，而是神的设立。

创世记说：

“因此，人要离开父母，与妻子连合，二人成为一体。”

（创世记 2:24，和合本）

这是圣经中对婚姻最早的描述。婚姻的核心在这里已经清楚显明：离开、连合、成为一体。

主耶稣也引用这段经文，并说：

“既然如此，夫妻不再是两个人，乃是一体的了。所以，神配合的，人不可分开。”（马太福音 19:6，和合本）

这表明，婚姻不仅是情感的结合，也不仅是法律的约束，更是在神面前的属灵联合。

因此，性不应被从盟约中抽离出来，成为单独消费的经验。它在婚姻中才有真正完整的意义：彼此交托，彼此委身，彼此守约。

当夫妻在神面前立约时，彼此的身体、生命与未来，都成为相互托付的一部分。

二、誓约的本质：一体与忠诚

在圣经中，婚姻被称为盟约。

先知玛拉基责备以色列人对妻子不忠，说：

“她虽是你的配偶，又是你盟约的妻。”（玛拉基书 2:14，和合本）

这句话点出婚姻的双重身份：

她是你的配偶，这是情感与生活的联合。

她是你盟约的妻，这是誓言与属灵的联合。

奸淫之所以严重，是因为它破坏的不只是夫妻之间的感情，更是违背了盟约。

盟约意味着忠诚与守信：不因环境改变而更改，不因情绪波动而背叛，不因一时欲望而否定一生承诺。

在圣经中，“奸淫”也常被用来比喻神的子民对神的不忠。以色列人离弃耶和華去随从别神，常被先知称为属灵的淫乱。

这说明，婚姻中的忠诚不仅是夫妻之间的事，也是一种对神信实的见证。

三、人的悖逆：誓约的失落

遗憾的是，自古以来，人类并没有忠实守住婚姻誓约。

在旧约中，亚伯拉罕虽然有撒拉，却因人的软弱接受夏甲，带来家庭与后代中的冲突。所罗门王虽有智慧，却因众多妃嫔使心偏离耶和華。以色列人也常陷入淫乱，不仅是肉体上的，也包括属灵上的偶像崇拜。

进入现代社会，人对婚姻誓约的漠视更加明显。

婚前同居，常常把性当作试验，却不愿承担盟约。

婚外情与轻率离婚，使誓言被当作可以随时撤回的话。

多元关系与对婚姻定义的重新建构，也反映出当代人试图用自己的方式重写神所设立的秩序。

这些现象表明，人类不断想用自己的方法来“改良”或“突破”婚姻，结果却常常带来更深的伤害、孤独与混乱。

四、尊重誓约的意义

为什么神如此强调“不可奸淫”？

因为婚姻誓约关系到三个层面的见证。

第一，是对配偶的见证。

婚姻是彼此交托的盟约。奸淫摧毁信任，让本应安全的家成为最受伤的地方。

第二，是对社会的见证。

家庭是社会的基本单元。若婚姻誓约被轻视，社会的稳定与下一代的成长必然受到影响。

第三，是对神的见证。

保罗说，婚姻预表基督与教会的关系：

“为这个缘故，人要离开父母，与妻子连合，二人成为一体。这是极大的奥秘，但我是指着基督和教会说的。”（以弗所书 5:31-32，和合本）

夫妻彼此忠诚，正是在向世界见证基督与教会之间那种舍己、忠贞、持久的爱。

因此，尊重婚姻誓约，不仅是守住一条诫命，更是在生活中彰显神的荣美。

五、如何实践尊重誓约

尊重誓约，不只是消极地“不奸淫”，更包括积极地守护婚姻。

第一，建立敬畏神的心。

婚姻不是只有两个人的契约，而是在神面前的盟约。只有在敬畏神的心中，婚姻誓言才不会被情绪、欲望和环境轻易推翻。

第二，培养夫妻之间真实的沟通。

很多婚姻的破裂并非一夜之间发生，而是长期缺乏沟通、理解和修复。尊重誓约，需要夫妻不断在交流、宽恕和接纳中成长。

第三，守住身心的纯洁。

主耶稣说：

“凡看见妇女就动淫念的，这人心里已经与她犯奸淫了。”
(马太福音 5:28，和合本)

尊重誓约不仅是外在行为，更包括内心的圣洁与自律。

第四，在教会中彼此守望。

教会群体应当成为婚姻的守护者。透过教导、辅导、关怀和同行，帮助夫妻坚守誓约，而不是等婚姻破裂之后才匆忙补救。

六、基督里的盼望

当我们审视婚姻与誓约时，不能否认，人类历史充满失败。

多少人违背誓言，多少家庭因不忠而破裂，多少人在亲密关系中受伤。

然而，感谢主，基督带来恢复与盼望。

基督是那位为新妇教会舍命的新郎。祂的爱是完全的、舍己的、永不改变的。

祂赦免破碎的人，也医治受伤的婚姻。

那些在婚姻中跌倒的人，在基督里仍能找到赦免与更新；那些被背叛的人，也能在基督里找到安慰与重新站立的力量。

因此，尊重誓约不仅是一条诫命，更是一种恩典中的呼召：呼召我们回到神面前，靠着祂的力量活出忠诚与信实。

七、结语

“不可奸淫”是一条神圣的诫命。

它提醒我们：婚姻是盟约，盟约必须被尊重。

婚姻是神所设立的关系，是一生一世的托付。奸淫不仅伤害配偶，也背叛誓约，更轻慢神的心意。

在一个轻看承诺、追求即时满足的世代，基督徒被呼召活出与世界不同的见证：

尊重生命的盟约。

守住婚姻的纯洁。

活出基督对教会的忠诚与爱。

愿我们都能记住：尊重誓约，不只是为了婚姻本身，更是为了荣耀那位设立婚姻的主。



Respecting Covenant

Reflections on “You Shall Not Commit Adultery”

At Mount Sinai, God gave the Ten Commandments to Israel.

Among them is a brief but weighty command:

“You shall not commit adultery.” (Exodus 20:14, NIV)

This command is not merely a restriction on personal behavior.

At a deeper level, it reveals God’s sacred design for marriage and His concern for covenant faithfulness.

Marriage is not simply a contract between two people. It is a solemn covenant made before God.

Behind adultery is a betrayal of covenant, an injury to one’s spouse, a tearing of the family, and a disregard for the order God established for marriage.

Therefore, “You shall not commit adultery” is not only about sexual boundaries. It is about honoring covenant.

1. Marriage: A Sacred Institution

Scripture teaches clearly that marriage is not a human invention, but God’s design.

Genesis says:

“That is why a man leaves his father and mother and is united to his wife, and they become one flesh.” (Genesis 2:24, NIV)

This is the earliest biblical description of marriage. Its core elements are already clear: leaving, cleaving, and becoming one flesh.

Jesus later quoted this passage and added:

“Therefore what God has joined together, let no one separate.”
(Matthew 19:6, NIV)

This shows that marriage is not merely an emotional bond or a legal arrangement. It is a spiritual union before God.

For this reason, sex should not be separated from covenant and turned into a private consumer experience. Within marriage, it finds its proper meaning: mutual trust, mutual surrender, and covenant faithfulness.

When husband and wife make vows before God, their bodies, lives, and futures become part of what they entrust to one another.

2. The Nature of Covenant: Oneness and Faithfulness

In Scripture, marriage is described as a covenant.

The prophet Malachi rebuked Israelite men for their unfaithfulness and called the wife “your partner, the wife of your marriage covenant.” (Malachi 2:14, NIV)

This sentence reveals the double identity of marriage.

She is your spouse: a union of affection and daily life.

She is the wife of your covenant: a union of vow and spiritual responsibility.

Adultery is serious because it breaks more than affection. It violates covenant.

Covenant means loyalty and faithfulness. It does not change simply because circumstances change. It does not betray because emotions shift. It does not deny lifelong promises because of passing desire.

In Scripture, adultery is also used as an image of God’s people being unfaithful to Him. When Israel turned from the Lord to other gods, the prophets often described it as spiritual adultery. This shows that marital faithfulness is not only a matter between husband and wife. It is also a witness to God’s own faithfulness.

3. Human Rebellion: The Loss of Covenant

Sadly, human beings have not faithfully guarded the marriage covenant.

In the Old Testament, Abraham had Sarah, yet human weakness led to Hagar, and family conflict followed. Solomon possessed great wisdom, yet his many wives turned his heart away from the Lord. Israel repeatedly fell into immorality, both physical and spiritual.

In modern society, disregard for covenant has become even more visible.

Cohabitation before marriage often treats sex as a trial while avoiding covenant responsibility.

Adultery and casual divorce turn vows into words that can be withdrawn at will.

Plural relationships and attempts to reconstruct the definition of marriage also reveal the modern desire to rewrite the order God has established.

These realities show that humanity keeps trying to “improve” or “move beyond” marriage by its own wisdom, yet the result is often deeper hurt, loneliness, and confusion.

4. Why Respecting Covenant Matters

Why does God emphasize “You shall not commit adultery” so strongly?

Because the marriage covenant bears witness on three levels.

First, it bears witness to the spouse.

Marriage is a covenant of mutual trust. Adultery destroys trust and turns the home, which should be a place of safety, into a place of deep pain.

Second, it bears witness to society.

The family is a basic unit of society. When the marriage covenant is weakened, the stability of society and the formation of the next generation are inevitably affected.

Third, it bears witness to God.

Paul teaches that marriage points to the relationship between Christ and the church:

“This is a profound mystery—but I am talking about Christ and the church.” (Ephesians 5:32, NIV)

When husband and wife remain faithful to one another, they bear witness to the self-giving, faithful, enduring love between Christ and His church.

Therefore, respecting the marriage covenant is not merely keeping a rule. It is displaying the beauty of God in ordinary life.

5. Practicing Respect for Covenant

Respecting covenant is not only the negative act of avoiding adultery. It also requires actively guarding marriage.

First, cultivate reverence for God.

Marriage is not merely a contract between two people. It is a covenant before God. Only when the heart fears God will marriage vows not be easily overturned by emotion, desire, or circumstance.

Second, nurture honest communication between husband and wife.

Many marriages do not break in a single moment. They erode over time through lack of communication, understanding, and repair. Respecting covenant requires couples to keep growing in conversation, forgiveness, and acceptance.

Third, guard purity of heart and body.

Jesus said:

“Anyone who looks at a woman lustfully has already committed adultery with her in his heart.” (Matthew 5:28, NIV)

Respecting covenant is not only about outward behavior. It also involves inward purity and self-discipline.

Fourth, practice mutual care within the church.

The church should be a guardian of marriage. Through teaching, counseling, care, and companionship, the church helps couples keep covenant before damage becomes collapse.

6. Hope in Christ

When we look honestly at marriage and covenant, we must admit that human history is filled with failure.

Many people have broken vows. Many families have been wounded by unfaithfulness. Many have suffered deeply in intimate relationships.

Yet thanks be to God, Christ brings restoration and hope. Christ is the bridegroom who gave Himself for His bride, the church. His love is complete, self-giving, and unchanging. He forgives the broken and heals wounded marriages.

Those who have fallen in marriage can still find forgiveness and renewal in Christ. Those who have been betrayed can also find comfort and strength to stand again in Him.

Therefore, respecting covenant is not only a command. It is also a calling within grace: a call to return to God and, by His strength, live with faithfulness and truth.

7. Conclusion

“You shall not commit adultery” is a sacred command.

It reminds us that marriage is covenant, and covenant must be honored.

Marriage is a relationship established by God, a lifelong entrusting of oneself to another. Adultery not only injures the spouse; it betrays covenant and disregards the heart of God.

In a generation that often treats commitment lightly and pursues immediate satisfaction, Christians are called to bear a different witness:

Honor the covenant of life.

Guard the purity of marriage.

Live out the faithfulness and love of Christ for His church.

May we remember that respecting covenant is not only for the sake of marriage itself, but for the glory of the Lord who established marriage.

第四篇：当信仰遇上科技



“下一代基督徒的使命与试炼”

如果你观察这个时代的年轻人，你会发现一个前所未有的现实：他们从小生活在互联网里，成长在智能手机里，学习在算法里，交友在社交媒体里，未来则越来越多地被人工智能塑造。

他们不是简单“使用科技的人”。

他们是被科技塑造的人。

上一代人讨论的是：科技会如何改变我们的生活？

下一代人面对的是：科技正在如何改变他们的灵魂？

科技已经不只是工具。它正在成为价值塑造者、注意力掠夺者、身份放大器、情绪操控者、生活节奏的支配者，也正在参与塑造人的世界观。

这是一个从未有过的时代。

科技让世界更大，也让心变得更小；科技让人更聪明，也让灵魂更脆弱；科技给人更多可能，也带来更多迷失。

一个新的时代正在展开，而信仰也在这个时代面临新的挑战。

下一代基督徒必须在科技风暴中回答两个关键问题：

我是谁？

我该如何活？

首先，科技撕裂人的注意力。

过去的人担心没有圣经可以读；现在的人常常担心读不到三节经文，就忍不住看手机。

注意力，是灵命成长最基础的能力。一个人若无法专注，就难以祷告，难以默想，也难以安静听见神。

科技让人聪明，却让心难以安静。这可能是下一代最大的属灵危机之一。

其次，科技让身份容易被点赞与算法绑架。

过去，人们主要从家庭、文化和信仰中获得身份。如今，许多人从点赞、关注、热度、评论、头像和社交定位中寻找价值。

但算法从来没有爱，只有利用。

一个不在基督里找到身份的年轻人，很容易在算法里迷失。

第三，科技让情绪更容易被操控。

人工智能可以识别情绪，社交媒体可以放大情绪，网络冲突比线下冲突更直接、更密集。于是这一代人更容易焦虑，更容易受伤，更容易愤怒，也更容易孤单。

当情绪长期混乱，灵性也必然受阻。

第四，科技让世界更加碎片化。

年轻人每天接触到进化论、多元文化、无神论、泛灵性、自我崇拜、AI 意识讨论、虚拟身份、性别议题、去权威化和大量碎片知识。

他们知道很多，却未必看见真理；接触很广，却未必有根基。

如果没有深度信仰作为整合的中心，人的世界观就会变成一盘散沙。

第五，科技弱化真实关系。

这一代人可能与网上的人更熟，与现实的人更远；朋友很多，真正的朋友很少；信息不断，心却孤单；社群很多，属灵共同体却稀少。

信仰不是一个人可以完整活出来的。但科技让“独行侠式信仰”变得越来越常见。

这将是未来教会最大的牧养挑战之一。

试炼是真实的，但伴随试炼的，也是使命。

下一代基督徒不是要逃避时代，而是要在时代中彰显基督。

第一，他们要在噪音的世界中建立安静的文化。

这个时代越来越快、越来越吵、越来越浅。下一代基督徒要学习反其道而行：建立祷告生活，练习默想，关掉手机，留下安静，把注意力从算法手中收回来，把心重新转向神。

在一个无法安静的时代，能安静的人，本身就是见证。

第二，他们要在虚拟的世界中活出真实的生命。

科技可以模拟陪伴，却不能带来真实。下一代必须让世界看见真实的爱、真实的友谊、真实的信仰、真实的告白、真实的悔改、真实的关系和真实的眼泪。

真实，是基督徒最强的反文化力量。

第三，他们要在碎片化时代建立有整合力的信仰。

下一代不能只会背金句，也必须学习系统性思维、神学框架、圣经内在脉络，以及信仰与世界的对话。

他们不是只要知道“圣经怎么说”，也要学习如何用信仰看世界。

第四，他们要在被算法牵动的时代，活出圣灵引导的人生。

算法猜你喜欢什么，圣灵知道你需要什么。

下一代必须学会辨别动机，不受流量牵动，不被舆论绑架，不被网络身份定义，并且每天重新问神：主，我该做什么？

当别人被数据引导时，基督徒要学习被圣灵引导。

第五，他们要在价值混乱的时代，活出圣洁的反文化见证。

科技时代的价值观越来越主观、放纵、去边界、去权威、去绝对，越来越强调体验，也越来越崇拜自我。

下一代基督徒必须更坚定地持守圣经真理、圣洁生活、纯正信仰、付代价的跟随、诚实的工作、温柔的勇气和爱人的心。

他们要成为真理清晰、灵魂稳固、生命真实的一代。

科技不是试炼的终点，而是呼召的起点。

为什么神让这一代人活在科技时代？为什么 AI 在这个时代爆炸式发展？

也许正因为这一代有一个独特呼召：在技术时代为神发光。

他们将在数字时代传福音，在网络空间塑造文化，在 AI 时代成为灵性导师，在价值真空中建立圣经价值，在虚拟世界中坚持真实生命，在迷失的时代带来方向，在喧嚣中成为安静之人，在黑暗中成为光。

科技不会毁掉信仰。

它只会推动信仰进入新的战场。

下一代不是要被科技吞没，而是要成为科技时代的光与盐。

我们无法阻止科技改变世界，但我们可以决定科技不能改变我们的心。

愿下一代成为在 AI 时代保持属灵敏感的人，在互联网里活出真实生命的人，在碎片世界里建立整全信仰的人，在算法时代跟随圣灵的人，在虚拟时代带来真实的人，在价值混乱时代活出圣洁的人，在动荡世界中稳稳站立的人。

愿这一代年轻人，不只是时代的产物，而是时代的光。

因为科技可以创造未来，但只有神能引领永恒。



When Faith Meets Technology

The Mission and Testing of the Next Generation of Christians

If you observe young people today, you will notice a reality unlike anything previous generations have known: they have lived inside the internet since childhood, grown up with smartphones, learned through algorithms, formed friendships through social media, and now face a future increasingly shaped by artificial intelligence.

They are not merely people who use technology.

They are people being formed by technology.

The previous generation asked, “How will technology change our lives?”

The next generation must ask, “How is technology changing our souls?”

Technology is no longer merely a tool. It has become a shaper of values, a thief of attention, an amplifier of identity, a manipulator of emotion, a ruler of daily rhythms, and a powerful force in shaping worldviews.

This is an unprecedented age.

Technology makes the world larger, yet often makes the heart smaller. It makes people smarter, yet often makes the soul more fragile. It gives people more possibilities, yet also creates more confusion.

A new age is unfolding, and faith faces new challenges within it.

The next generation of Christians must answer two crucial questions in the storm of technology:

Who am I?

How should I live?

First, technology fractures attention.

In the past, people worried about not having a Bible to read.

Today, many people struggle to read even three verses before reaching for their phones.

Attention is one of the most basic capacities for spiritual growth. A person who cannot focus will find it difficult to pray, to meditate, and to become quiet enough to hear God.

Technology may make people clever, but it often makes the heart restless. This may be one of the greatest spiritual crises facing the next generation.

Second, technology allows identity to be captured by likes and algorithms.

In the past, people often received their identity from family, culture, and faith. Today, many seek value through likes, followers, popularity, comments, avatars, and social positioning. But algorithms do not love. They only use.

A young person who does not find identity in Christ will easily become lost within the algorithm.

Third, technology makes emotions easier to manipulate.

Artificial intelligence can identify emotion. Social media can intensify emotion. Online conflict is often more direct and more frequent than conflict in physical life. As a result, this generation is more easily anxious, wounded, angry, and lonely.

When emotions remain disordered for too long, spiritual life is inevitably hindered.

Fourth, technology fragments worldview.

Young people encounter evolution, pluralism, atheism, spiritual confusion, self-worship, debates about AI consciousness, virtual identities, gender issues, deconstruction of authority, and endless fragments of information.

They may know many things, but not see truth. They may be widely exposed, but not deeply rooted.

Without a deep faith at the center to integrate what they receive, their worldview becomes scattered.

Fifth, technology weakens real relationships.

This generation may be more familiar with people online than with people nearby. It may have many contacts but few true friends, constant messages but lonely hearts, countless online communities but few spiritual communities.

Faith cannot be fully lived alone. Yet technology makes the “solo Christian” increasingly common.

This will be one of the great pastoral challenges for the future church.

The testing is real, but with the testing comes a mission.

The next generation of Christians is not called to escape the age. They are called to reveal Christ within it.

First, they must build a culture of stillness in a noisy world.

This age is becoming faster, louder, and shallower. The next generation of Christians must learn to move differently: to build a life of prayer, practice meditation, turn off the phone, preserve quietness, reclaim attention from the algorithm, and turn the heart back toward God.

In an age that cannot be still, a person who can be still becomes a witness.

Second, they must live real lives in a virtual world.

Technology can simulate companionship, but it cannot create true presence. The next generation must show the world real love, real friendship, real faith, real confession, real repentance, real relationships, and real tears.

Authenticity is one of the strongest countercultural forces Christians can offer.

Third, they must build an integrated faith in a fragmented age. The next generation cannot only memorize Bible verses. They must learn systematic thinking, theological frameworks, the inner coherence of Scripture, and how faith speaks to the world. They must not only know what the Bible says. They must learn to see the world through faith.

Fourth, in an age driven by algorithms, they must live lives guided by the Holy Spirit.

The algorithm guesses what you like. The Holy Spirit knows what you need.

The next generation must learn to discern motives, resist being driven by traffic, refuse to be kidnapped by public opinion, reject being defined by online identity, and ask God each day, "Lord, what should I do?"

When others are guided by data, Christians must learn to be guided by the Spirit.

Fifth, they must live a holy countercultural witness in a confused age.

The values of the technological age are becoming increasingly subjective, permissive, boundaryless, anti-authority, anti-absolute, experience-centered, and self-worshipping.

The next generation of Christians must be more firmly rooted in biblical truth, holy living, sound faith, costly discipleship, honest work, gentle courage, and love for others.

They must become a generation with clear truth, steady souls, and authentic lives.

Technology is not the end of the test. It is the beginning of a calling.

Why has God allowed this generation to live in the age of technology? Why has AI developed so explosively in this time? Perhaps because this generation has a unique calling: to shine for God in a technological age.

They will proclaim the gospel in a digital age, shape culture in online spaces, become spiritual guides in the age of AI, establish biblical values in a vacuum of meaning, insist on real life in a virtual world, bring direction in a confused age, become quiet people in a noisy world, and shine as light in darkness.

Technology will not destroy faith.

It will push faith onto a new battlefield.

The next generation is not called to be swallowed by technology. They are called to become salt and light in the age of technology. We cannot stop technology from changing the world, but we can decide that technology will not change our hearts.

May the next generation remain spiritually sensitive in the age of AI. May they live authentic lives on the internet. May they build whole faith in a fragmented world. May they follow the Spirit in the age of algorithms. May they bring reality into virtual spaces, holiness into moral confusion, and stability into a restless world.

May this generation of young people be more than products of the age.

May they become light for the age.

Technology may create the future, but only God can lead us into eternity.

第五篇：当教会进入 AI 时代



“信徒如何在技术变革中保持属灵敏感”

过去二十年，技术像一阵风，从来没有问过我们是否准备好，就已经把我们带进了新的时代。

AI 出现以后，这阵风变成了暴风。

以前我们以为，技术只是工具；现在我们越来越发现，技术正在成为环境，成为空气，甚至成为一种新的力量体系。

AI 会写文章、创作音乐、整理资料、预测趋势，甚至模拟人的对话。它不像互联网时代只是提供资讯，它更像一个“智慧存在”，安静地陪在我们身边。它让信息不再稀缺，而是无限；让效率不再是问题，而是变成速度的负担；也让人类第一次清楚意识到：我们不再是唯一看起来“会思考”的存在。

于是，我们不得不问：

在一个 AI 无所不在的时代，教会该改变什么？信徒该守住什么？灵命如何不被淹没？属灵敏感如何被保存？辨别力如何不被替代？

这是属于这个时代的新属灵功课。

一、AI 时代带来的属灵挑战

第一，从知识太少，到资讯过载。

过去，我们的难处是“不知道”。如今，我们的难处是“知道太多”。

资讯太多，会让心灵疲惫、灵性分散，使人失去安静，也失去聆听的能力。问题往往不是没有神的声音，而是太多声音淹没了神的声音。

属灵敏感不是靠更多知识，而是靠一颗安静的心。

第二，从效率不足，到效率成瘾。

AI 让许多事情变得更快：写作更快，查资料更快，沟通更快，回复更快。

可是灵命不是越快越好。属灵生命需要慢，需要深，需要等候、经历、反思和陪伴。

AI 可以解决效率的问题，却无法替代灵魂的深度。

第三，从人比机器强，到机器越来越像“人”。

AI 会写诗，会安慰，会交谈，会陪伴。甚至有人说：“AI 比很多人更理解我。”

这是一种危险的时代征兆：我们比以往更孤单，以至于机器的温柔都开始触动人的心。

信徒若没有真实而深入的关系连结，心灵就可能被机器的模拟陪伴所取代。

第四，从价值由人判断，到价值被算法塑造。

过去，人们靠良心、传统、文化、圣经、牧者、群体和祷告来形成判断。今天，许多人靠推荐算法、热点、搜索引擎、爆款内容和评论区意见来决定自己看什么、想什么、相信什么。

算法比我们更了解我们的偏好。更危险的是，它开始替我们做决定。

因此，如果信徒没有属灵敏敏，就会不知不觉被世界的模式塑造。

二、AI 不会淘汰神，也不能取代教会

有一种恐惧是：“AI 会不会取代教会？会不会取代讲道？会不会取代牧师？”

答案是：不会。永远不会。

AI 能处理资讯，却不能更新灵魂。

AI 能分析情绪，却不能拥抱一个受伤的人。

AI 能写出讲章，却不能为人代祷。

AI 能整理知识，却不能施行救赎。

AI 能给出聪明的回答，却不能赐下圣灵的光照。

属灵生命不是信息交换，而是关系、启示、呼召、饶恕、悔改和转变。

这些，只有神能做。

三、在 AI 时代保持属灵敏感

第一，练习“灵命优先”，而不是“效率优先”。

AI 可以帮助你更快完成工作，却绝不能让你“更快完成祷告”。属灵生命不能被效率统治。

一天开始的时候，不要急着先打开手机，而要先打开心。先神，再生活。

第二，学会信息过滤，保护内在的圣所。

属灵敏感最怕的，不只是明显的罪，也包括持续的嘈杂。每天资讯过载，会造成分心、心慌、容易被触发、失去专注，最后变得属灵麻木。

我们需要问自己：“我正在看的这些内容，是让我更像基督，还是更像世界？”

要为自己的心设立边界：不被通知绑架，不被热点牵动，不被算法控制。

灵魂需要宁静，才能听见神。

第三，保持灵性节奏，不让技术掌控时间。

AI 可以帮你节省时间，但节省下来的时间要归给神，而不是重新交给手机。

给自己设定灵修时间、安静时间、家庭共处时间、休息时间、无科技时间和主日敬拜时间。

节奏，是灵命的心跳。

第四，守住深度关系，不让 AI 替代真实的人际连结。

AI 能陪你聊天，却不能与你一起哭、一起祷告、一起走过苦难。

你仍然需要真实的人：属灵同伴、小组、家庭、牧者、属灵长辈和信仰群体。

AI 的陪伴是模拟的，群体的陪伴是真实的。

圣经从来没有呼召人成为独行的门徒，而是呼召我们进入基督的身体。

第五，练习辨别力：技术是工具，不是主宰。

圣经说：

“不要效法这个世界，只要心意更新而变化。”

（罗马书 12:2，和合本）

我们要常常分辨：这项技术会让我更接近神，还是更远离神？它是帮助我更好地生活，还是让我变得更懒？它是在释放我，还是在控制我？它只是工具，还是已经成为依赖？

信徒需要在技术面前保持清醒，而不是沉溺。

第六，让圣灵成为你生命中最重要“智能系统”。

你可以向 AI 问问题，但你不能把人生方向交给 AI。你的生命必须交给圣灵。

圣灵会引导、光照、责备、安慰、带领、更新、提醒和呼召。

AI 再智能，也不可能拥有圣灵的权柄。

AI 给你答案，圣灵给你道路。

四、教会如何回应 AI 时代

面对 AI，教会既不必拒绝，也不应迷恋，而是要以智慧使用，以信仰引导。

未来的教会可以使用 AI 提升行政效率，协助教学与门训，建立更精准的牧养系统，释放牧者更多时间陪伴人，也辅助查经、讲道预备和福音传播。

但同时，教会必须维护真实关系，坚守属灵操练，教导信徒分辨，抵抗世俗算法，深化灵命根基，让教会继续保持人性的温度与属神的深度。

技术是仆人，不是主人。

五、结语：技术会变，神的声音不变

AI 会越来越强，越来越像人，甚至在许多方面超越人。

但一个属灵敏感的人，不会被它吞没。

因为他知道，谁是生命的中心，谁是灵魂的牧者，谁给他方向，谁掌管未来，谁能真正触摸他的心。

技术更新世界，但神更新我们。

愿你在 AI 的巨浪中，不迷失，不焦虑，不被吞没，反而成为一个更清醒、更敏锐、更有智慧、更有深度的信徒。

愿你在技术革命中，仍能听见那句永恒的话：

“你们要休息，要知道我是神。”（诗篇 46:10，和合本）



When the Church Enters the Age of AI Staying Spiritually Sensitive in a Time of Technological Change

Over the past twenty years, technology has moved like a wind. It did not ask whether we were ready. It simply carried us into a new age.

With the rise of artificial intelligence, that wind has become a storm.

We once thought technology was only a tool. Now we are beginning to see that technology has become an environment, an atmosphere, even a new system of power.

AI can write articles, compose music, organize information, predict trends, and simulate human conversation. It no longer merely provides information, as the internet once did. It now feels like an intelligent presence quietly beside us. It makes information endless rather than scarce. It turns efficiency from a problem into a pressure. It also forces humanity to realize that we are no longer the only beings that appear to “think.”

So we begin to ask:

In an age where AI is everywhere, what should the church change? What must believers preserve? How can spiritual life avoid being drowned? How can spiritual sensitivity be protected? How can discernment avoid being replaced?

These are new spiritual lessons for our time.

1. The Spiritual Challenges of the AI Age

First, we have moved from too little knowledge to too much information.

In the past, the problem was not knowing. Today, the problem is knowing too much.

Too much information exhausts the heart, scatters the soul, removes stillness, and weakens our ability to listen. Often the problem is not that God is silent. It is that too many voices have drowned out the voice of God.

Spiritual sensitivity does not come from more information. It comes from a quiet heart.

Second, we have moved from lack of efficiency to addiction to efficiency.

AI makes many things faster: writing, research, communication, responses.

But spiritual life is not better simply because it is faster.

Spiritual life needs slowness, depth, waiting, experience, reflection, and companionship.

AI can solve problems of efficiency, but it cannot replace the depth of the soul.

Third, we have moved from humans being stronger than machines to machines seeming increasingly human.

AI can write poetry, offer comfort, hold conversations, and provide companionship. Some people even say, "AI understands me better than many people do."

That is a dangerous sign of the times. We are more lonely than ever, so lonely that even the simulated gentleness of machines can touch the human heart.

If believers lack deep and real relationships, their hearts may gradually be replaced by artificial companionship.

Fourth, we have moved from human judgment to algorithmic formation.

In the past, people formed their values through conscience, tradition, culture, Scripture, pastors, community, and prayer.

Today, many are shaped by recommendation algorithms, trends, search engines, viral content, and comment sections.

Algorithms know our preferences better than we do. The deeper danger is that they begin making decisions for us.

If believers lack spiritual sensitivity, they will slowly be formed by the patterns of this world without even realizing it.

2. AI Will Not Outdate God or Replace the Church

Some people fear, “Will AI replace the church? Will it replace preaching? Will it replace pastors?”

The answer is no. Never.

AI can process information, but it cannot renew the soul.

AI can analyze emotion, but it cannot embrace a wounded person.

AI can write a sermon, but it cannot pray for you.

AI can organize knowledge, but it cannot redeem.

AI can offer intelligent responses, but it cannot give the light of the Holy Spirit.

Spiritual life is not the exchange of information. It is relationship, revelation, calling, forgiveness, repentance, and transformation.

Only God can do these things.

3. How to Stay Spiritually Sensitive in the AI Age

First, practice spiritual priority rather than efficiency priority.

AI may help you finish work faster, but it must never teach you to “finish prayer faster.” Spiritual life must not be ruled by efficiency.

At the beginning of the day, do not rush to open your phone.

Open your heart first.

God first. Then life.

Second, learn to filter information and protect the inner sanctuary.

Spiritual sensitivity is threatened not only by obvious sin, but also by constant noise. Information overload creates distraction, anxiety, emotional reactivity, lack of focus, and eventually spiritual numbness.

We need to ask, “Is what I am consuming making me more like Christ or more like the world?”

Set boundaries for your heart: do not be kidnapped by notifications, driven by trends, or controlled by algorithms.

The soul needs quiet in order to hear God.

Third, keep a spiritual rhythm and do not let technology control your time.

AI may save time, but the time it saves should be given back to God, not handed back to your phone.

Set aside time for devotion, silence, family presence, rest, technology-free space, and Sunday worship.

Rhythm is the heartbeat of spiritual life.

Fourth, preserve deep relationships and do not let AI replace real human connection.

AI can chat with you, but it cannot weep with you, pray with you, or walk with you through suffering.

You still need real people: spiritual companions, small groups, family, pastors, spiritual elders, and a community of faith.

AI companionship is simulated. The companionship of the body of Christ is real.

Scripture never calls us to become solitary disciples. It calls us into the body of Christ.

Fifth, practice discernment. Technology is a tool, not a master.

Scripture says:

“Do not conform to the pattern of this world, but be transformed by the renewing of your mind.”

(Romans 12:2, NIV)

We must continually ask: Does this technology draw me closer to God or farther from Him? Does it help me live better, or make me spiritually lazy? Does it free me, or control me? Is it still a tool, or has it become a dependency?

Believers must remain awake before technology rather than absorbed by it.

Sixth, let the Holy Spirit become the most important “intelligent system” in your life.

You may ask AI questions, but you must not entrust your life direction to AI. Your life must be entrusted to the Holy Spirit. The Spirit guides, illumines, convicts, comforts, leads, renews, reminds, and calls.

No matter how intelligent AI becomes, it can never possess the authority of the Holy Spirit.

AI gives you answers. The Spirit gives you a path.

4. How the Church Should Respond to the AI Age

The church does not need to reject AI, nor should it idolize it. We must use it wisely and guide it faithfully.

The future church may use AI to improve administration, assist teaching and discipleship, build more precise systems of pastoral care, free pastors to spend more time with people, support Bible study and sermon preparation, and expand gospel reach.

At the same time, the church must preserve real relationships, practice spiritual disciplines, teach discernment, resist secular algorithms, deepen spiritual roots, and remain both deeply human and deeply God-centered.

Technology is a servant, not a master.

5. Conclusion: Technology Changes, but God's Voice Does Not

AI will become stronger, more humanlike, and in many ways more capable than human beings.

But spiritually sensitive people will not be swallowed by it.

They know who is the center of life, who is the shepherd of the soul, who gives direction, who holds the future, and who can truly touch the heart.

Technology updates the world, but God renews us.

May you not be lost, anxious, or swallowed by the great wave of AI. May you become a clearer, wiser, deeper, and more spiritually sensitive believer.

And in the middle of this technological revolution, may you still hear the eternal word:

“Be still, and know that I am God.”

(Psalm 46:10, NIV)

第六篇：当代信徒如何在忙碌中守住“灵魂的空间”？



“在嘈杂时代，为神保留安静之地”

如果你问我，这个时代最大的危机是什么？

不是经济压力，不是就业竞争，也不只是社会变动。

而是人越来越没有“灵魂的空间”。

我们拥有 Wi-Fi、5G、云端储存、智能手机和无限刷屏的时间，却没有空间听见自己的心；没有空间与神对话；没有空间感受生命正在流失；甚至没有空间意识到自己正在失去空间。

有人说：“不是我不想安静，是我没有时间。”

但真相往往不是没有时间，而是心被挤满了。

忙碌不只是一种节奏，更是一种心态。如果心一直被外界牵动，就算人坐下来，灵魂依旧慌乱。若心里有空间，即使生活很忙，仍能感受神的同在。

在一个被速度、压力、资讯和焦虑填满的时代，问题不再只是“你忙不忙”，而是：

你还能不能让灵魂有空间？

一、我们为什么正在失去灵魂空间

因为我们活在一个永远在线的时代。

手机填满了所有碎片时间。等红灯十秒钟，也要刷一下；排队一分钟，也要刷一下。灵魂没有空隙，它被填满了。

工作流入生活，生活渗入工作。人回到家以后，依然在线，依然被寻找，依然被吩咐，这并不是真正的休息。

情绪也被信息不断打扰。打开手机，就进入别人的情绪风暴：愤怒、焦虑、对立、八卦、争论。你的心无形中被拖着走。

心又被无数“要做的事情”压得喘不过气：任务、消息、回复、群聊、作业、工作流程、家务。心里像一个没有关掉的浏览器，开着二十九个标签页，却一个也处理不完。

更严重的是，灵命被现实挤到角落。祷告变得仓促，灵修变得可有可无，读经变成“等我不忙再说”，教会也成了可以随时跳过的选项。

我们如此忙碌，以至于连停下来面对神的勇气都快要失去。

二、什么是灵魂空间

灵魂空间不是把手机关机，不是离开人群，不是去深山修行，也不是逼自己什么都不做。

灵魂空间是一种内在状态：

当你不急，心就能听见神。

当你不慌，心就能看见自己。

当你不再被推着走，才有自由去选择。

灵魂空间不是环境，而是心里面为神留下的位置。

那是一个让神说话、让心复原、让生命呼吸的地方。

三、在忙碌中守住灵魂空间

第一，先灵魂，后生活。

每天至少留出十分钟，关掉手机，把心从世界收回来。

你可以向神说一句最真实的话，可以安静呼吸，可以坐着，可以打开一篇诗篇，也可以只是把自己交给神。

这十分钟不是浪费时间，而是救命的时间。

十分钟未必立刻改变你的生活，却可能先改变你的心。

第二，练习节奏灵修。

忙碌的人最需要的不是更多热情，而是稳定节奏。

每天固定一段祷告，中午有十秒钟的停顿，晚上有一个小小的感恩；每周有一次家庭敬拜，主日分别为圣。

灵魂需要规律，就像心脏需要节拍。

不必多，但要稳。稳定的节奏，比一次性的热情更能守住灵魂。

第三，创造“无意义”的时刻。

我们这一代人太功利了：看书要增值，出门要高效，休息要有成果，甚至灵修都想立刻有感觉。

但灵魂需要一些无功利、无要求、无压力的时刻。

静静坐着，看一片叶子，听水声，喝一杯茶，和家人散步，什么也不做。

为什么重要？

因为灵魂不是机器。它需要呼吸，而不只是被使用。

第四，刻意减速。

世界的速度会让人迷失，神的速度却常常是安静、稳定、温柔的。

减速可以很具体：不急着把所有事情马上做完；刻意慢慢吃饭；散步时不看手机；不在每一次沉默中寻找刺激；给自己多三秒钟回应别人。

减速不是浪费时间，而是让灵魂重新成为主人。

第五，用属灵过滤器保护你的心。

你的灵魂不是垃圾桶。

每天都要过滤不必要的资讯、争吵的对话、让你焦虑的消息、让你愤怒的短视频、让你不断比较的动态。

你需要问：“这件事会让我更像基督吗？”

如果不会，就不要让它继续占据你的心。

灵魂空间不是靠找到更多时间，而是靠删掉许多杂音。

第六，向神交托。

这个时代最大的忙碌，常常来自内心的声音：我必须做得更好，我不能失败，我得撑住，我不能拖累别人，我必须完美，我必须负责所有。

但你不是神。

你的生命不是靠能力维持，而是靠恩典托住。

诗篇说：

“你们要休息，要知道我是神。”（诗篇 46:10，和合本）

安静的意思不是没有声音，而是你允许神当神，也停止把自己当神。

当你放下掌控，灵魂的空间就打开了。

四、有空间的灵魂会怎样改变

你会变得更稳定，更平静，更有力量，更敏锐，更有爱，也更能听见神的声音。

你会更能面对压力，也更能祝福别人。

因为一个有灵魂空间的信徒，不会被世界推动，而是被神引领。

五、结语：愿你的灵魂有空间，让神可以进来

这个时代最难的不是忙，而是忙到没有自己，没有神，也没有灵魂。

请记住：灵魂空间不会自然出现，它是你必须主动守住的圣地。

愿你在忙碌里仍然保持柔软的心、安静的灵、清晰的方向、稳定的脚步，以及与神同行的节奏。

愿你在嘈杂的世界里，成为一个内心有空间、灵魂能呼吸、生命能发光的人。

因为灵魂一旦有空间，神的声音就能再次被听见。



Guarding Space for the Soul in a Busy Age Making Room for God in a Noisy World

If you asked me what the greatest crisis of this age is, I would not first say economic pressure, job competition, or social change.

I would say this: people are losing space in their souls.

We have Wi-Fi, 5G, cloud storage, smartphones, and endless time for scrolling. Yet we have little room to hear our own hearts, little room to speak with God, little room to notice life slipping

away, and sometimes not even enough room to realize that we are losing room.

Some people say, “It is not that I do not want to be still. I simply do not have time.”

But the truth is often not that we have no time. It is that our hearts are crowded.

Busyness is not only a schedule. It is a condition of the heart. If the heart is constantly pulled by the outside world, the soul remains restless even when the body sits down. But if the heart has space, a person can still sense God's presence even in a busy life.

In an age filled with speed, pressure, information, and anxiety, the question is no longer simply, “Are you busy?”

The deeper question is this:

Can your soul still breathe?

1. Why We Are Losing Space for the Soul

We live in an always-online age.

Our phones fill every fragment of time. Ten seconds at a red light, and we check the screen. One minute in line, and we scroll again. The soul has no open space. It is constantly filled.

Work flows into life, and life leaks into work. Even after coming home, many people remain online, available, and responsive.

That is not true rest.

Our emotions are also constantly disturbed by information. The moment we open our phones, we enter other people's emotional storms: anger, anxiety, conflict, gossip, argument. Our hearts are dragged along without realizing it.

The heart is also pressed down by endless tasks: messages, replies, group chats, assignments, workflows, housework. The mind becomes like a browser with twenty-nine tabs open and none of them completed.

Most seriously, spiritual life gets pushed into a corner. Prayer becomes hurried. Devotion becomes optional. Scripture reading becomes “when I am less busy.” Church becomes something that can be skipped at any time.

We are so busy that we are losing the courage to stop before God.

2. What Is Space for the Soul?

Space for the soul is not simply turning off the phone, leaving people, going into the mountains, or forcing yourself to be less busy.

It is an inner condition.

When you are not rushed, your heart can hear God.

When you are not panicked, your heart can see itself.

When you are not being pushed along, you are free to choose.

Space for the soul is not mainly about environment. It is about making room within the heart for God.

It is the place where God can speak, the heart can recover, and life can breathe again.

3. How to Guard Space for the Soul in a Busy Life

First, put the soul before the schedule.

Set aside at least ten minutes a day. Turn off your phone and bring your heart back from the world.

You may say one honest sentence to God. You may breathe. You may sit quietly. You may open a psalm. You may simply place yourself before God.

These ten minutes are not wasted time. They are life-saving time.

Ten minutes may not change your whole life immediately, but they can begin to change your heart.

Second, practice rhythmic devotion.

Busy people do not need only more passion. They need a stable rhythm.

A short prayer in the morning. Ten seconds of pause at noon. A small thanksgiving at night. Family worship once a week. Sunday set apart for worship.

The soul needs rhythm, just as the heart needs a beat.

It does not have to be much, but it needs to be steady. A stable rhythm protects the soul better than a moment of intense enthusiasm.

Third, create “unproductive” moments.

Our generation is deeply utilitarian. Reading must improve us. Going out must be efficient. Rest must produce results. Even devotion is expected to produce immediate feeling.

But the soul needs moments without pressure, demand, or usefulness.

Sit quietly. Watch a leaf. Listen to water. Drink a cup of tea.

Walk with your family. Do nothing.

Why does this matter?

Because the soul is not a machine. It needs to breathe, not merely to be used.

Fourth, intentionally slow down.

The speed of the world can make people lose their way. God's pace is often quiet, steady, and gentle.

Slowing down can be very practical: do not rush to finish everything immediately; eat slowly; walk without looking at your phone; do not fill every silence with stimulation; give yourself three extra seconds before responding.

Slowing down is not wasting time. It is letting the soul become master again.

Fifth, protect your heart with a spiritual filter.

Your soul is not a trash can.

Each day, you need to filter unnecessary information, combative conversations, anxiety-producing news, anger-inducing videos, and social media that pulls you into comparison.

Ask yourself, "Will this make me more like Christ?"

If not, do not let it keep occupying your heart.

Space for the soul does not come only from finding more time. It also comes from removing unnecessary noise.

Sixth, entrust yourself to God.

Much of modern busyness comes from inner pressure: I must do better. I cannot fail. I must hold everything together. I cannot burden others. I must be perfect. I must be responsible for everything.

But you are not God.

Your life is not sustained by your ability. It is held by grace.

The psalm says:

“Be still, and know that I am God.”

(Psalm 46:10, NIV)

Stillness does not mean the absence of sound. It means allowing God to be God and stopping the attempt to be God yourself.

When you release control, space opens in the soul.

4. What Happens When the Soul Has Space?

You become more stable, peaceful, strong, sensitive, loving, and able to hear God's voice.

You become more able to face pressure and more able to bless others.

A believer with space in the soul is not driven by the world. Such a person is led by God.

5. Conclusion: May Your Soul Have Room for God

The hardest thing in this age is not busyness itself. It is becoming so busy that we lose ourselves, lose God, and lose our souls.

Remember this: space for the soul will not appear by accident. It is sacred ground that must be guarded.

May you keep a tender heart, a quiet spirit, a clear direction, steady steps, and a rhythm of walking with God even in a busy life.

May you become a person whose heart has room, whose soul can breathe, and whose life can shine in a noisy world.

When the soul has space, the voice of God can be heard again.

第七篇：如何让你的家庭成为一个“情绪健康的属灵共同体”？



“让家不只是住处，更成为灵魂被修复的地方”

在这个时代，很多人都有一个共同的感叹：

“家里最容易发生情绪爆炸。”

外面一整天都彬彬有礼、客气周到；但一回到家，情绪就像没有拴住的马，随时冲出来。

因为家，是人最放松、也最不设防的地方。

我们在外面控制情绪，在家里释放情绪；我们对外人客气，却对最亲的人发火；我们面对陌生人很温柔，面对家人却很暴躁。

家庭本该是安全的港湾，但在许多家中，却常常成为情绪的战场。

然而，圣经从头到尾都在提醒我们：家庭是信仰最真实的战场，也是门徒训练最重要的场所。

如果一个人的信仰不能在家中落地，那么他的信仰就还没有真正扎根。

所以问题来了：在一个高度情绪化的时代，我们如何让家庭成为一个情绪健康的属灵共同体？

不是气氛紧绷的地方，不是冲突不断的地方，而是灵魂被修复的地方，一个真正的家。

一、为什么家庭最需要情绪健康

因为家里的情绪氛围，会决定孩子的安全感、夫妻关系的韧性、家庭的属灵传承，以及这个家里是否有基督的香气。

我们常以为灵命成长发生在教会、查经班和小组里。其实最决定性的场所常常是餐桌、卧室、客厅、车里、厨房、争吵之后、哭泣之中。

家庭情绪不健康，会产生冷暴力、情感退缩、亲子疏离、压抑的气氛、表达的恐惧、隐藏的怨恨，也会让属灵生活停滞。

家庭情绪健康，则会带来安全、信任、透明、倾听、祝福、彼此扶持和共同成长。

家庭的情绪，就是灵魂的空气。

空气品质，决定生命质量。

二、什么是情绪健康的属灵共同体

它不是从来不吵架的家庭，不是所有人都完美的家庭，也不是永远和气、没有冲突的家庭。

那不真实，也不是圣经呈现的人生图画。

情绪健康的属灵家庭，是这样的：

情绪可以被看见，而不是被压抑。每个人都能诚实表达感受，而不担心被嘲笑或否定。

冲突可以被面对，而不是被掩盖。吵架不是关系的结束，而是沟通的起点。

软弱可以被承认，而不是被藏起来。家应当是最安全承认软弱的地方。

破口可以被修复，而不是带着十年不处理。有冲突，却不积怨。

每个人都被尊重。不是孩子被控制、妻子被压制、丈夫被忽略，而是彼此建立。

神是家里的中心，而不是墙上的装饰。祷告不是形式，而是关系。

这样的家，才是属灵共同体，而不是宗教展示的场所。

三、建立情绪健康家庭的六条路

第一，创造情绪安全空间：家不是法庭，而是避风港。
家里最容易发生的错误，是情绪还没有表达，就先被审判。

孩子说：“我很难过。”父母回答：“你想太多了。”

妻子说：“我感到孤单。”丈夫回答：“你不要这么敏感。”

丈夫说：“我压力很大。”妻子回答：“别人也很辛苦啊。”

这种回应不是安慰，而是封口。

情绪健康的家庭会说：“谢谢你愿意告诉我。”“我了解你的感受。”“你能告诉我更具体一点吗？”“我在这里陪你。”

安全感来自被理解，而不是被说服。

属灵家庭从理解开始，而不是从讲道开始。

第二，学会健康沟通：不是发泄情绪，而是表达自己。

沟通有三个层次。

第一层是表达事件：“你今天回来晚了。”

第二层是表达情绪：“我很担心。”

第三层是表达需要：“我需要知道你平安，我需要安心。”

情绪健康从第三层开始。许多家庭只停在第一层或第二层，所以越沟通越累。

耶稣与人的对话，常常触摸人的真实需要，而不只是处理表面的事件。

家庭也需要这样的沟通。

第三，练习家庭祷告：让神进入家庭的情绪生活。

很多家庭祷告停留在“求主赐福我们今天顺利”“求主看顾我们”“求主赐我们平安”。

这些当然可以祷告，但情绪健康的家庭祷告还可以更真实：

“主啊，我们今天有些冲突，求祢医治。”

“主啊，孩子很紧张，求祢给他力量。”

“主啊，我和妻子今天误解彼此，求祢帮助我们重新靠近。”

“主啊，我们的心需要祢。”

祷告不是宗教仪式，而是家庭情绪被神重塑的过程。

一个会祷告的家庭，不会破碎太久。

第四，让孩子看到真实的父母，而不是完美的父母。

情绪不健康的家庭常常假装没问题、彼此冷战、把冲突藏起来、对孩子隐瞒真实。

但孩子并不迟钝。他们心里真正的问题是：为什么我们不能诚实？

情绪健康的家庭会说：“爸爸刚刚很生气，但我正在学习更好地表达。”“妈妈今天很累，需要一点空间。”“我们吵架了，但我们仍然彼此相爱。”“我们一起祷告，请求神帮助我们。”

孩子不是被完美的父母影响，而是被真实又倚靠神的父母影响。

第五，练习和好文化：让道歉与宽恕成为家庭节奏。

家庭不是没有冲突，而是有没有能力修复冲突。

道歉可以有五步：承认、承担、理解、改变、请求宽恕。

“我刚才的语气不对。”

“这影响了你，我很抱歉。”

“你一定很难受。”

“我会努力更好地表达。”

“你愿意原谅我吗？”

宽恕也需要学习：我愿意放下；我不再抓住过去；我们一起往前走。

家庭里的和好，是很美的敬拜。

第六，建立家庭属灵节奏：让神成为家庭的空气。

情绪健康离不开属灵节奏：每日短祷告，每周家庭敬拜，家庭经文分享，一起服事，一起感恩，一起面对困难，一起等候神的带领。

这些不是额外的属灵任务，而是家庭的生命线。

一个家庭若一起行在神面前，他们的心就不容易各奔东西。

四、家庭情绪健康，是教会复兴的根基

复兴不只是从讲台开始，也常常从餐桌开始。

复兴不只是更大的聚会、更强的讲道、更多的活动；复兴也是家庭恢复温度，人能在家中经历神，亲密关系被医治，孩子从小认识爱，婚姻成为福音的见证。

一个国家灵魂的健康，取决于家庭；教会属灵的高度，也取决于家庭的深度。

当家庭成为情绪健康的属灵共同体，教会自然拥有复兴的土壤。

五、结语：让家成为一块圣地

家庭并不完美，但它可以被神更新。我们也不完美，但我们可以学习成为成熟的人。

愿你的家庭成为一个可以哭、可以笑、可以说真话、可以承认软弱、可以被原谅、可以一起祷告、可以因神重新连在一起的地方。

愿你的家成为情绪健康的属灵共同体。

愿神的平安，从你的家里开始扩散。



Making the Home an Emotionally Healthy Spiritual Community

Letting the Home Become a Place Where Souls Are Restored

Many people in our time share the same experience:

“Home is where emotional explosions happen most easily.”

All day long, people may be polite, controlled, and considerate outside the home. But once they return home, emotions can run loose like an untied horse.

Home is where people are most relaxed and least guarded.

We control our emotions outside and release them at home. We are courteous to strangers and harsh with those closest to us. We may be gentle with outsiders and irritable with family.

The home should be a safe harbor, yet in many families it becomes an emotional battlefield.

Scripture reminds us again and again that the family is one of the most real battlegrounds of faith and one of the most important places of discipleship.

If faith cannot take root at home, it has not truly taken root.
So the question is: in a highly emotional age, how can the family become an emotionally healthy spiritual community?
Not a place of constant tension. Not a place of endless conflict.
But a place where souls are restored. A true home.

1. Why the Family Needs Emotional Health

The emotional atmosphere of the home shapes a child's sense of safety, the resilience of marriage, the spiritual inheritance of the family, and whether the fragrance of Christ can be sensed in the home.

We often assume spiritual growth happens mainly in church, Bible studies, and small groups. But often the most decisive places are the dining table, the bedroom, the living room, the car, the kitchen, after an argument, and in the middle of tears.

When the emotional life of a family is unhealthy, it produces cold silence, emotional withdrawal, distance between parents and children, oppressive atmosphere, fear of expression, hidden resentment, and spiritual stagnation.

When the emotional life of a family is healthy, it produces safety, trust, transparency, listening, blessing, mutual support, and shared growth.

The emotions of a family are the air of the soul.

The quality of that air shapes the quality of life.

2. What Is an Emotionally Healthy Spiritual Community?

It is not a family that never argues. It is not a family where everyone is perfect. It is not a family where everything is always peaceful and conflict never appears.

That is not real life, and it is not the picture Scripture gives us of human life.

An emotionally healthy spiritual family looks like this:

Emotions can be seen rather than suppressed. Each person can honestly express feelings without fear of ridicule or denial.

Conflict can be faced rather than covered. An argument is not the end of relationship, but the beginning of communication.

Weakness can be admitted rather than hidden. Home should be the safest place to confess weakness.

Broken places can be repaired rather than carried for years.

Conflict may happen, but resentment is not allowed to take root.

Each person is respected. Children are not merely controlled, wives are not suppressed, husbands are not ignored, and everyone is built up.

God is the center of the home, not a decoration on the wall.

Prayer is not a formality. It is relationship.

Only then does the home become a spiritual community rather than a religious display.

3. Six Ways to Build an Emotionally Healthy Home

First, create emotional safety. Home is not a courtroom. It is a shelter.

One common mistake at home is judging emotions before they are expressed.

A child says, "I feel sad." A parent replies, "You are overthinking."

A wife says, "I feel lonely." A husband replies, "Do not be so sensitive."

A husband says, "I feel stressed." A wife replies, "Everyone else is tired too."

These responses do not comfort. They silence.

An emotionally healthy family learns to say, "Thank you for telling me." "I want to understand how you feel." "Can you tell me more?" "I am here with you."

Safety comes from being understood, not merely from being corrected.

A spiritual home begins with understanding, not with preaching.

Second, learn healthy communication. Do not merely express emotion. Express yourself.

There are three levels of communication.

The first level expresses the event: "You came home late today."

The second level expresses emotion: "I was worried."

The third level expresses need: “I need to know you are safe. I need reassurance.”

Emotional health begins at the third level. Many families remain at the first or second level, which is why communication becomes exhausting.

Jesus often touched the deep needs of people, not merely the surface events.

Families need this kind of communication too.

Third, practice family prayer. Let God enter the emotional life of the home.

Many family prayers remain at the level of “Lord, bless our day,”

“Lord, watch over us,” or “Lord, give us peace.”

These prayers are good, but emotionally healthy families can pray more honestly:

“Lord, we had conflict today. Please heal us.”

“Lord, our child is anxious. Give strength.”

“Lord, my spouse and I misunderstood each other. Help us draw near again.”

“Lord, our hearts need You.”

Prayer is not a religious ritual. It is the process by which family emotions are reshaped by God.

A family that knows how to pray will not remain broken for long.

Fourth, let children see real parents, not perfect parents.

Emotionally unhealthy families often pretend everything is fine, give each other the silent treatment, hide conflict, and conceal reality from children.

But children are not unaware. Their deeper question is: Why can we not be honest?

An emotionally healthy family can say, “Dad was angry just now, but I am learning to express myself better.” “Mom is tired today and needs a little space.” “We argued, but we still love each other.” “Let us pray together and ask God to help us.”

Children are not shaped most deeply by perfect parents. They are shaped by real parents who depend on God.

Fifth, practice a culture of reconciliation. Let apology and forgiveness become a family rhythm.

The issue is not whether a family has conflict. The issue is whether the family can repair conflict.

An apology may include five steps: acknowledge, take responsibility, understand, change, and ask for forgiveness.

“My tone was wrong.”

“It hurt you, and I am sorry.”

“That must have been painful for you.”

“I will work on expressing myself better.”

“Will you forgive me?”

Forgiveness also has to be learned: I am willing to release this. I will not keep holding the past against you. We will move forward together.

Reconciliation in the home is a beautiful form of worship.

Sixth, build a spiritual rhythm at home. Let God become the air of the family.

Emotional health needs spiritual rhythm: short daily prayer, weekly family worship, Scripture sharing, serving together, giving thanks together, facing difficulty together, and waiting for God's leading together.

These are not extra spiritual tasks. They are the lifeline of the family.

When a family walks together before God, their hearts are less likely to scatter in different directions.

4. Emotional Health in the Family Is the Soil of Church Renewal
Renewal does not begin only from the pulpit. It often begins around the table.

Renewal is not only bigger meetings, stronger sermons, or more programs. Renewal is also warmth returning to the family, people experiencing God at home, intimate relationships being healed, children learning love from a young age, and marriage becoming a witness to the gospel.

The health of a nation's soul depends on the family. The spiritual height of the church also depends on the depth of the family.

When families become emotionally healthy spiritual communities, the church has soil in which renewal can grow.

5. Conclusion: Let the Home Become Holy Ground

The family is not perfect, but it can be renewed by God. We are not perfect, but we can learn to become mature people.

May your home become a place where people can cry, laugh, tell the truth, admit weakness, receive forgiveness, pray together, and be joined together again by God.

May your home become an emotionally healthy spiritual community.

May the peace of God begin to spread from your home.

第八篇：如何在情绪世代成为一个情绪成熟的信徒？



“让情绪被看见，也让情绪被真理更新”

我们正在进入一个情绪成为社会主导力量的时代。

人越来越容易被一句话激怒，被一条消息击垮，被一个眼神触发，被一件小事困住。

我们活在一个高度敏感、容易爆炸、普遍焦虑的社会。有些人把这样的时代称为“情绪世代”。

这个时代最大的挑战，不只是知识，不只是资源，也不只是能力，而是情绪成熟度。

一个人若没有成熟的情绪，就很难拥有成熟的人生；一个信徒若不会处理情绪，也很难拥有成熟的信仰。

情绪不成熟，会让信仰变成几种扭曲的样子：用情绪代替真理，以为哭了就是被感动，有感觉才算属灵；用情绪代替信心，顺利时相信，逆境中怀疑；用情绪代替关系，开心时靠近教会，不开心时就离开。

因此，情绪成熟不只是心理学问题，也是属灵生命成长的问题。

一、为什么现代信徒需要情绪成熟

因为情绪不成熟会直接影响信仰的稳定性。

情绪不成熟的人，今天觉得神很爱我，明天又觉得神离弃我；今天想服事，明天就想放弃；今天信心满满，明天就怀疑人生。

这样的信仰，很容易被情绪绑架。

情绪不成熟也会影响关系的健康。

人会容易误解别人，容易被冒犯，过度敏感，把情绪当真相，也容易在教会里制造隐性的冲突。

于是越爱越累，越靠近越痛。

情绪不成熟还会影响服事的持久度。

一个情绪不成熟的服事者，可能太在意别人的眼光，太容易失落，太容易灰心，太容易疲倦，也太容易觉得“不被理解”。

他可能爱主，但撑不久。

二、什么是情绪成熟的信徒

情绪成熟并不是不生气、不忧伤、不难过、不害怕。

那是石头，不是人。

情绪成熟的标志是：情绪不是主人，而是被带到神面前，被整合，被更新。

一个情绪成熟的信徒，可以有情绪，但不会被情绪牵着跑；会受伤，但不会反击伤害别人；会哭泣，但不会绝望；会害怕，但仍选择相信；会软弱，但知道到哪里寻求力量。

他会聆听自己的情绪，但不会让情绪当主人。

三、圣经中的情绪成熟榜样

如果问圣经中谁最能帮助我们理解情绪成熟，答案也许不是保罗，也不是彼得，而是大卫。

因为诗篇不是冷冰冰的信条，而是完整的人类情绪。

大卫一生经历恐惧、愤怒、沮丧、背叛、孤独和悲伤。

但他没有把情绪变成单纯的抱怨，而是把情绪带到神面前，化成祷告。

诗篇是情绪如何成为敬拜的范本。

这就是成熟的情绪生命。

四、在情绪世代成为成熟信徒的六条路

第一，觉察情绪：认识它，而不是否认它。

情绪不成熟的人，第一反应常常是忍住、压下、装没事，甚至假装很属灵。

但属灵成熟不是压住情绪，而是认识情绪。

你可以问自己：我现在真正的感受是什么？我在害怕什么？我在失望什么？我在期待什么？我被什么触发了？

情绪被看见，才不会反扑。

第二，诠释情绪：情绪是真实的，但不等于事实。

许多人跌倒，不是因为情绪本身，而是因为误以为情绪就是现实。

“我觉得没人爱我”，不等于真的没人爱你。

“我觉得神沉默”，不等于神离开你。

“我觉得自己没有价值”，不等于你真的没有价值。

成熟的信徒知道：情绪是信号，不是审判；情绪是信息，不是真相。

第三，转向神：把情绪带到神面前，而不是丢给别人。

情绪不成熟的人，容易随时爆发，把压力丢给配偶、孩子、弟兄姊妹，甚至用情绪控制别人。

情绪成熟的人却学习：把情绪带到神那里，而不是带到别人身上。

这就是诗篇的智慧。

第四，练习情绪祷告：把情绪化成敬拜。

情绪祷告可以分三步。

第一步，真实表达：“主啊，我现在很痛、很怒、很害怕、很孤单。”

第二步，让真理介入：“主啊，求祢帮助我看见祢的同在。”

第三步，把心交托：“主啊，我把我的心交给祢。”

这是情绪成熟的灵魂运动。

第五，带着情绪行动：不让情绪决定该做什么。

情绪不成熟的人会说：“我今天心情不好，所以不祷告。”“我今天没有感觉，所以不敬拜。”“我今天很烦，所以不去教会。”

成熟的信徒却学习：我带着情绪依然敬拜，带着疲惫依然祷告，带着伤口依然跟随神。

这不是虚伪，这是坚强。

第六，建立稳固的内在生命：让真理成为情绪的锚。

情绪真正的医治，来自每日与神同行、固定灵修、稳定生活规律、安静祷告的空间、群体中的支持、属灵长辈的同行，以及在真理里扎根。

情绪成熟不是一夜之间的改变，而是灵魂缓慢而扎实的更新。

五、情绪成熟的信徒能给时代带来什么

他会成为家庭里的稳定者，不再是情绪的火药桶，而是和平的源头。

他会成为教会里的和平者，不被情绪左右，也不被冲突牵动。

他会成为工作场所的安静力量：别人慌，他稳；别人怒，他静。

他也会成为时代中的见证人，在混乱中活出清晰，在焦虑中活出平安。

情绪成熟的信徒，会成为这个时代宝贵的光。

六、结语：愿你的心成为稳稳的心

这个时代会越来越情绪化，但信徒可以越来越成熟。

愿你成为一个有情绪却不被情绪控制的人，会哭泣却不失盼望的人，会软弱却不放弃跟随的人，会受伤却不停止爱的人，会挣扎却不丢弃信心的人。

愿你的灵魂不因时代的情绪洪流而漂泊，而是在基督里扎下安静而坚定的根。

因为情绪成熟，不只是心理技巧，而是生命扎根在永恒里的结果。



Becoming Emotionally Mature in an Emotional Age
Letting Emotions Be Seen and Renewed by Truth

We are entering an age in which emotion has become one of the dominant forces in society.

People are more easily angered by a sentence, shaken by a message, triggered by a glance, or trapped by a small incident.

We live in a highly sensitive, easily reactive, widely anxious society. Some have called this the emotional age.

The greatest challenge of this age is not only knowledge, resources, or ability. It is emotional maturity.

Without emotional maturity, a person will struggle to live a mature life. Without the ability to handle emotions, a believer will struggle to live a mature faith.

Emotional immaturity can distort faith in several ways. It replaces truth with emotion, as if tears automatically mean spiritual movement and feelings define spirituality. It replaces faith with emotion, believing when life goes smoothly and doubting when hardship comes. It replaces relationship with emotion, drawing close to the church when happy and leaving when disappointed.

For this reason, emotional maturity is not merely a psychological issue. It is a matter of spiritual formation.

1. Why Modern Believers Need Emotional Maturity

Emotional immaturity directly affects the stability of faith.

An emotionally immature person may feel loved by God today and abandoned by God tomorrow; eager to serve today and ready to quit tomorrow; full of faith today and full of doubt tomorrow.

Such faith is easily kidnapped by emotion.

Emotional immaturity also affects the health of relationships.

It makes people more likely to misunderstand others, feel offended, become oversensitive, treat emotion as truth, and create hidden conflict in the church.

The more people love, the more exhausted they become. The closer people get, the more pain they feel.

Emotional immaturity also affects the endurance of ministry.

An emotionally immature servant may care too much about how others see him, become easily disappointed, lose heart quickly, grow tired easily, and often feel misunderstood.

Such a person may love the Lord, but may not last long.

2. What Is an Emotionally Mature Believer?

Emotional maturity does not mean never being angry, sad, hurt, or afraid.

That would be a stone, not a human being.

The mark of emotional maturity is this: emotions are not the master. They are brought before God to be integrated and renewed.

An emotionally mature believer has emotions but is not driven by them. Such a person can be wounded without striking back, weep without falling into despair, feel afraid and still choose trust, feel weak and know where to seek strength.

An emotionally mature believer listens to emotions, but does not allow them to rule.

3. A Biblical Picture of Emotional Maturity

If we ask who in Scripture helps us understand emotional maturity, the answer may not first be Paul or Peter, but David. Why?

Because the Psalms are not cold statements of doctrine. They are the full range of human emotion.

David experienced fear, anger, discouragement, betrayal, loneliness, and grief.

Yet he did not turn emotion into mere complaint. He brought emotion before God and turned it into prayer.

The Psalms show us how emotion can become worship.

This is mature emotional life.

4. Six Ways to Become Emotionally Mature in an Emotional Age

First, notice your emotions. Know them rather than deny them.

The first reaction of an emotionally immature person is often to suppress, bury, pretend, or act spiritual.

But spiritual maturity is not the denial of emotion. It is the recognition of emotion.

Ask yourself: What am I truly feeling? What am I afraid of? What am I disappointed about? What am I expecting? What has triggered me?

When emotions are seen, they are less likely to strike back.

Second, interpret your emotions. Emotions are real, but they are not always facts.

Many people stumble not because they have emotions, but because they assume emotions are reality.

“I feel unloved” does not mean no one loves you.

“I feel God is silent” does not mean God has left you.

“I feel worthless” does not mean you have no worth.

A mature believer knows that emotion is a signal, not a verdict.

It is information, not ultimate truth.

Third, turn to God. Bring emotions before Him instead of throwing them onto others.

Emotionally immature people easily explode, leak emotions everywhere, dump pressure onto spouses, children, or brothers and sisters, and sometimes use emotion to control others.

Emotionally mature people learn to bring emotions to God rather than place them on other people.

This is the wisdom of the Psalms.

Fourth, practice emotional prayer. Turn emotion into worship.

Emotional prayer can move in three steps.

First, express honestly: “Lord, I am in pain. I am angry. I am afraid. I feel alone.”

Second, invite truth: “Lord, help me see Your presence.”

Third, surrender the heart: “Lord, I give my heart to You.”

This is the movement of an emotionally mature soul.

Fifth, act with emotion present. Do not let emotion decide what you will do.

Emotionally immature people say, “I am in a bad mood today, so I will not pray.” “I do not feel anything today, so I will not worship.” “I am irritated today, so I will not go to church.”

Mature believers learn to worship with emotion present, pray while tired, and follow God while wounded.

This is not hypocrisy. It is strength.

Sixth, build a steady inner life. Let truth become the anchor of emotion.

True emotional healing comes through daily walking with God, regular devotion, stable rhythms of life, quiet space for prayer, support within community, spiritual mentors, and deep roots in truth.

Emotional maturity does not happen overnight. It is the slow and solid renewal of the soul.

5. What Emotionally Mature Believers Bring to the Age

They become stabilizing people in the family, no longer emotional explosives but sources of peace.

They become peacemakers in the church, not controlled by emotion or pulled by conflict.

They become quiet strength in the workplace. When others panic, they remain steady. When others rage, they remain calm.

They become witnesses in the age, living with clarity in confusion and peace in anxiety.

Emotionally mature believers become precious lights in this generation.

6. Conclusion: May Your Heart Become Steady

This age may become increasingly emotional, but believers can become increasingly mature.

May you become a person who has emotions but is not controlled by them; who weeps but does not lose hope; who is weak but does not stop following; who is wounded but does not stop loving; who struggles but does not abandon faith.

May your soul not drift in the emotional flood of this age. May it put down quiet and steady roots in Christ.

Emotional maturity is not merely a psychological technique. It is the result of a life rooted in eternity.

第九篇：灵魂的复原力



“一个信徒如何在苦难中变得更坚强”

每个人的一生都会遇见苦难：疾病、压力、误解、失败、关系破裂、沮丧、焦虑、意外、动荡。

没有人能完全避免。

但奇妙的是，苦难并不会“平均打击”所有人。有些人在苦难中被击垮，久久难以恢复；有些人却在苦难中变得更成熟、更敏锐、更有智慧、更有力量。

这种差别，来自一种重要的品质：

复原力。

复原力，是灵魂被击打之后重新站起来的能力。它不是单纯的性格，不只是意志力，也不是盲目的乐观主义，而是一种内里被神扶持的力量。

一个信徒若拥有复原力，无论苦难多深，都不会被永久击败。

一、为什么信徒需要复原力

因为我们所处的世界没有绝对安全、绝对顺利、绝对稳定，也没有绝对完整。

主耶稣从未应许我们可以绕过一切苦难，祂却应许我们：

“在世上你们有苦难；但你们可以放心，我已经胜了世界。”（约翰福音 16:33，和合本）

这节经文，正是信徒复原力的神学基础：苦难是真实的，但信徒仍可以站起来，因为基督已经胜了世界。

复原力越深，信徒就越能面对痛苦，经历破碎，在跌倒后再走一步，在眼泪中不放弃，在失望中仍有盼望。

复原力不是让你不痛，而是让你不被痛吞没。

二、苦难为什么击垮一些人，却塑造另一些人

心理学提醒我们：苦难不会自动塑造人，苦难只会放大一个人的内在结构。

若一个人的内在比较强壮，苦难可能塑造他；若一个人的内在极其脆弱，苦难就容易压碎他。

而属灵生命给我们一个更深的答案：人真正的复原力，不是来自自我强大，而是来自神在他里面的扶持。

决定信徒复原力的，不只是环境，而是根基。

若根基在成功，一失败就倒。

若根基在人际关系，一破裂就崩。

若根基在健康，一生病就慌。

若根基在金钱，一失业就乱。

但若根基在基督，即使世界摇动，灵魂仍能站立。

三、信徒的复原力从哪里来

第一，来自神的同在。

诗篇 23 篇不是理论，而是现实：

“我虽然行过死荫的幽谷，也不怕遭害，因为你与我同在。”（诗篇 23:4，和合本）

当你知道自己不是独自面对苦难，苦难就不能完全摧毁你。神的同在，是复原力最深的支撑。

第二，来自神的应许。

没有盼望的人，苦难是一堵墙；有盼望的人，苦难可能成为一扇门。

苦难不会是信徒故事的结局，神的应许才是。

第三，来自神的恩典。

恩典意味着：你可以软弱，可以哭，可以不完美，可以跌倒，也可以慢慢来。

恩典是复原力的空气。没有恩典，人很难真正恢复。

第四，来自共同体的支持。

一个孤单的信徒是脆弱的；一个在群体中的信徒更容易坚韧。

复原力不只属于个人，它也来自关系。

第五，来自生命的意义。

罗马书 5 章告诉我们一个属灵链条：患难生忍耐，忍耐生老练，老练生盼望。

苦难不是毁灭信徒的工具，也可以成为塑造信徒的炉火。

四、如何培养灵魂的复原力

第一，真实面对痛苦，而不是逃避。

逃避不能治愈，只会让伤口更深。复原力从承认开始：“我痛，我累，我需要帮助。神，我需要祢。”

坦诚，是坚强的第一步。

第二，练习情绪祷告。

诗篇不是镇静剂，而是情绪的出口。

你可以对神说：“我害怕，我愤怒，我迷茫，我孤单，我不理解，我需要祢。”

把情绪压下，是脆弱；把情绪交给神，是成熟。

第三，建立稳固的生活节奏。

复原力更多来自节奏，而不是一时的意志。固定的祷告、休息、家庭时光、运动和反思，会慢慢把灵魂重新扶稳。

没有节奏的人，很难稳定。

第四，在苦难中寻找有意义的解释。

很多人被苦难击倒，是因为一直问：“为什么是我？为什么现在？为什么这么痛？”

复原力来自另一种问题：“神要我学什么？神正在塑造什么？神要我变成谁？”

意义越深，复原力越强。

第五，学会寻求帮助。

寻求属灵的、专业的、关系中的帮助，不是软弱，而是智慧。

你的复原力不是一个人的力量，而是神与人一起托住你的力量。

第六，让痛苦成为祝福他人的能力。

最深的复原力，是转化。

当你的伤口成为别人得医治的见证，你就真正变得坚强。

五、复原力不是变强，而是被神托住

一个有复原力的信徒，不是从不哭、从不倒、从不怕、从不痛。

而是倒了还会站起来，哭过还能继续走，受伤却不绝望，疲惫却仍祷告，被击中却不失去盼望。

因为神在里面托住他。

真正的复原力，不是你拥有多强的能力，而是你拥有一位永不离弃你的神。

六、结语：愿你的灵魂越炼越纯

苦难不是终点，苦难可以成为深度的起点。

你的生命不是被苦难定义，而是被神的同在、神的爱、神的恩典、神的目的和神的塑造定义。

愿你的灵魂不因苦难而破碎，却因神而更坚强、更温柔、更像基督。

因为一个拥有复原力的信徒，不只是自己站立得住，也会成为许多人的盼望。



The Resilience of the Soul

How a Believer Becomes Stronger Through Suffering

Every person will meet suffering in life: illness, pressure, misunderstanding, failure, broken relationships, discouragement, anxiety, accidents, and upheaval.

No one can avoid it completely.

Yet suffering does not affect everyone in the same way. Some people are crushed by it and struggle to recover. Others become more mature, more sensitive, wiser, and stronger through it. The difference often comes from one quality: resilience.

Resilience is the ability of the soul to rise again after being struck. It is not merely personality, willpower, or optimism. It is an inner strength sustained by God.

When believers have this kind of resilience, they may suffer deeply, but they will not be permanently defeated.

1. Why Believers Need Resilience

We live in a world without absolute safety, absolute ease, absolute stability, or absolute wholeness.

Jesus never promised that we would avoid all suffering. But He did promise:

“In this world you will have trouble. But take heart! I have overcome the world.”

(John 16:33, NIV)

This verse gives us the theological foundation of resilience.

Trouble is real, but believers can rise again because Christ has overcome the world.

The deeper our resilience, the more we can face pain, endure brokenness, take another step after falling, refuse to give up in tears, and hold on to hope in disappointment.

Resilience does not mean you will not hurt. It means pain will not swallow you whole.

2. Why Suffering Crushes Some and Forms Others

Psychology reminds us that suffering does not automatically form people. It often reveals and magnifies the structure within them.

If a person's inner life is strong, suffering may shape him. If it is fragile, suffering may crush him.

Spiritual life gives us an even deeper answer: true resilience does not come from self-strength, but from the strength of God within us.

The key is not only the environment, but the foundation.

If your foundation is success, failure will shake you.

If your foundation is relationships, a relational break may crush you.

If your foundation is health, illness may terrify you.

If your foundation is money, unemployment may undo you.

But if your foundation is Christ, the soul can stand even when the world shakes.

3. Where the Believer's Resilience Comes From

First, it comes from God's presence.

Psalm 23 is not theory. It is lived reality:

“Even though I walk through the darkest valley, I will fear no evil, for you are with me.”

(Psalm 23:4, NIV)

When you know you are not facing suffering alone, suffering cannot fully destroy you. God's presence is the deepest support of resilience.

Second, resilience comes from God's promises.

For those without hope, suffering becomes a wall. For those with hope, suffering may become a door.

Suffering will not have the final word in the believer's story.

God's promise will.

Third, resilience comes from grace.

Grace means you may be weak, you may weep, you may be imperfect, you may fall, and you may recover slowly.

Grace is the air of resilience. Without grace, true recovery is difficult.

Fourth, resilience comes from community.

A lonely believer is fragile. A believer rooted in community is more resilient.

Resilience is not only personal. It is also relational.

Fifth, resilience comes from meaning.

Romans 5 gives us a spiritual chain: suffering produces perseverance, perseverance produces character, and character produces hope.

Suffering is not only a force that can damage believers. In God's hands, it can also become a fire that forms them.

4. How to Cultivate Resilience of the Soul

First, face pain honestly rather than avoid it.

Avoidance does not heal. It deepens the wound. Resilience begins with confession: "I hurt. I am tired. I need help. God, I need You."

Honesty is the first step of strength.

Second, practice emotional prayer.

The Psalms are not sedatives. They are outlets for the soul.

You can say to God, "I am afraid. I am angry. I am confused. I feel alone. I do not understand. I need You."

Suppressing emotions is fragile. Bringing them to God is maturity.

Third, build a steady rhythm of life.

Resilience often comes from rhythm more than from willpower.

Regular prayer, rest, family time, exercise, and reflection slowly steady the soul.

Without rhythm, stability is difficult.

Fourth, seek meaningful interpretation in suffering.

Many people are crushed because they ask only, "Why me? Why now? Why does it hurt so much?"

Resilience grows through deeper questions: "What is God teaching me? What is God forming in me? Who is God calling me to become?"

The deeper the meaning, the stronger the resilience.

Fifth, learn to seek help.

Seeking spiritual, professional, and relational help is not weakness. It is wisdom.

Your resilience is not the strength of one person alone. It is the strength of God and others holding you up.

Sixth, let your pain become a capacity to bless others.

The deepest resilience is transformation.

When your wounds become a testimony that helps others heal, you have become truly strong.

5. Resilience Is Not Becoming Stronger by Yourself

A resilient believer is not someone who never cries, never falls, never fears, and never hurts.

A resilient believer falls and rises again, weeps and keeps walking, is wounded but not hopeless, is tired but still prays, is struck but does not lose hope.

Because God is holding that person from within.

True resilience is not that you possess great strength. It is that you belong to a God who will never forsake you.

6. Conclusion: May Your Soul Be Refined

Suffering is not the end. It may become the beginning of depth.

Your life is not defined by suffering, but by God's presence, love, grace, purpose, and formation.

May your soul not be shattered by suffering. May it become stronger, gentler, and more like Christ through God.

A resilient believer not only stands. Such a person becomes hope for many others.

第十篇：在动荡中保持稳固



“信徒如何在时代巨变中不被摇动”

有人说，二十一世纪并没有进入“稳定繁荣”的时代，反而进入了一个持续变化、剧烈动荡的时代。

科技革命、经济不确定、全球政治紧张、文化价值碰撞、工作模式重塑、媒体风向瞬息万变、心理压力飙升、家庭结构被冲击。

所有结构都在动，所有价值都在变，所有节奏都在加速。

在这样的时代，一个真实的问题摆在每个信徒面前：

我们如何在巨变中站稳？如何不焦虑、不迷茫、不被拉扯，而是扎根在神的稳固之中？

这篇文章，是写给在动荡中寻找稳定的人。

一、为什么现在的信徒更容易被摇动

不是因为信仰一定比过去更弱，而是因为环境比过去更强烈。

第一，信息量过大，使人情绪不堪重负。

过去人一天接收的信息，如今可能一个小时就装满了。新闻、视频、社交媒体，让人随时处在焦虑、比较、愤怒或悲伤中。

情绪疲惫，灵魂自然不稳。

第二，社会节奏过快，使人无法消化。

人需要节奏，但今天许多人只有匆忙。匆忙的心无法祷告，匆忙的灵无法聆听神，匆忙的人也最容易被动荡击倒。

第三，生活结构不断变化，使人缺乏归属感。

搬家、换工作、换城市、换关系、换节奏，一切都在流动。

没有扎根，就没有稳定。

第四，人心承受能力下降，抗压性变弱。

经济压力、情绪压力、家庭压力、身份压力，让许多人外表强大，内心脆弱。

当内在承受力变弱，信仰也容易被动摇。

第五，教会有时忙于活动，却缺少深度牧养。

活动多、节目多、讲道多，但许多人依旧灵命浅、关系少、情绪累、心理伤、生命虚，难以抵抗动荡。

规模化的教会很多，深度的教会仍然需要被建立。

二、圣经给动荡时代的答案

圣经从不承诺世界会稳定，甚至清楚告诉我们会风浪。

但圣经应许：基督徒的稳固不是来自世界的稳定，而是来自与基督的连接。

稳定不是外在环境，而是内在根基。

保罗说：“你们应当靠主站立得稳。”（腓立比书 4:1，和合本）

主耶稣也说，听见祂的话又去行的人，就像把房子盖在磐石上。风雨来到，房子却不倒塌。（参马太福音 7:24-25，和合本）

诗篇说：“神是我们的避难所，是我们的力量，是我们在患难中随时的帮助。”（诗篇 46:1，和合本）

稳固来自关系，不是环境；来自根基，不是力量；来自神，不是自己。

三、在巨变时代保持稳固的六条属灵路

第一，建立内在稳固度。

稳定的根源不在外面，而在里面。你需要固定祷告、固定灵修、固定安静、固定反思、固定更新。

许多信徒焦虑，不是因为问题太多，而是因为灵魂没有时间与神对齐。

稳固，可以从每天十五分钟的安静开始。

第二，把焦虑交给神，而不是交给手机。

很多人一焦虑就刷手机，一迷茫就看新闻，一孤单就刷短视频，一疲惫就寻找娱乐。

但这些常常只会让心更碎。

焦虑的问题不只是焦虑本身，而是你把焦虑带到哪里。

把焦虑带到神面前，你的心就不会轻易被动荡带走。

第三，在教会中建立真实关系网络。

没有关系的信徒，是最容易被动荡摧垮的信徒。

你需要可以谈心的弟兄姊妹，可以一起流泪祷告的同伴，可以提醒你的属灵朋友，也需要能扶持你的群体。

信仰不是单打独斗。没有关系，信仰很难稳固。

第四，学会属灵分辨力。

动荡时代的关键能力，是分辨什么是事实，什么是情绪，什么是媒体操控，什么是潮流，什么是神的声音。

一个不善分辨的人，注定被世界牵着走。

分辨不是批判，分辨是智慧。

第五，在家庭中建立稳固节奏。

你的家庭节奏越稳定，你的生命越稳固。

固定吃饭、固定安息、固定祷告、固定分享、固定陪伴、固定祝福，这些看似普通，却会成为灵魂的避风港。

家庭若稳固，心就更容易稳固。

第六，让使命感成为你的锚。

使命不是沉重的责任，而是属灵身份。

一个知道神呼召的人，无论时代如何变化，都不会轻易动摇。

使命给你方向，方向给你意义，意义给你稳固。

当你知道自己是谁，也知道神要你做什么，你就能在风浪中仍有平安。

四、在动荡中成为稳定的人

未来的时代不会更容易，但信徒可以更坚强。

稳固不是外在没有风浪，而是里面有基督的磐石。

稳固的信徒，会让家庭更稳定，因为他的家会因他多一份平安。

稳固的信徒，会让教会更健康，因为他不再成为动荡的来源。

稳固的信徒，也会让世界因他看见光。在混乱中活出平静的力量，是对世界很深的见证。

五、结语：不是时代稳定，而是你被神托住

信徒之所以稳固，不是因为我们有多强，而是因为我们有一位不改变的神。

世界会继续动荡，时代会继续变化，环境会继续不确定。

但神不会变。祂的爱不会变，祂的应许不会变，祂的同在不会变。

愿你成为这样的人：在时代巨变中站立得稳，在混乱中保持清晰，在风浪中依旧平安，在不确定中仍有盼望。

因为你的根不在世界，而在基督。



Staying Steady in a Time of Upheaval

How Believers Can Stand Firm in a Changing Age

Some have said that the twenty-first century has not become an age of stable prosperity, but an age of constant change and intense upheaval.

Technological revolution, economic uncertainty, global political tension, cultural conflict, reshaped work patterns, shifting media narratives, rising psychological pressure, and changing family structures are all pressing upon us.

Structures are moving. Values are shifting. Rhythms are accelerating.

In such an age, every believer faces a real question:

How do we stand firm in great change? How do we avoid being anxious, confused, and pulled apart? How do we stay rooted in the steadiness of God?

This chapter is for those who are looking for stability in unstable times.

1. Why Believers Are More Easily Shaken Today

It is not necessarily because faith has become weaker, but because the surrounding environment has become more intense. First, there is too much information, and our emotions are overwhelmed.

What people once received in a day, we may now receive in an hour. News, videos, and social media keep people in constant anxiety, comparison, anger, or sadness.

When emotions are exhausted, the soul becomes unstable.

Second, the pace of society is too fast to digest.

Human beings need rhythm, but many people today only have hurry. A hurried heart cannot pray. A hurried soul cannot listen to God. A hurried person is easily knocked down by upheaval.

Third, life structures keep changing, and belonging becomes fragile.

People move homes, change jobs, change cities, change relationships, and change rhythms. Everything seems fluid.

Without roots, there is no stability.

Fourth, the inner capacity of the heart is weakening.

Economic pressure, emotional pressure, family pressure, and identity pressure leave many people outwardly strong but inwardly fragile.

When inner capacity is weak, faith is more easily shaken.

Fifth, churches can become busy with programs while lacking deep pastoral care.

There may be many activities, programs, and sermons, yet many people remain shallow in spiritual life, thin in relationships, emotionally tired, wounded within, and unable to resist upheaval.

Many churches have scale. The church still needs depth.

2. The Biblical Answer for an Unstable Age

Scripture never promises that the world will be stable. In fact, it tells us there will be storms.

But Scripture does promise that Christian steadiness does not come from the stability of the world, but from connection with Christ.

Stability is not outward circumstance. It is inward foundation. Paul says, “stand firm in the Lord.”

(Philippians 4:1, NIV)

Jesus says that the one who hears His words and puts them into practice is like a house built on the rock. The storm comes, but the house does not fall.

(See Matthew 7:24-25, NIV)

The psalm says:

“God is our refuge and strength, an ever-present help in trouble.”

(Psalm 46:1, NIV)

Steadiness comes from relationship, not environment; from foundation, not force; from God, not the self.

3. Six Spiritual Ways to Stay Steady in Great Change

First, build inner stability.

The root of stability is not outside you, but within. You need regular prayer, regular devotion, regular silence, regular reflection, and regular renewal.

Many believers are anxious not because there are too many problems, but because the soul has no time to realign with God. Steadiness can begin with fifteen minutes of quiet each day.

Second, bring anxiety to God rather than to your phone.

Many people respond to anxiety by scrolling, to confusion by reading news, to loneliness by watching short videos, and to tiredness by seeking entertainment.

But these often fragment the heart even more.

The problem is not only anxiety itself, but where you bring your anxiety.

Bring it before God, and your heart will not be carried away so easily by upheaval.

Third, build a real network of relationships in the church.

Believers without relationships are among the easiest to be crushed by upheaval.

You need brothers and sisters with whom you can speak honestly, companions who can pray and weep with you, spiritual friends who can remind you, and a community that can support you.

Faith is not a solo battle. Without relationships, faith struggles to remain steady.

Fourth, learn spiritual discernment.

The key ability in an age of upheaval is discerning what is fact, what is emotion, what is media manipulation, what is trend, and what is the voice of God.

A person without discernment will be led around by the world.

Discernment is not cynicism. It is wisdom.

Fifth, build a steady rhythm in the family.

The steadier your family rhythm, the steadier your life can become.

Regular meals, rest, prayer, sharing, presence, and blessing may seem ordinary, but they become shelters for the soul.

When the family is steady, the heart can become steady.

Sixth, let calling become your anchor.

Calling is not merely a heavy responsibility. It is spiritual identity.

A person who knows God's calling will not be easily shaken by changing times.

Calling gives direction, direction gives meaning, and meaning gives steadiness.

When you know who you are and what God is calling you to do, you can remain at peace even in the storm.

4. Becoming a Steady Person in an Unstable Time

The future will not necessarily become easier, but believers can become stronger.

Steadiness does not mean the absence of storms outside. It means the presence of Christ as the rock within.

A steady believer helps the family become more peaceful.

A steady believer helps the church become healthier, because he is not another source of turmoil.

A steady believer also shines before the world. To live with calm strength in chaos is a deep witness.

5. Conclusion: Not Because the Age Is Stable

Believers stand firm not because we are strong, but because we belong to an unchanging God.

The world will continue to shake. Times will keep changing. Circumstances will remain uncertain.

But God does not change. His love does not change. His promises do not change. His presence does not change.

May you become a person who stands firm in great change, remains clear in confusion, keeps peace in storms, and holds hope in uncertainty.

Your roots are not in the world. They are in Christ.

第十一篇：在破碎的世界里做一个完整的人



“新时代信徒的内在生命”

你有没有发现，越是现代社会强调成功、能力和效率，人越容易在心里感到破碎？

许多人外表光鲜，心里却是碎的。关系是碎的，节奏是碎的，情绪是碎的，灵魂也是碎的。

这个世界最流行的状态，似乎是：外面看似挺住，里面却在掉落。

而新时代基督徒面对的最大挑战之一，不只是如何更有效率、更成功、更被看见，而是：

如何在破碎的世界里，保持一个完整的灵魂？

一个信徒的内在生命如何，将在未来决定他能否站立得住。

一、这个时代为什么让人内心破碎

第一，生活节奏碎片化。

工作、手机、社交媒体，把我们的时间切成碎片，使人无法深度思考、深度休息、深度灵修。

碎片化的时间，最终会制造碎片化的灵魂。

第二，关系越来越浅。

我们每天接触成百上千的信息，却很难和一个人深入沟通。

孤独不是身边没人，而是心里无人可托付。

第三，人被要求完美，却没人教我们面对不完美。

我们被要求表现、优秀、坚强，不能哭、不能弱、不能停。

但一个总是被要求坚强的人，灵魂会慢慢裂开。

第四，失控的世界让人焦虑。

科技、大环境、价值观、经济、社会结构都在快速变化，似乎没有什么稳固的。

当外界不稳定时，灵魂最容易破碎。

二、什么是完整的人

圣经从来没有要求我们成为没有裂缝的人，却一直呼召我们成为在神里面被整合的人。

完整不是没有破碎，而是即使破碎，也能因为与神连接而被重新整合。

一个完整的人，情绪真实而不压抑，内心安稳而不焦虑，关系健康而不孤立，节奏平衡而不急躁，有盼望而失控，有边界而不迷失自己，也有力量爱别人而不耗尽自己。

完整不是一个静止状态，而是生命不断被神恢复的过程。

三、未来信徒必须操练的五个内在修炼

第一，建立灵魂的节奏。

现代人最缺的不是时间，而是节奏。

你需要固定安静祷告的时间、无手机的时间、独处的时间、不工作也不学习的时间、与家人真实相处的时间。

一个没有节奏的人，就是一个难以恢复的人。

属灵生命不是被挤出来的，而是被留出来的。

第二，真实面对自己的情绪。

在许多信徒的观念里，难过好像不属灵，软弱好像不属灵，伤心也好像不属灵。

但圣经告诉我们，耶稣也哭过，也忧伤过，也经历极深的痛苦。

你不能医治你不愿面对的情绪。

未来的信徒必须学会给情绪命名，把情绪带到神面前，与信任的人分享，不用属灵话术掩盖痛苦，并在脆弱中经历神的靠近。

当你真实，你才会自由。

第三，建立健康的关系。

破碎的人害怕关系，完整的人学习建立关系。

未来的信徒至少需要三个关系圈层：支撑关系，同行关系，受托关系。

支撑关系，是属灵导师、牧者或成熟信徒；同行关系，是一起生活的小组和朋友；受托关系，是你所关怀、扶持、陪伴的人。

没有关系的信仰，会慢慢枯萎。

第四，设立生命的边界。

边界不是拒绝别人，而是保护你能继续爱别人。

信徒需要学习适时说“不”，不背负不属于自己的责任，不让别人用情绪操控自己，不让服事取代家庭，不让忙碌取代灵命，也不让自责取代恩典。

一个没有边界的人，很难维持长期的爱。

第五，拥有内在的安稳与盼望。

未来的世界不一定更稳定，但你的心可以更稳定。

有盼望的人，不是因为形势更好，而是因为他知道神没有睡着，神没有改变，神仍然掌权，也会在混乱中带领他。

真正的盼望不是逃避现实，而是在现实中看见神的作为。

四、一个完整的信徒，会带来什么改变

未来的教会不仅需要会讲道的人，也需要完整的人。

一个完整的人，会让家庭更稳固，因为他愿意倾听、接纳和陪伴。

一个完整的人，会让教会更健康，因为他不制造分裂，而是带来温柔与和平。

一个完整的人，也会让见证更有力量，因为他的生命真实、有盼望、有整全、有韧性。

完整的人，本身就是活的见证。

五、结语：在破碎之地，被神重新整合

未来的时代不会比现在更容易，但信徒可以比现在更坚强。

不是靠意志力，不是靠神学知识，也不是靠忙碌的事工，而是靠一颗被神不断修复、整合、医治的心。

世界可能破碎，关系可能破碎，情绪可能破碎，生活可能破碎，时代也可能破碎。

但你可以神里面不被破碎定义。

愿你成为这样的信徒：在破碎的世界里，安静、深刻、柔软而坚韧，活出一个因神而完整生命。



Becoming Whole in a Broken World The Inner Formation of Believers in a New Age

Have you noticed that the more modern society emphasizes success, ability, and efficiency, the more broken people often feel inside?

Many people look polished on the outside, yet feel fragmented within. Relationships are fragmented. Rhythms are fragmented. Emotions are fragmented. The soul itself feels fragmented.

One of the most common conditions of our world is this: outwardly holding together, inwardly falling apart.

One of the greatest challenges for Christians in this new age is not only how to be more efficient, more successful, or more visible. The deeper question is:

How do we preserve a whole soul in a broken world?

The inner formation of a believer will determine whether that believer can stand in the years ahead.

1. Why This Age Fragments the Inner Life

First, life is fragmented by pace.

Work, phones, and social media cut our time into pieces. People lose the ability to think deeply, rest deeply, and practice devotion deeply.

Fragmented time eventually creates fragmented souls.

Second, relationships are becoming shallower.

We encounter hundreds or thousands of messages each day, yet struggle to have a deep conversation with one person.

Loneliness is not simply having no one nearby. It is having no one to whom the heart can be entrusted.

Third, people are expected to be perfect, but few are taught how to face imperfection.

We are expected to perform, excel, and remain strong. We are told not to cry, not to be weak, not to stop.

But a person who is always required to be strong will eventually begin to crack inside.

Fourth, an uncontrollable world creates anxiety.

Technology, public life, values, economics, and social structures are changing rapidly. Very little feels stable.

When the outer world becomes unstable, the soul is easily fractured.

2. What Does It Mean to Be Whole?

Scripture does not call us to become people without cracks. It calls us to become people who are reintegrated in God.

Wholeness does not mean the absence of brokenness. It means that even in brokenness, we can be restored and integrated because we are connected to God.

A whole person is emotionally honest rather than repressed, inwardly steady rather than anxious, relationally healthy rather than isolated, balanced in rhythm rather than hurried, hopeful rather than controlled by fear, clear in boundaries rather than lost in the self, and able to love others without being consumed. Wholeness is not a fixed state. It is the ongoing process of being restored by God.

3. Five Inner Practices Believers Need

First, build a rhythm for the soul.

Modern people do not lack time as much as they lack rhythm.

You need regular time for quiet prayer, time without your phone, time alone, time that is neither work nor study, and time to be truly present with family.

A person without rhythm struggles to recover.

Spiritual life is not squeezed out. It is made room for.

Second, face your emotions honestly.

Many believers assume sadness is unspiritual, weakness is unspiritual, and grief is unspiritual.

But Scripture shows us that Jesus wept, grieved, and entered deep anguish.

You cannot heal emotions you refuse to face.

Believers in the future must learn to name emotions, bring them before God, share with trusted people, refuse to hide pain behind spiritual language, and experience God's nearness in vulnerability.

When you become honest, you begin to become free.

Third, build healthy relationships.

Broken people fear relationships. Whole people learn to build them.

Believers need at least three circles of relationships: supporting relationships, companion relationships, and entrusted relationships.

Supporting relationships may include spiritual mentors, pastors, and mature believers. Companion relationships include small groups and friends who walk with us in life. Entrusted relationships are the people we care for, support, and accompany.

Faith without relationships slowly withers.

Fourth, establish life-giving boundaries.

Boundaries are not a rejection of others. They protect your ability to keep loving others.

Believers need to learn when to say no, how not to carry responsibilities that are not theirs, how not to be controlled by others' emotions, how not to let ministry replace family, how not

to let busyness replace spiritual life, and how not to let self-condemnation replace grace.

A person without boundaries will struggle to sustain love over time.

Fifth, cultivate inner steadiness and hope.

The future world may not become more stable, but your heart can become more stable.

A person with hope does not hope because circumstances are better, but because God is not asleep, God has not changed, God still reigns, and God will lead in the midst of confusion.

True hope does not escape reality. It sees the work of God within reality.

4. What a Whole Believer Brings

The future church needs not only people who can preach. It also needs whole people.

A whole person helps the family become steadier, because such a person listens, receives, and accompanies.

A whole person helps the church become healthier, because such a person does not create division, but brings gentleness and peace.

A whole person strengthens witness, because the life itself is real, hopeful, integrated, and resilient.

A whole person is a living witness.

5. Conclusion: Reintegrated by God in a Broken Place

The future will not necessarily become easier, but believers can become stronger.

Not by willpower, theological knowledge, or endless ministry activity, but by a heart continually repaired, integrated, and healed by God.

The world may be broken. Relationships may be broken.

Emotions may be broken. Life may be broken. Even the age itself may feel broken.

But in God, you do not have to be defined by brokenness.

May you become this kind of believer: quiet, deep, tender, and resilient in a broken world, living a whole life because of God.

第十二篇：从孤单到共同体



“中国信徒如何重建属灵连接”

我们生活在一个前所未有地连接、却前所未有地孤单的时代。

手机让我们和全世界保持在线，心却比任何时代都更容易离线。

这不仅是社会问题，也是属灵问题。因为神造人，本来就不是让我们独自面对世界，而是让我们在爱中彼此连接、彼此成全。

然而，今天的中国信徒，无论在国内还是海外，都普遍面对一种共同处境：

关系越来越多，连接越来越浅；信息越来越快，灵里越来越干；教会活动越来越丰富，心灵却越来越孤单。

未来二十年，中国信徒如何从孤单中走出来，重新建立健康、深度、有生命力的属灵共同体？

一、为什么现代信徒比以往更孤单

孤单并不是因为人少，而是因为心无处安放。

第一，城市化带来流动性的破碎。

人们换城市、换工作、换生活的频率越来越高，家乡与故土越来越远，熟悉的教会、稳定的小组、人际支持系统也渐渐消失。

流动的生活让关系变得脆弱，灵里难以扎根。

第二，新时代的节奏太快，灵魂跟不上。

白天忙工作，晚上刷手机，周末补作业、跑活动。有空的时候只想休息，没力气陪伴任何人；真正有需要的时候，却找不到可以依靠的人。

快节奏让人疲惫，疲惫让人孤单。

第三，社交媒体创造了虚假的连接。

朋友圈、视频号、短视频让我们以为保持联系很容易，但那并不等于真实的生命共享。

点赞的热闹，掩盖不了心里的寂静。

第四，许多信徒受过伤，却不敢表达。

在家庭、教会、职场和关系中受过伤的人，往往最害怕再次脆弱。于是他们选择：“我自己扛”“我不麻烦别人”“我不说，就不会被拒绝。”

但隐藏伤口不会带来医治，只会让人更孤单。

第五，许多教会忙于做事，却忽略做关系。

活动、节目、讲座、事工都很重要，但人更需要能听心里话的人，真正理解自己的朋友，一起祷告流泪的同伴，以及可以托付生命的属灵关系。

教会若没有关系的深度，就难以抵挡现代孤单的风暴。

二、孤单为什么是属灵危机

孤单不只是个人情绪，也是一种属灵危机。

一个缺乏共同体的信徒，会慢慢出现三种倾向。

第一，灵命越来越靠个人努力，而不是共同扶持。

他读经、祷告、敬拜都靠意志力，而不是关系中的陪伴、鼓励与激发。久而久之，就容易倦怠。

第二，试炼中无处可去，痛苦只能独自承担。

婚姻、子女、病痛、压力、信仰困惑，若没有同行者，痛苦会加倍，挣扎会加深。

第三，冷漠、怀疑、疲倦、放弃会慢慢增长。

这种冷却不是一夜发生的，而是在孤单中一点点生成的。

一个孤单的信徒不一定马上跌倒，但会一点点萎缩。

三、从活动型教会走向关系型教会

未来二十年，中国教会若要真正复兴，必须从只忙于活动，转向深度重建关系。

关系是门徒的土壤，共同体是信仰的空气。

属灵生命不只是在讲座中成长，更是在关系里发芽。

第一，建立真实沟通的文化。

今天许多信徒需要的，不只是更多神学知识，也需要一个可以说真话的地方。

真实连接从简单的话开始：“你最近还好吗？”“你需要有人陪你祷告吗？”“你可以放心跟我说，我不会评判你。”

没有真实，就没有共同体。

第二，小组要从查经小组走向生命小组。

查经很重要，但不能成为小组生活的全部。未来教会的小组，需要成为彼此倾听、彼此医治、彼此陪伴、一起哭、一起笑、一起成长的地方。

一个生命得医治的人，往往比许多头脑只有知识的人更能带来复兴。

第三，重建陪伴式门徒训练。

耶稣没有只开办讲座，祂选择与门徒一起走路、吃饭、生活。

未来的教会需要恢复这种陪伴式牧养：一对一，一对二，生命带生命，关系带关系，在真实生活里学习跟随主。

门徒不是只在课堂里被造就，也是在同行中被塑造。

四、个人如何走出孤单

你不必等教会开始，自己就可以开始。

第一，主动建立关系。给一个人发消息，约一次见面。孤单不是等别人来救你，而是你先迈出一大步。

第二，成为一个安全的人。安全的人不评判别人，不传播别人的痛苦，也不用教导代替陪伴。当你成为安全的人，别人自然愿意靠近。

第三，找两三个能一起同行的信徒。分享挣扎，一起祷告，为彼此家庭代求，一起灵修。两三个人，就能改变你灵命的强度。

第四，用你的恩赐去祝福他人。当你让别人不孤单的时候，你自己也不再孤单。

五、结语：在彼此连接中，我们才真正成为教会

基督徒的生命不是独行侠的旅程，而是一群陪伴者同行的道路。

未来二十年，面对巨大的压力、变化与挑战，中国教会能否继续前行，关键不只在聚会人数多少，而在连接是否真实。

教会不是建筑、活动或节目。教会是：在孤单时代仍愿意彼此陪伴的人，在困难时代仍愿意彼此扶持的人，在黑暗时代仍愿意一起寻求光的人。

愿你找到这样的人，也愿你成为这样的人。

因为当一个信徒从孤单走向共同体，一个教会就会复兴；当一群信徒从孤单走向共同体，一个城市就会被点亮。



From Loneliness to Community Rebuilding Spiritual Connection Among Chinese Believers

We live in an age that is more connected than ever and yet more lonely than ever.

Our phones keep us online with the whole world, but our hearts may be more offline than in any previous age.

This is not only a social problem. It is a spiritual problem. God did not create human beings to face the world alone, but to be connected and built up in love.

Yet Chinese believers today, whether in China or overseas, often face a common reality:

More relationships, but shallower connection. Faster information, but drier souls. More church activities, but lonelier hearts.

How can Chinese believers in the next twenty years move from loneliness into healthy, deep, life-giving spiritual community?

1. Why Modern Believers Are More Lonely

Loneliness does not come simply from having too few people around. It comes when the heart has nowhere to rest.

First, urbanization creates the brokenness of mobility.

People change cities, jobs, and lifestyles more frequently.

Hometowns feel farther away. Familiar churches, stable small groups, and relational support systems gradually disappear.

A mobile life makes relationships fragile, and the soul struggles to take root.

Second, the pace of the new age is too fast for the soul.

People work all day, scroll at night, catch up on tasks and activities during the weekend. When they finally have free time, they only want to rest and have no strength to accompany anyone. But when they truly need help, they may find no one to lean on.

Fast pace creates exhaustion, and exhaustion deepens loneliness.

Third, social media creates false connection.

Moments, short videos, and online posts make us feel that staying connected is easy. But this is not the same as sharing life. The noise of likes cannot hide the silence of the heart.

Fourth, many believers have been wounded but are afraid to speak.

Those wounded in family, church, workplace, or relationships often fear becoming vulnerable again. So they choose, “I will carry it myself.” “I do not want to trouble others.” “If I do not speak, I will not be rejected.”

But hidden wounds do not bring healing. They deepen loneliness.

Fifth, many churches are busy doing things but neglect building relationships.

Activities, programs, lectures, and ministries matter. But people also need someone who will listen to the heart, friends who truly understand, companions who pray and weep together, and spiritual relationships to which life can be entrusted.

If the church lacks relational depth, it will struggle to withstand the storm of modern loneliness.

2. Why Loneliness Is a Spiritual Crisis

Loneliness is not merely a personal emotion. It is a spiritual crisis.

A believer without community will slowly develop several patterns.

First, spiritual life depends more and more on personal effort rather than mutual support.

Bible reading, prayer, and worship depend only on willpower rather than companionship, encouragement, and stirring up within relationships. Over time, fatigue sets in.

Second, trials have nowhere to go, and pain must be carried alone.

Marriage, children, illness, pressure, and questions of faith become heavier without companions. Pain doubles, and struggle deepens.

Third, coldness, doubt, fatigue, and resignation grow quietly. This cooling does not happen overnight. It forms slowly in loneliness.

A lonely believer may not fall immediately, but the soul will gradually shrink.

3. From Activity-Based Church to Relationship-Based Church

If the Chinese church is to experience genuine renewal in the next twenty years, it must move from mere activity to the rebuilding of deep relationships.

Relationships are the soil of discipleship. Community is the air of faith.

Spiritual life does not grow only in lectures. It sprouts in relationships.

First, build a culture of honest communication.

Many believers today do not only need more theological knowledge. They need a place where they can tell the truth.

Real connection can begin with simple words: “How have you really been?” “Do you need someone to pray with you?” “You can speak freely. I will not judge you.”

Without honesty, there is no community.

Second, small groups must become life groups, not only Bible study groups.

Bible study is important, but it cannot be the whole life of the group. Future church small groups need to become places of listening, healing, companionship, tears, laughter, and shared growth.

One healed life may bring more renewal than many minds filled only with information.

Third, rebuild accompanying discipleship.

Jesus did not merely hold lectures. He walked, ate, and lived with His disciples.

The future church needs to recover this kind of pastoral accompaniment: one-on-one, one-on-two, life shaping life, relationships forming relationships, learning to follow the Lord in real life.

Disciples are not formed only in classrooms. They are formed on the road together.

4. How Each Believer Can Move Out of Loneliness

You do not have to wait for the church to begin. You can begin.

First, take initiative in relationships. Send a message to one person. Invite someone to meet. Loneliness is not overcome by waiting for others to rescue you. It begins to change when you take one step.

Second, become a safe person. A safe person does not judge, does not spread another person's pain, and does not replace companionship with teaching. When you become safe, others naturally draw near.

Third, find two or three believers to walk with. Share struggles, pray together, intercede for one another's families, and practice devotion together. Two or three people can change the strength of your spiritual life.

Fourth, use your gifts to bless others. When you help others become less lonely, you also become less lonely.

5. Conclusion: We Become the Church Through Connection

The Christian life is not the journey of a solitary hero. It is the road of companions walking together.

In the next twenty years, as pressure, change, and challenges grow, the future of the Chinese church will depend not only on attendance numbers, but on whether connection is real.

The church is not a building, an activity, or a program. The church is the people who still choose to accompany one another in a lonely age, support one another in a difficult age, and seek the light together in a dark age.

May you find such people, and may you become such a person. When one believer moves from loneliness to community, a church can be renewed. When a group of believers move from loneliness to community, a city can be lit with hope.

第五辑：教会的未来与使命

第十三篇：教会如何面对多元社会？



“在张力中保持真理与恩典”

同一个家庭里，父母和孩子可能对婚姻、性别、成功、自由、权威和信仰有完全不同的理解。

同一个小组里，有人从传统文化走来，有人深受西方教育影响；有人习惯清楚答案，有人更愿意在问题中探索。

这就是今天教会真实的牧养现场：价值观并不一致，文化背景彼此交错，许多问题也不再能用一句简单的话回答。

教会置身其中，既不是局外人，也不是旁观者。我们是被呼召在所在之地作盐作光的群体。

问题是：在日益多元、复杂、冲突并存的社会中，教会如何既不妥协真理，又不失去恩典？

这是华人教会无法回避的核心问题之一。

一、多元社会给教会带来的挑战

多元社会意味着价值观不再一致，生活方式不再统一，年轻人与年长者之间的差异更大，全球化与本地文化并存，科技让人的思维快速变化，媒体也不断制造碎片化的世界。

在这样的背景下，教会若不敏锐，不仅会失去下一代，也会逐渐失去自身的立足点。

第一，价值观冲突成为常态。

过去相对单一的社会里，许多道德与价值几乎不用解释。但今天，婚姻、性别、家庭、权威、信仰、伦理、真理，都可能被重新质疑。

年轻人在学校、网络和同伴中听见的声音，常常与教会完全不同。

第二，许多信徒不知道如何面对不同。

遇到不同观点，有人回避，有人争吵，有人沉默，有人妥协，有人愤怒，也有人直接远离对话。

但真正成熟的信徒，需要学习带着恩典与智慧进入对话。

第三，教会内部也出现差异与张力。

文化背景不同、教育水平不同、新旧移民差异、代际观点不同，都会让小组融合、教会决策、青年牧养与长者感受变得更复杂。

教会既要合一，又要尊重差异，这从来不容易。

第四，社交媒体制造情绪化社会。

在各种社交平台里，冷静常常是少数，情绪才是主导。

但属灵生命不能靠情绪建立。

第五，教会容易陷入两种极端。

一种极端是过度强调真理，却缺乏恩典，让人觉得信仰僵硬、沉重、压迫。

另一种极端是过度追求恩典，却淡化真理，让信仰失去方向和根基。

真正的信仰，必须在真理与恩典之间活出完整见证。

二、耶稣的方式：真理与恩典缺一不可

约翰福音给了我们最重要的方向：

“道成了肉身，住在我们中间，充充满满地有恩典有真理。”（约翰福音 1:14，和合本）

耶稣是历史上唯一把真理与恩典完美结合的人。

面对撒玛利亚妇人，祂以恩典接纳，也以真理指引。面对撒该，祂以恩典临到，也带来生命更新。面对犯罪的妇人，祂不定罪，也说“去吧，从此不要再犯罪”。面对法利赛人，祂用真理揭露虚伪，却仍为耶路撒冷哀哭。

耶稣不是一半恩典、一半真理。祂是完全的恩典，也是完全的真理。

这也是教会在多元处境中的方向。

三、教会如何在多元社会中持守真理

持守真理，不是靠更凶，也不是靠更硬。

第一，不妥协圣经的权威。

圣经是教会的根基，不因时代变化而改变。

第二，持守核心教义，而不是把次要议题绝对化。

教会必须区分永恒真理、文化习俗与个人喜好。不能把自己的偏好当作神的真理，也不能把文化习惯上升为信仰标准。

第三，帮助信徒建立分辨能力。

牧养的目标不是只告诉信徒“该怎么想”，而是教导他们如何在圣经、圣灵与共同体中分辨。

第四，用生活见证真理，而不是只用争辩维护真理。

真理不是靠辩论赢得的，而是靠生命显明的。

第五，不因害怕争议而沉默真理。

沉默不一定是谦卑，有时也可能是逃避。

真理本身不会让人远离，缺少爱的真理才会。

四、教会如何在多元中活出恩典

恩典不会让教会软弱，恩典让教会有力量接触世界。

第一，倾听，而不是急着定论。

倾听是恩典的开始。

第二，尊重不同背景、文化与经历的人。

不是每个人都像我们那样成长。理解，常常比要求更有力量。

第三，允许人有成长过程。

真理进入生命，常常不是瞬间完成，而是一段旅程。

第四，接纳软弱者、迷失者、失败者。

恩典最大的力量，是给人重新开始的机会。

第五，用温柔、平安和耐心回应攻击与误解。

恩典不是一种表面的姿态，而是一种由基督塑造出来的态度。

五、真理与恩典之间的道路

教会若要忠心走下去，不是靠对抗社会，也不是靠迎合世界。

教会需要成为安全的地方，让人可以真实而不被羞辱；成为有深度的地方，让信徒建立稳固根基；也成为温柔的地方，在爱里带出改变。

温柔不是软弱。温柔是圣灵赋予的力量。温柔让人向真理敞开，也让人看见基督的美。

六、结语：多元社会不是危机，而是机会

多元社会考验教会，也成就教会。

正是在多元的张力中，教会才能展现真正的爱，活出真正的真理，成为真正的光，建立真正的共同体，见证真正的福音。

环境越纷乱，越需要稳固而温柔的信仰群体。

越是在多元的社会，越需要既坚定真理、又满有恩典的信徒。

愿神使我们成为这样的群体：在真理上不动摇，在恩典上不缺乏，在爱中勇敢地拥抱身边的人。



The Church in a Pluralistic Society Holding Truth and Grace in Tension

Within one family, parents and children may understand marriage, gender, success, freedom, authority, and faith in very different ways.

Within one small group, some people may come from a more traditional cultural background, while others have been deeply shaped by Western education. Some long for clear answers; others are more willing to explore questions.

This is the pastoral field before the church today: shared assumptions are weakening, cultures overlap, and many questions can no longer be answered with a single simple sentence.

The church is not an outsider or a spectator in this world. We are called to be salt and light where God has placed us.

The question is this: in a society that is increasingly plural, complex, and conflicted, how can the church refuse to compromise truth without losing grace?

This is one of the central questions Chinese churches cannot avoid.

1. The Challenge of a Pluralistic Society

A pluralistic society means shared values are weakening, lifestyles are no longer uniform, generational differences are widening, global and local cultures live side by side, technology reshapes thought quickly, and media fragments the world.

If the church is not spiritually alert, it may lose not only the next generation, but also its own footing.

First, value conflict becomes normal.

In a more uniform society, many moral assumptions did not need much explanation. Today, marriage, gender, family, authority, faith, ethics, and truth are all questioned.

The voices young people hear at school, online, and among peers are often very different from what they hear in church.

Second, many believers do not know how to face difference.

When they encounter different views, some avoid them, some argue, some stay silent, some compromise, some become angry, and some withdraw from conversation.

Mature believers must learn to enter dialogue with grace and wisdom.

Third, the church itself experiences tension.

Differences in culture, education, immigration experience, and generation can make small groups, church decisions, youth ministry, and older members' concerns more complicated. The church must pursue unity while respecting difference. That is not easy.

Fourth, social media creates an emotional society.

On social platforms, calmness is often rare and emotion often leads.

But spiritual life cannot be built on emotion.

Fifth, the church can fall into two extremes.

One extreme emphasizes truth without grace, making faith feel rigid, heavy, and oppressive.

The other extreme emphasizes grace while diluting truth, causing faith to lose direction and foundation.

True faith must bear witness through both truth and grace.

2. The Way of Jesus: Truth and Grace Together

The Gospel of John gives us the most important direction:

“The Word became flesh and made his dwelling among us. We have seen his glory... full of grace and truth.”

(John 1:14, NIV)

Jesus is the only One in history who perfectly united truth and grace.

With the Samaritan woman, He received her with grace and guided her with truth. With Zacchaeus, grace came to his house and truth renewed his life. With the woman caught in sin, Jesus did not condemn her, and He also said, “Go now and leave your life of sin.” With the Pharisees, He exposed hypocrisy with truth, yet wept over Jerusalem.

Jesus is not half grace and half truth. He is full grace and full truth.

This is also the church's direction in plural contexts.

3. How the Church Holds Truth

Holding truth does not mean becoming harsher or harder.

First, do not compromise the authority of Scripture.

Scripture is the foundation of the church. It does not change with the age.

Second, hold core doctrines without absolutizing secondary issues.

The church must distinguish eternal truth, cultural custom, and personal preference. We must not treat our preferences as God's truth or elevate cultural habits into spiritual standards.

Third, help believers develop discernment.

The goal of pastoral ministry is not merely to tell people what to think, but to teach them how to discern through Scripture, the Spirit, and community.

Fourth, witness to truth through life, not only through argument. Truth is not ultimately won by debate. It is revealed through life.

Fifth, do not remain silent about truth because of fear of controversy.

Silence is not always humility. Sometimes it is avoidance.

Truth itself does not drive people away. Truth without love often does.

4. How the Church Lives Out Grace

Grace does not weaken the church. Grace gives the church strength to touch the world.

First, listen before making conclusions.

Listening is the beginning of grace.

Second, respect people from different backgrounds, cultures, and experiences.

Not everyone grew up the way we did. Understanding is often more powerful than demanding.

Third, allow people to grow through a process.

Truth entering a life is often not instant. It is a journey.

Fourth, receive the weak, the lost, and the failed.

The great power of grace is that it gives people another beginning.

Fifth, respond to attack and misunderstanding with gentleness, peace, and patience.

Grace is not a surface posture. It is an attitude formed by Christ.

5. The Path Between Truth and Grace

The church will not walk faithfully by fighting society, nor by imitating the world.

The church must become a safe place where people can be real without being shamed; a deep place where believers develop firm roots; and a gentle place where love opens the way for change. Gentleness is not weakness. It is strength given by the Holy Spirit. Gentleness helps people open their hearts to truth and see the beauty of Christ.

6. Conclusion: Plurality Is Not Only a Crisis

A pluralistic society tests the church, but it can also form the church.

In the tensions of plurality, the church can reveal genuine love, embody truth, shine as light, build real community, and bear witness to the gospel.

The more chaotic the environment, the more we need faith communities that are steady and gentle.

The more plural the society, the more we need believers who are firm in truth and full of grace.

May God make us such a church: unwavering in truth, rich in grace, and courageous in love as we serve the people around us.

第十四篇：当教会与社会边界模糊



“如何在灰色地带活出清晰的信仰”

一位年轻信徒问我：“牧师，这件事违法吗？”

我说：“不违法。”

他又问：“那基督徒是不是就可以做？”

这个问题，正好说出了许多信徒今天的困惑。现实并不总是简单的黑白。有些事情法律允许，圣经却提醒谨慎；有些事情文化接受，信仰却需要分辨；有些事情社会鼓励，但属灵后果复杂；有些事情人人都这样做，信徒却必须存心辨识。

灰色地带最令人焦虑的地方在于：没有现成的标准答案。

于是，一代信徒站在迷雾中问：“在模糊处境中，我们该怎么活？边界在哪里？什么是自由，什么是危险？怎样不活得律法化，又不掉入放纵？”

这是信徒一直需要面对的问题，只是在今天显得格外迫切。

一、为什么边界越来越模糊

这不只是教会的问题，也是现实结构正在变化。

第一，社会价值观快速变化，速度超过教会吸收能力。

过去价值观变化较慢，群体还有时间回应、消化、辨识。现在变化太快，我们往往还在讨论上一代议题，年轻人已经开始面对下一代问题。

第二，科技改变了信徒接触世界的方式。

手机、社交媒体、全球化信息、AI、大数据、网络社群，让信徒与世界高度混合，也让界限感显著下降。

第三，现代社会强调个人自由，而教会强调共同体顺服。

这两者之间的张力，让许多信徒感到冲突：如何平衡个人表达与群体顺服？如何兼顾个性与圣洁？如何活在自由里，却不成为别人的绊脚石？

第四，代际差异空前加大。

年长者对信仰的理解常常是纪律与固定模式，年轻人对信仰的理解常常是真实与灵活空间。一个强调边界，一个强调开放。两者交汇时，教会的界线就变得复杂。

第五，许多议题本来就不是简单黑白。

职场伦理、消费文化、网络娱乐、情绪表达、人际关系、家庭结构，许多事情圣经没有直接逐条说明，需要分辨、智慧和群体指引。

模糊不一定是失败，也可能是信徒成熟的起点。

二、灰色地带中的两种危险极端

灰色地带让信徒不安，于是一些教会容易走向两个极端。

第一，用律法化的黑白解决灰色。

这种做法规定过多，害怕模糊，倾向用禁令代替牧养，用“不要、不能、不许”来处理复杂问题，也容易把文化习惯当作信仰真理。

结果是年轻人离开，信仰变窄，恩典减少，心灵压抑，讨论被禁止，教会越来越僵硬。

律法化的黑白可以带来秩序，却未必带来生命。

第二，用无限度的自由逃避真理。

这种做法凡事都说“无所谓”，用爱包容一切，却失去圣洁；回避教导，害怕得罪人；淡化真理，只强调体验；只讲恩典，不讲悔改。

结果是信仰失去分辨力，生命没有方向，教会丧失道德声音，下一代也不知道真理的界线。

没有真理的恩典，会变成廉价的恩典。

三、如何在灰色地带活出清晰

答案不只在教会的规则，更在信徒生命的成熟度。

第一，用圣经的核心真理判断，而不是用文化习惯判断。

不是所有旧的都是圣经的，也不是所有新的都是危险的。

关键是：这件事是否违背圣经清楚的教导？如果违背，就不是灰色，而是黑色；如果符合，就不是灰色，而是白色；如果圣经没有直接教导，才进入灰色地带。

灰色地带需要的不是简单禁令，而是属灵智慧。

第二，在灰色地带中，让基督的平安在心里作主。

保罗说：“又要叫基督的平安在你们心里作主。”（歌罗西书 3:15，和合本）

若一件事越做越混乱、越做越亏欠、越做越远离神、越做越隐藏、越做越羞愧，就需要认真停下来分辨。

平安，是灵里的红绿灯。

第三，寻求成熟信徒的建议。

孤单的信徒容易被自己说服，但共同体能保护心灵。

灰色问题不必独自处理。可以向牧者请教，找成熟信徒分享，与属灵同伴祷告，寻求群体智慧。

当一个人把灰色问题带进共同体，神常常借着共同体帮他看见光。

第四，不只问“能不能”，更要问“像不像基督”。

属灵成熟的标志，不是越来越多行为规范，而是凡事都会问：“这是否更像基督？”

我可以这样做吗？也许可以。但它更荣耀神吗？更祝福别人吗？更让生命成长吗？更让关系和好吗？

成熟的人不只看许可，也看益处。

第五，在灰色地带中保持温柔的边界。

温柔不是妥协，温柔是带着爱坚持边界。

健康的信徒可以说：“我尊重你，但我不能这样做。”“我理解你的观点，但我不会放弃我的信仰。”“我们可以对话，但我不会用争吵回应。”“我爱你，所以我不会迎合错误。”

在灰色地带里，温柔的边界比强硬的控诉更有力量。

四、结语：模糊是成熟的邀请

当社会边界模糊时，神邀请我们进入更深的属灵成熟。

因为清晰不是只来自规则，更来自生命。

一个成熟信徒在灰色地带中，会用真理辨识，用恩典连接，用平安判断，用群体确认，用爱活出界线，也用基督显明方向。

当信徒成熟，群体就有路；当教会清晰，世界就会看见光。

愿你成为这样的信徒：在模糊中持守清晰，在复杂中活出单纯，在灰色中显出基督的荣光。



Faith with Clarity in Gray Areas When the Boundaries Between Church and Society Become Blurred

A young believer once asked me, “Pastor, is this illegal?”

I said, “No, it is not illegal.”

He then asked, “Then does that mean a Christian can do it?”

That question captures the confusion many believers feel today.

Reality is not always black and white. It often contains many gray areas. Some things may be legally permitted, yet spiritually concerning. Some may be culturally accepted, yet require discernment. Some may be socially encouraged, yet carry complex spiritual consequences. Some may be common practice, yet believers still need to examine them carefully.

The most unsettling thing about gray areas is that there are no ready-made answers.

So a generation of believers stands in the fog and asks: How should we live amid ambiguity? Where are the boundaries? What is freedom, and what is danger? How do we avoid legalism without falling into indulgence?

Believers have always faced these questions, but today they feel especially urgent.

1. Why Boundaries Are Becoming Blurred

This is not only a church problem. It reflects the changing shape of life around us.

First, social values are changing faster than the church can process.

In the past, values changed more slowly, and communities had time to respond, absorb, and discern. Today change is so fast that the church may still be discussing the questions of one generation while young people are already facing the questions of the next.

Second, technology has changed how believers encounter the world.

Phones, social media, global information, AI, big data, and online communities keep believers constantly exposed to the wider world. The sense of boundary becomes weaker.

Third, modern society emphasizes personal freedom, while the church emphasizes communal obedience.

This tension causes many believers to struggle. How do we balance personal expression and communal submission? How do we honor individuality while pursuing holiness? How do we live in freedom without becoming a stumbling block?

Fourth, generational differences have widened.

Older believers often understand faith through discipline and fixed patterns. Younger believers often emphasize authenticity and flexible space. One side stresses boundaries, the other openness. When these meet, the church's boundaries become complicated.

Fifth, many issues are genuinely gray rather than simply black and white.

Workplace ethics, consumer culture, online entertainment, emotional expression, relationships, and family structures are not always addressed by Scripture in direct detail. They require discernment, wisdom, and communal guidance.

Ambiguity is not necessarily failure. It may be the beginning of maturity.

2. Two Dangerous Extremes in Gray Areas

Gray areas make believers uncomfortable, so churches can fall into two extremes.

The first extreme is using legalistic black-and-white rules to solve gray areas.

This approach creates too many rules, fears ambiguity, replaces pastoral care with prohibitions, and often treats cultural habits as biblical truth.

The result is that young people leave, faith becomes narrow, grace decreases, hearts feel oppressed, discussion is forbidden, and the church becomes rigid.

Legalistic black-and-white thinking can produce order, but not necessarily life.

The second extreme is using unlimited freedom to avoid truth.

This approach says everything is acceptable, uses love to excuse everything while losing holiness, avoids teaching for fear of offense, weakens truth, centers experience, and speaks of grace without repentance.

The result is that faith loses discernment, life loses direction, the church loses its moral voice, and the next generation no longer knows where truth's boundaries are.

Grace without truth becomes cheap grace.

3. How to Live with Clarity in Gray Areas

The answer is not only found in church rules. It is found in the maturity of believers.

First, judge by the core truths of Scripture rather than cultural habits.

Not everything old is biblical, and not everything new is dangerous.

The key question is this: Does this violate clear biblical teaching? If it does, it is not gray; it is black. If it agrees with Scripture, it is not gray; it is white. If Scripture does not address it directly, then it enters the gray area.

Gray areas require not simple prohibitions, but spiritual wisdom. Second, let the peace of Christ rule in the heart.

Paul says:

“Let the peace of Christ rule in your hearts.”

(Colossians 3:15, NIV)

If something increasingly brings confusion, guilt, distance from God, secrecy, and shame, then it needs serious discernment.

Peace is a spiritual traffic light.

Third, seek counsel from mature believers.

Lonely believers can easily persuade themselves. Community helps protect the heart.

Gray questions do not have to be handled alone. Ask pastors, share with mature believers, pray with spiritual companions, and seek communal wisdom.

When a person brings gray questions into community, God often uses that community to help the person see light.

Fourth, do not ask only, “Can I?” Ask, “Is this like Christ?”

The mark of spiritual maturity is not having more behavioral rules, but learning to ask in all things, “Does this make me more like Christ?”

Perhaps I can do this. But does it glorify God? Does it bless others? Does it help life grow? Does it bring reconciliation?

Mature people do not look only at permission. They also look at what is beneficial.

Fifth, keep gentle boundaries in gray areas.

Gentleness is not compromise. Gentleness is holding boundaries with love.

A healthy believer can say, “I respect you, but I cannot do this.”

“I understand your view, but I will not give up my faith.” “We can talk, but I will not answer with quarrels.” “I love you, so I will not affirm what is wrong.”

In gray areas, gentle boundaries are more powerful than harsh accusation.

4. Conclusion: Ambiguity Is an Invitation to Maturity

When social boundaries blur, God invites us into deeper spiritual maturity.

Clarity does not come only from rules. It comes from life.

A mature believer in gray areas discerns with truth, connects with grace, judges with peace, confirms with community, lives boundaries with love, and reveals direction through Christ.

When believers mature, the church finds a way forward. When the church is clear, the world sees light.

May you become such a believer: holding clarity in ambiguity, living simplicity in complexity, and revealing the glory of Christ in the gray.

第十五篇：当下一代离开教会



“我们如何挽回他们的心”

“牧师，我儿子不愿意去教会了。”

“孩子上大学以后，完全不再信了。”

“小组里的年轻人不见了，聚会剩下的大多是中年人。”

这样的声音，这几年在许多华人教会中不断出现。

全球范围内，许多研究都指出，十八到二十九岁的年轻人正以前所未有的速度离开教会。这不是中国教会独有的问题，但在中国信徒与海外华人教会中，也表现得十分明显。

为什么？

因为今天的年轻人面对的世界，已经与上一代完全不同。

于是，一个迫切的问题摆在所有教会面前：当下一代离开教会，我们究竟该如何挽回他们？

一、年轻人为什么离开教会

许多父母和教会以为年轻人离开教会，是因为他们懒、叛逆、世俗。

但如果我们愿意坐下来听他们心里真实的声音，会发现原因远比这些更深。

第一，他们不反对信仰，却反对虚假。

这一代年轻人最敏锐的，未必是神学术语，而是真诚。

他们可以忍受不完美，却很难忍受虚伪。当教会讲爱，私下却充满竞争；讲圣洁，领袖却有隐藏问题；讲饶恕，关系却彼此冷漠；讲恩典，却用律法压迫年轻人，他们会很快失望。

年轻人离开，不一定是因为信仰不真实，而是因为他们找不到真实的信徒生活。

第二，他们觉得教会只关心行为，不关心他们的心。

“不能谈恋爱？”“不能玩游戏？”“不能谈心理问题？”“不能怀疑？”

当教会只看表现，却不管内心，年轻人会感到被控制、被审判、被误解、被标签化。

没有一个年轻人愿意长久停留在一个不断评判自己的地方。

第三，年轻人面对巨大压力，却在教会得不到足够支持。

许多年轻人离开教会不是不信，而是太累了。

学业压力、职场竞争、身份焦虑、情绪不稳、家庭紧张、孤单、焦虑、抑郁，都可能压在他们身上。

他们不是不想来，而是觉得自己没有力气面对人。

他们不是离开信仰，而是被生活压垮了。

第四，教会表达与年轻人的语境脱节。

有些讲台仍停留在多年前的表达方式，而年轻人生活在图像化、数字化、情绪化、关系化、全球化、快节奏的时代。

当牧者与年轻人不在同一个语境里，年轻人就很难感到被理解。

第五，他们渴望参与，不想只是听命。

年轻人希望被聆听、被信任、被赋权，有创造空间，也有参与决策的机会。

如果教会仍然只是“长辈说了算”的结构，年轻人会感到没有归属感。

第六，他们不一定是离开信仰，而是在离开旧的教会模式。

许多年轻人对耶稣仍有好感，却对教会感到距离。

他们并非不要神，而是在寻找一种更真、更深、更真实的门徒生活。

二、如何挽回他们的心

挽回下一代，不是靠更多活动，而是靠更深的爱、更多的倾听、更真实的同行。

第一，给他们一个可以真实而不被审判的空间。

年轻人最缺的，不只是圣经知识，也包括一个可以讲痛苦、讲困惑、讲失败、讲罪、讲怀疑、讲挣扎，却不会被羞辱和论断的地方。

当教会成为这样的地方，他们就比较愿意留下。

第二，建立代际对话，而不是代际冲突。

年轻人最需要的，不是长辈立刻理解他们所有想法，而是愿意认真听他们为什么这样想。

代际沟通不是“我告诉你应该怎样”，而是“我愿意听你为什么这样想”。

年轻人需要的不只是教训，更是倾听。

第三，恢复关系大于活动的教会文化。

教会不一定需要更多节目，却一定需要更深关系。

让年轻人感到：我在这里被看见，被记得，被需要，被爱，也被接纳。

关系，是教会对下一代最强的吸引力。

第四，赋权，而不是只安排任务。

年轻人愿意服事，但他们不愿意只被当作劳动力。

他们需要参与感、决策权、创造空间、信任、鼓励和导师式陪伴。

他们不只是“孩子”，也是正在被预备的领袖。

第五，让信仰真正走进日常。

年轻人需要的不只是神学概念，也需要信仰如何面对压力、处理情绪、建立关系、在职场做光、在生活中听见神、活出内在丰盛。

当信仰能够进入现实，年轻人会重新发现信仰的价值。

第六，讲台必须更诚实、更脆弱、更真实。

下一代不是来听完美的信息，而是来听真实的信息。

一个脆弱、诚实、谦卑的讲台，比许多完美却遥远的讲台更能挽回下一代。

第七，让年轻人参与使命，而不只是活动。

年轻人对使命极其敏感，他们愿意为改变世界而摆上生命。

教会若能引导他们参与社区关怀、关心弱势群体、参与短宣、投身文化使命、用恩赐祝福他人，他们就会重新找到属于自己的位置。

三、挽回下一代，从一个问题开始

这个问题很简单：

“你愿意告诉我，你心里真正的挣扎吗？”

你不必先给他们讲道，只需要先给他们空间。

你不必先给他们答案，只需要先听见他们的声音。

你不必强迫他们回来，只需要让他们知道：

“你走多远，都有一个家在等你。”

真正能挽回下一代的，不只是策略，而是爱；不是方法，而是关系；不是活动，而是牧养。

四、结语：下一代不是问题，而是祝福

不要把下一代当作麻烦。他们是神托付给教会的礼物。

不要害怕他们的疑问，他们的疑问会让信仰更真实。

不要担心他们的不同，他们的不同会让教会更有创造力。

不要急着压制他们的声音，他们的声音能帮助教会更忠心地面对现实处境。

下一代不是一定要离开教会，他们只是在寻找一个配得上他们真实生命的教会。

愿我们建造这样的教会：有恩典，有深度，有温度，有真实，有关系，有使命。

愿他们回来，不是因为被要求，而是因为在这里，他们找到了被爱、被理解、被托住的地方。



When the Next Generation Leaves the Church How Do We Win Back Their Hearts?

“Pastor, my son no longer wants to go to church.”

“After my child went to college, he stopped believing altogether.”

“The young people in our small group are gone. Most of those left are middle-aged.”

In recent years, voices like these have been heard in many Chinese churches.

Studies around the world have shown that young adults between eighteen and twenty-nine are leaving churches at an unprecedented pace. This is not only a Chinese church problem, but it is clearly present among Chinese believers and overseas Chinese churches.

Why?

Because the world young people face today is completely different from the world many of us grew up in.

So an urgent question stands before every church: when the next generation leaves the church, how do we win back their hearts?

1. Why Young People Leave the Church

Many parents and churches assume young people leave because they are lazy, rebellious, or worldly.

But if we are willing to sit down and listen to the true voices of their hearts, we may discover that the reasons are much deeper.

First, they do not necessarily reject faith. They reject hypocrisy.

This generation may not be most sensitive to theological vocabulary, but it is deeply sensitive to authenticity.

They can tolerate imperfection, but they struggle to tolerate hypocrisy. When the church speaks of love while privately practicing competition, speaks of holiness while leaders hide serious problems, speaks of forgiveness while relationships remain cold, and speaks of grace while placing legalistic burdens on young people, they become disappointed quickly.

Young people may not leave because faith is unreal. They may leave because they cannot find a real life of faith.

Second, they feel the church cares about their behavior but not their hearts.

“Can I date?” “Can I play games?” “Can I talk about mental health?” “Can I doubt?”

When the church sees only outward performance and does not care for the inner life, young people feel controlled, judged, misunderstood, and labeled.

No young person wants to remain long in a place that constantly judges him.

Third, young people face enormous pressure but often do not receive enough support from the church.

Many young people do not leave because they have no faith. They leave because they are exhausted.

Academic pressure, workplace competition, identity anxiety, emotional instability, family tension, loneliness, anxiety, and depression can all weigh heavily on them.

They may not be unwilling to come. They may simply have no strength left to face people.

They may not be leaving faith. They may be crushed by life.

Fourth, church language is often disconnected from the world of young people.

Some pulpits still speak in the language of decades past, while young people live in a visual, digital, emotional, relational, globalized, fast-paced world.

When pastors and young people no longer share the same context, young people struggle to feel understood.

Fifth, they long to participate, not merely obey instructions.

Young people want to be heard, trusted, empowered, given creative space, and invited into decision-making.

If the church still functions only as “the older generation decides,” young people will struggle to feel belonging.

Sixth, many are not leaving faith itself. They are leaving an old model of church.

Many young people still respond positively to Jesus, but feel distant from the church.

They may not be rejecting God. They may be searching for a truer, deeper, more authentic way of discipleship.

2. How to Win Back Their Hearts

Winning back the next generation will not happen through more activities alone. It will require deeper love, more listening, and more authentic companionship.

First, give them a space where they can be real without being judged.

Young people do not only need Bible knowledge. They need a place where they can speak about pain, confusion, failure, sin, doubt, and struggle without being shamed or condemned.

When the church becomes such a place, they are more likely to stay.

Second, build intergenerational dialogue rather than intergenerational conflict.

What young people need most is not for older believers to understand every thought immediately, but for them to be willing to listen carefully.

Intergenerational communication is not, "I will tell you what you should do." It is, "I am willing to hear why you think this way."

Young people need listening as much as instruction.

Third, restore a church culture where relationships matter more than activities.

The church may not need more programs, but it will certainly need deeper relationships.

Young people need to feel: I am seen here. I am remembered. I am needed. I am loved. I am accepted.

Relationship is one of the church's strongest attractions for the next generation.

Fourth, empower them rather than merely assign tasks.

Young people are willing to serve, but they do not want to be treated only as labor.

They need participation, decision-making, creative space, trust, encouragement, and mentoring companionship.

They are not merely children. They are leaders being prepared.

Fifth, bring faith into daily life.

Young people need not only theological concepts. They need to know how faith helps them face pressure, handle emotions, build

relationships, be light at work, hear God in daily life, and live with inner abundance.

When faith speaks to reality, young people rediscover its value.

Sixth, the pulpit must become more honest, vulnerable, and real.

The next generation is not looking only for polished messages.

They are looking for truthful ones.

A vulnerable, honest, humble pulpit can reach the next generation more deeply than many perfect but distant sermons.

Seventh, invite young people into mission, not merely activities.

Young people are deeply sensitive to mission. They are willing to give their lives for something that matters.

If the church guides them into community care, concern for the vulnerable, short-term missions, cultural mission, and using their gifts to bless others, they may rediscover their place.

3. It Begins with One Question

The question is simple:

“Would you be willing to tell me what you are really struggling with?”

You do not have to preach to them first. You need to give them space.

You do not have to give them answers first. You need to hear their voices.

You do not have to force them to return. You need to let them know:

“No matter how far you go, there is still a home waiting for you.”

What truly wins back the next generation is not strategy, but love; not methods, but relationship; not activities, but pastoral care.

4. Conclusion: The Next Generation Is Not a Problem

Do not treat the next generation as a problem. They are a gift God has entrusted to the church.

Do not fear their questions. Their questions can make faith more real.

Do not fear their differences. Their differences can make the church more creative.

Do not rush to suppress their voices. Their voices can help the church face its real context more faithfully.

The next generation does not necessarily want to leave the church. They are looking for a church worthy of their real lives.

May we build such a church: full of grace, depth, warmth, authenticity, relationship, and mission.

May they return not because they are required to, but because here they find a place where they are loved, understood, and held.

第十六篇：家庭、教会与使命



“未来二十年中国信徒的三重身份与挑战”

一个信徒最真实的生活，常常不是发生在主日，而是发生在周一到周六。

他要面对家人的需要、教会的服事、职场的压力、孩子的教育、父母的照护，也要在各种现实责任中继续分辨神给他的呼召。

对于中国基督徒来说，未来的挑战不只是“如何参加教会”，而是如何在家庭、教会与使命之间活出一个整全的人。

因此，我们必须重新思考三个最核心的身份：家庭中的角色、教会中的位置、使命中的呼召。

这三者不是彼此分开的，而是深度交织、彼此支撑的三重身份。若其中任意一项失衡，信徒的生命、见证与呼召都可能受损。

一、家庭：信仰最真实的战场

接下来，家庭会是中国基督徒最真实、也最激烈的属灵战场之一。

家庭压力将比过去更重：婚姻稳定性降低，子女教育压力更大，老龄化带来照护负担，单亲家庭、丁克家庭、跨文化家庭增多，媒体与文化对家庭观的冲击也更明显。

家庭不再只是生活空间，更是价值观冲突与信仰决策的主战场。

信徒必须在家庭中操练三种核心能力。

第一是沟通的能力。不是辩论，而是倾听。

第二是疗愈的能力。先愿意让自己被神医治，才能真正安慰别人。

第三是舍己的能力。爱不是感觉，而是选择与行动。

如果信仰不能影响家庭，它就很难真正进入社会。

真正的复兴，不会只发生在讲台和活动中，也会发生在餐桌旁、客厅里和亲密关系中。

二、教会：信徒归属与成长的共同体

中国教会也会继续经历新的挑战。

第一，代际差异的张力会变大。

老一代习惯传统敬拜、层级结构和稳定模式；新一代重视自由、对话、情绪健康与科技融合；城市年轻人也更注重真实性，而不只是权威。

教会必须学习跨世代沟通、跨文化牧养和跨风格敬拜。

第二，教会的组织结构会被重新定义。

传统大型聚会模式会受到挑战，小组、家庭教会、线上线下结合的教会形态，也会持续发展。

教会不一定要更大，但必须更深。

最重要的问题不是：多少人参加？建了多大的堂？有多少节目？

而是：有没有真实的门徒？有没有生命的陪伴？有没有跨文化、跨阶层的共同体？受伤的人在这里是否可以安全地被医治？

第三，教会要成为情绪健康与灵命成长并行的地方。

心理压力、创伤、焦虑、失眠、关系破裂等议题，会比过去更普遍。

未来的教会若不能成为情绪安全的地方，就很难牧养未来的一代。

三、使命：信徒在世界中的存在方式

过去，许多人以为使命就是做宣教士、传道人、带查经。

使命需要被重新理解：它不是少数人的呼召，而是每一个信徒的生活方式。

信徒的使命，可能体现在许多领域。

家庭使命，是孩子的属灵养育。

职场使命，是成为诚信、温柔、有智慧的人。

邻里使命，是关怀社区、活出关系中的福音。

文化使命，是创造美，在写作、音乐、教育中见证神。

科技使命，是在 AI 时代守住人的价值。

跨文化使命，是海外华人拥有更广的平台与责任。

使命不只是“我去哪里”，而是“在神放我的地方，我活成谁”。

使命不一定高调，它常常是渗透式的忠心，像盐一样，像光一样，像基督的香气一样。

使命不在于影响全世界，而在于照亮你周围的一平方米。

最有影响力的基督徒，不一定是说得最响的人，而是活得更真实、最能陪伴破碎者、最能在黑暗中仍坚持温柔、最敢在压力中活出诚信、生命里真正有盼望、有勇气、有恩典的人。

他们不用宣告自己有使命，因为他们的生命本身就是使命。

四、三重身份之间的张力

我们都知道家庭、教会与使命重要，但现实的问题是：很难同时做好。

于是许多信徒陷入三种极端：在家庭忙碌到教会软弱，在教会热心到家庭破裂，在使命奔走到灵命枯竭。

关键不是更多，而是更整全。

家庭是根，教会是干，使命是果。顺序不能倒。若根没有供应，树干会枯；若树干不健康，果子也难以出现。

信徒需要新的属灵节奏：有家庭的时间，有安静祷告的时间，有小组共同体的时间，有自我更新的时间，也有外展与使命的时间。

你不能做所有事，但你可以做神托付你的事。

信徒也要学会：不急着成功，而急着忠心。

神不是呼召我们做大，而是呼召我们做真。

五、结语：路属于有深度的信徒

中国教会最需要的信徒，不是最忙的人、最能讲的人、最会办活动的人、最多才多艺的人、最追热点的人。

而是生命深的人，家庭稳的人，在教会扎根的人，有使命感的人，内心平安的人，温柔坚韧的人。

他们的生命会像安静的火，照亮家庭，温暖教会，也影响社会。

愿神预备，也愿祂兴起你，成为未来二十年中国教会所需要的人。



Family, Church, and Mission

The Threefold Identity and Challenge of Chinese Believers Today

The most honest life of a believer often does not happen on Sunday. It happens from Monday to Saturday.

A believer faces family needs, church service, workplace pressure, children's education, care for aging parents, and the need to discern God's calling amid many real responsibilities.

For Chinese Christians, the challenge is not only how to attend church, but how to live as whole people within family, church, and mission.

Therefore, we must rethink three core identities: our role in the family, our place in the church, and our calling in mission.

These three are not separate. They are deeply interwoven and mutually supporting. If any one of them becomes imbalanced, the believer's life, witness, and calling may suffer.

1. Family: The Most Real Battlefield of Faith

The family is one of the most real and intense spiritual battlefields for Chinese Christians.

Family pressure will become heavier: marriage stability may weaken, educational pressure on children may increase, aging will bring caregiving burdens, more families will be single-parent, child-free, or cross-cultural, and media and culture will continue to reshape views of family.

The family is no longer only a living space. It is a primary arena for value conflict and faith decisions.

Believers need to practice three core abilities in the family.

First, communication: not debate, but listening.

Second, healing: only those willing to be healed by God can truly comfort others.

Third, self-giving: love is not merely a feeling, but a choice and an action.

If faith cannot shape the family, it will struggle to enter society.

True renewal will not happen only from pulpits and programs. It will also happen around dining tables, in living rooms, and within intimate relationships.

2. Church: A Community of Belonging and Growth

Chinese churches will continue to face new challenges.

First, generational tensions will grow.

The older generation may be accustomed to traditional worship, hierarchical structures, and stable patterns. The younger generation often values freedom, dialogue, emotional health, and technological integration. Urban young adults often care deeply about authenticity, not merely authority.

The church must learn cross-generational communication, cross-cultural pastoral care, and worship across different styles.

Second, church structures will be redefined.

Traditional large-gathering models will be challenged. Small groups, house churches, and hybrid online-offline church forms will continue to develop.

The church does not necessarily have to be larger, but it must become deeper.

The most important questions will not be: How many people attend? How large is our building? How many programs do we have?

The deeper questions are: Are there real disciples? Is there life-giving companionship? Is there a community that crosses cultures and social levels? Can wounded people be safely healed here?

Third, the church must become a place where emotional health and spiritual growth walk together.

Psychological pressure, trauma, anxiety, insomnia, and broken relationships will become more common.

If the church cannot become an emotionally safe place, it will struggle to shepherd the next generation.

3. Mission: The Way Believers Exist in the World

In the past, many people thought mission meant becoming a missionary, pastor, or Bible study leader.

Mission must be understood more broadly. It is not the calling of a few, but the way of life for every believer.

The mission of believers may be expressed in many areas.

Family mission is the spiritual formation of children.

Workplace mission is becoming people of integrity, gentleness, and wisdom.

Neighborhood mission is caring for the community and embodying the gospel in relationships.

Cultural mission is creating beauty and bearing witness through writing, music, and education.

Technological mission is preserving human value in the age of AI.

Cross-cultural mission is the wider platform and responsibility given to overseas Chinese believers.

Mission is not only “Where should I go?” but “Who am I becoming in the place God has put me?”

Mission does not have to be loud. It is often quiet faithfulness that permeates like salt, light, and the fragrance of Christ.

Mission is not always about influencing the whole world. It begins by illuminating the square meter around you.

The most influential Christians may not be those who speak the loudest, but those who live most truthfully, accompany the broken, remain gentle in dark times, practice integrity under pressure, and carry genuine hope, courage, and grace.

They do not need to announce that they have a mission. Their lives are the mission.

4. The Tension Between the Three Identities

We all know that family, church, and mission matter. The real difficulty is living them together.

Many believers fall into one of three extremes: so busy with family that church life becomes weak; so devoted to church that family breaks down; so driven by mission that spiritual life dries up.

The key is not more, but greater wholeness.

Family is the root, church is the trunk, and mission is the fruit.

The order cannot be reversed. If the root is not nourished, the trunk withers. If the trunk is unhealthy, fruit will not appear.

Believers need a renewed spiritual rhythm: time for family, time for quiet prayer, time for small-group community, time for personal renewal, and time for outreach and mission.

You cannot do everything, but you can do what God has entrusted to you.

Believers must also learn not to be anxious for success, but eager for faithfulness.

God has not called us first to become big. He has called us to become true.

5. Conclusion: The Road Belongs to Deep Believers

Chinese churches will not most need the busiest believers, the most eloquent speakers, the best event organizers, the most talented people, or those who chase every trend.

It will need believers with deep lives, steady families, roots in the church, a clear sense of mission, inner peace, and gentle resilience.

Their lives will be like a quiet fire, bringing light to families, warmth to churches, and faithful influence to society.

May God prepare and raise you up to become the kind of person Chinese churches will need.

第十七篇：教会的未来不是规模，而是深度



“新时代信徒的共同使命”

一间教会开会时，最容易被问到的问题常常是：主日有多少人？小组有多少组？年度奉献多少？活动有多少参与者？场地够不够大？线上观看多少？

数字当然有意义，但数字从来无法完全表达一个教会的生命力。因为在圣经里，神从未单单用人数作为衡量教会标准。

一个真正强大、稳固、活泼、有见证的教会，不只是人数多，而是生命深。

教会若要穿越压力，就需要一种更深的生命生态。这个生态的核心，不再只是规模，而是深度。

一、为什么教会必须走向深度

第一，处境越来越复杂，表面的信仰撑不住了。

过去也许靠传统、文化、习惯和活动，就能维持教会运转；但今天已经不够了。家庭结构改变、单身人口增多、情绪问题上升、职场压力倍增，信仰环境也更不稳定，青年一代对形式极度敏感。

一个浅层、忙活动、却不关注生命的教会，将难以牧养这样的处境。

第二，新一代信徒不缺节目，缺真实。

他们更愿意问：“我在这里能找到真实的关系吗？这里的人愿意听我的挣扎吗？我能在这里做真实的自己吗？这里的人是否真的活出信仰？”

他们不缺内容，他们缺真诚。

第三，没有深度，教会难以承受压力。

教会会面对更大的流动性、更明显的代际差异、更激烈的价值冲突、更紧张的生活节奏，以及更沉重的情绪与心理压力。

浅层的信仰无法承受这些风暴。

二、什么是教会的深度

深度不是玄学，而是教会的核心能力。

第一，深度属灵。

教会要懂得祷告、敬拜、寻求神的同在。不是表面灵修，而是在苦难中会祷告，在迷茫中懂得安静，在选择面前能分辨，在疲惫中能更新。

深度属灵不是更激动，而是更稳固。

第二，深度关系。

真正的教会不是只聚会的地方，而是可以哭、可以讲失败、可以承认软弱、不会被定罪、不会被拒绝、有人陪伴生命的群体。

有深度关系的教会像医院；没有关系的教会容易像商场。

第三，深度门徒。

门徒训练不能只靠课程、项目、任务、表格和考试，而要靠陪伴、分享、祷告、一起经历神、一起走人生的路。

门徒不是只讲出来的，也是陪出来的。

第四，深度医治。

信徒会面对焦虑、抑郁、关系失衡、家庭破碎、职场压力、自我怀疑和童年创伤。

如果教会不能成为安全之地，许多人就会到世界寻找看似的医治。

第五，深度使命。

使命不是活动，而是生活方式。

信徒要学会在家庭中活出信仰，在职场中活出诚信，在文化中活出美善，在网络中活出影响力，在邻里中活出温柔与关怀。

当教会有深度使命，世界会因教会而看见天国的影子。

三、有生命力的教会有哪些标志

第一，讲台是真实的，不是表演的。讲道不是为了取悦、控制或煽动，而是用神的话更新生命。

第二，小组是温暖的，不是形式的。一个好的小组，可以改变一个人的生命方向。

第三，牧养是有陪伴的，不是行政化的。牧者不是经理，牧者是同行者。

第四，关系是诚实的，不只是礼貌的。礼貌让人保持距离，诚实让人走进彼此心里。

第五，信仰是落地的，不是抽象的。它能帮助信徒面对婚姻、育儿、情绪、金钱、压力和呼召。

第六，教会是开放的，不是封闭的。不怕问题，不怕不同，不怕困难，不怕挑战。

一个开放而有根基的教会，不会轻易萎缩。

四、深度从哪里开始

中国教会的复兴，不会只靠建大教堂、做盛大活动、用华丽节目、吸引更多人或邀请更厉害的讲员。

真正的复兴，来自深度的祷告、深度的关系、深度的门徒、深度的爱和深度的生命。

深度，是教会穿越风浪的力量。

而深度不是等教会先做，而是从每一个信徒开始。

当每一个信徒愿意更诚实、更温柔、更稳固、更愿意陪伴、更愿意倾听、更愿意爱、更愿意活出真实信仰，整个教会就会变得有深度。

五、结语：教会因深度而被托住

中国教会将经历挑战、变化、压力和重塑。但这不只是危机，也是神给教会的邀请。

不要只追求规模，要追求深度。不要只追求扩张，要追求扎根。不要只追求表面成功，要追求生命丰盛。

因为当一个教会足够深，它就不容易被风浪吹倒，也不容易被环境吞没。

愿我们成为这样的教会：深深扎根于基督，深深连接彼此，也深深拥抱世界。

让深度成为信徒的共同使命，也让教会因深度而发光。



The Future of the Church Is Depth, Not Size A Shared Mission for Believers in a New Age

In church meetings, the easiest questions to ask are often numerical: How many people attend on Sunday? How many small groups do we have? How much was given this year? How many joined the event? Is the building large enough? How many watched online?

Numbers matter, but numbers can never fully express the life of a church. In Scripture, God never measures the church by numbers alone.

A truly strong, steady, living, and faithful church is not only large in attendance. It is deep in life.

If the church is to endure pressure, it needs a deeper life together. The heart of that life is not size, but depth.

1. Why the Church Must Move Toward Depth

First, our context is becoming more complex, and surface-level faith cannot stand.

In the past, tradition, culture, habit, and activities may have been enough to keep church life moving. But that is no longer enough. Family structures are changing, single adults are

increasing, emotional struggles are rising, workplace pressure is growing, the faith environment is less stable, and younger generations are highly sensitive to empty forms.

A shallow church that is busy with activities but inattentive to life will struggle to shepherd such a context.

Second, the next generation does not need more programs as much as it needs reality.

They are asking: Can I find real relationships here? Are people willing to hear my struggles? Can I be honest here? Do these people actually live out their faith?

They do not lack content. They lack sincerity.

Third, without depth, the church cannot bear pressure.

Churches will face greater mobility, sharper generational differences, stronger value conflicts, faster social rhythms, and heavier emotional and psychological pressure.

Shallow faith cannot withstand these storms.

2. What Depth Means

Depth is not mystical. It is the core capacity of the church.

First, spiritual depth.

The church must know how to pray, worship, and seek God's presence. This is not surface devotion, but the ability to pray in suffering, be still in confusion, discern in decisions, and be renewed in weariness.

Spiritual depth is not more excitement. It is greater steadiness.

Second, relational depth.

The church is not merely a place of meetings. It is a community where people can weep, speak of failure, admit weakness, avoid condemnation, receive welcome, and be accompanied in life.

A church with deep relationships is like a hospital. A church without relationships can become like a shopping mall.

Third, disciple-making depth.

Discipleship cannot depend only on classes, programs, tasks, forms, and tests. It must depend on companionship, sharing, prayer, experiencing God together, and walking through life together.

Disciples are not only taught. They are accompanied.

Fourth, healing depth.

Believers will face anxiety, depression, relational imbalance, family brokenness, workplace pressure, self-doubt, and childhood wounds.

If the church cannot become a safe place, many will seek healing elsewhere.

Fifth, missional depth.

Mission is not an activity. It is a way of life.

Believers must learn to live faith in the family, integrity in the workplace, goodness in culture, influence online, and gentleness and care in the neighborhood.

When a church has missional depth, the world sees a glimpse of the kingdom.

3. Marks of a Church with Life

First, the pulpit is real, not performative. Preaching is not for pleasing, controlling, or stirring people up, but for renewing life through the Word of God.

Second, small groups are warm, not formal. A good small group can change the direction of a life.

Third, pastoral care is relational, not merely administrative. A pastor is not a manager. A pastor is a companion.

Fourth, relationships are honest, not merely polite. Politeness can keep distance. Honesty opens the heart.

Fifth, faith is practical, not abstract. It helps believers face marriage, parenting, emotions, money, pressure, and calling.

Sixth, the church is open, not closed. It is not afraid of questions, differences, difficulties, or challenges.

A church that is both open and rooted will not wither easily.

4. Where Depth Begins

The renewal of the Chinese church will not come only through large buildings, grand events, impressive programs, bigger crowds, or famous speakers.

True renewal comes through deep prayer, deep relationships, deep discipleship, deep love, and deep life.

Depth is the power that carries the church through storms.
And depth does not begin only when the church as an institution changes. It begins with each believer.

When believers become more honest, gentle, steady, willing to accompany, willing to listen, willing to love, and willing to live out real faith, the whole church becomes deeper.

5. Conclusion: The Church Will Be Held by Depth

The Chinese church will face challenges, change, pressure, and reshaping. But this is not only a crisis. It is also an invitation from God.

Do not pursue size alone. Pursue depth. Do not pursue expansion alone. Pursue rootedness. Do not pursue visible success alone. Pursue abundant life.

When a church is deep enough, it will not easily be blown down by storms or swallowed by its environment.

May we become such a church: deeply rooted in Christ, deeply connected to one another, and deeply present in the world.

May depth become the shared mission of believers, and may the church shine because of it.

第十八篇：中国教会的未来领袖



“什么样的人能在新世代中站立得住”

我常常想，一个年轻传道人若在今天开始服事，他最需要的是什么呢？

不是更响亮的麦克风，也不只是更完整的履历，而是一种能够在压力、变化、误解和孤独中仍然站稳的生命。

教会最迫切需要的，不是明星讲员，不是组织高手，不是节目导演，甚至不只是拥有头衔的人。

中国教会最需要的，是能在新世代中站立得住的领袖。

什么样的人能在这个时代站住？什么样的领袖能引领未来的中国教会？

以下这些特质，是未来领袖的属灵骨骼、生命纹理与牧养底气。

一、有根的人

外部环境越动荡，越显明一个领袖的根扎在哪里。

未来真正能站住的领袖，不靠情绪，不靠热闹，不被舆论摆布，不被趋势吸引，而是在祷告、圣经和稳定灵性中有安静的内在世界。

这个时代需要的不是舞台领袖，而是属灵根基稳得像磐石的人。

二、温柔的人

温柔常被误解为软弱，但在圣经中，温柔是被神驯服的力量。

未来的领袖必须有权柄却不压人，有力量却不伤人，有真理却不硬心，有影响力却仍愿意洗脚。

温柔不是缺乏能力，而是能力因为爱而被限制、净化和使用。

三、真诚透明的人

新时代的人最痛恨伪装，也最渴望真实。

未来的领袖必须能承认自己的软弱，分享自己的故事，对自己诚实，对别人坦白，让人看见一个真实的人，而不是宗教包装出来的形象。

真实能吸引人，伪装只能暂时取悦人。

真正能建立教会的领袖，永远是真诚的人。

四、理解新世代的人

教会不可能回到过去。

未来的领袖需要理解年轻人的语言、数字时代的沟通方式、心理健康的需要、家庭结构的新趋势、文化多元带来的张力，以及城市节奏对灵性的影响。

这不是为了迎合时代，而是为了在时代中牧养人心。

五、耐心的人

现代人焦虑，要快、要效果、要增长、要结果。

但属灵生命从来都不是快的。

未来的领袖需要对门徒训练有耐心，对软弱者有耐心，对破碎者有耐心，对教会成长有耐心，对自己的生命也有耐心。

耶稣用了三年半训练十二个门徒。领袖必须相信：深度比速度更重要。

六、健康的人

不健康的领袖，很难带出健康的教会。

未来的领袖必须学习休息，学习处理情绪，拥有相对稳定的家庭关系，有成熟的自我认知，不把压力发泄在会众身上，也不把服事变成身份依赖。

健康不是奢侈品，而是领袖的基本装备。

七、心胸宽的人

中国教会未来一定会更加多元：不同神学背景、不同敬拜风格、不同文化气质、不同地区与海外互动、不同年龄层融合。

未来的领袖必须胸怀宽广，不排斥不同，不害怕差异，不仇视新事物，不嫉妒同行，也不坚持“只有我对”。

胸怀越宽，神能托付的越多。

八、会牧养的人

未来的牧养不是活动，而是生命相伴。

它包括疗愈关系、灵魂倾听、牧者型陪伴、心理与灵性的整合、弱者优先，也包括把小组建成生命共同体，而不是课程小班。

未来真正的领袖，是会陪人走过谷底的人。

九、有智慧的人

未来环境复杂，信息真假难辨，情绪传播迅速，社会舆论敏感，教会内部差异也会增加。

未来的领袖需要属灵智慧：什么时候说，什么时候不说；什么时候推进，什么时候安静；什么时候保护羊，什么时候教育羊。

智慧，是比知识更高的属灵恩赐。

十、有使命感的人

真正能在新时代站立的人，都是有使命感的人。

他们不因压力而沉默，不因不确定而退缩，不因复杂环境而迷失，不因孤单而丢掉呼召，也不因疲惫而放弃羊群。

使命是领袖最后的力量。当所有外在光环都被拿走，真正支撑人的，是那句：“主啊，我愿意。”

十一、愿意被塑造的人

未来环境不会容易，但也正是磨练领袖的土壤。

未来的领袖必须愿意经历破碎、熬炼、误解、软弱、等待和盼望。

破碎不是失败，而是在打造更大的器皿。

十二、有爱的人

最有影响力的领袖，不一定是最会讲道的人，而是最会爱的人。

这个时代的人怕被拒绝、怕被否定、怕被操控、怕被遗弃、怕被标签。

领袖最大的力量，就是爱：能拥抱、能陪伴、能接纳、能守候、能医治，能给人回家的感觉。

有能力的领袖会吸引人，但有大爱的人能改变人。

结语：未来属于有深度、有温度、有根基、有爱的人

中国教会未来的领袖，不一定是最会营销、最会搞活动、最有资源或最有头衔的人。

未来属于有深度、有根、有爱、有使命、有恩典、能站住、能陪伴、能哭也能祷告的人。

教会需要这样的牧者，时代也等待这样的人出现。

愿神预备并兴起他们，可能就在你我之中。



Future Leaders of the Chinese Church

What Kind of People Can Stand in a New Generation?

I often wonder what a young minister beginning service today needs most.

Not a louder microphone, and not merely a stronger resume, but a life that can stand firm amid pressure, change, misunderstanding, and loneliness.

The church's most urgent need is not celebrity speakers, organizational experts, program directors, or even people with impressive titles.

Chinese churches need leaders who can stand firm in this generation.

What kind of people can stand under pressure? What kind of leaders can guide Chinese churches forward?

The following qualities form the spiritual backbone, life texture, and pastoral substance of the leaders we need.

1. Rooted People

The more unstable the outside environment becomes, the more clearly it reveals where a leader's roots are.

Leaders who can stand will not depend on emotion, excitement, public opinion, or trends. They will have a quiet inner world rooted in prayer, Scripture, and steady spirituality.

This generation does not need stage personalities as much as people whose spiritual roots are firm like rock.

2. Gentle People

Gentleness is often misunderstood as weakness, but in Scripture gentleness is strength submitted to God.

Such leaders must have authority without crushing others, strength without wounding others, truth without hardness of heart, and influence while still being willing to wash feet.

Gentleness is not the absence of ability. It is ability restrained, purified, and used by love.

3. Honest and Transparent People

People today quickly recognize pretense and long for what is real.

Leaders must be able to acknowledge weakness, share their stories, be honest with themselves, be open with others, and allow people to see a real human being rather than a religious image.

Authenticity draws people. Pretense only pleases temporarily. The leaders who truly build the church will always be sincere.

4. People Who Understand the New Generation

The church cannot return to the past.

Leaders must understand the language of young people, communication in digital culture, mental-health needs, new patterns in family life, the tension of cultural plurality, and the impact of urban pace on spirituality.

This is not about conforming to culture. It is about shepherding hearts within it.

5. Patient People

Modern people are anxious for speed, results, growth, and visible outcomes.

But spiritual life is never fast.

Leaders need patience in discipleship, patience with the weak, patience with the wounded, patience with church growth, and patience with their own lives.

Jesus spent three and a half years training twelve disciples.

Leaders must believe that depth matters more than speed.

6. Healthy People

Unhealthy leaders struggle to build healthy churches.

Leaders must learn to rest, handle emotions, maintain relatively stable family relationships, grow in self-awareness, avoid placing their pressure on the congregation, and refuse to turn ministry into an identity addiction.

Health is not a luxury. It is basic equipment for leadership.

7. Broad-Hearted People

Chinese churches will be increasingly diverse: different theological backgrounds, worship styles, cultural temperaments, regions, overseas connections, and age groups.

Leaders must have broad hearts. They must not reject difference, fear diversity, despise new things, envy co-laborers, or insist that only they are right.

The broader the heart, the more God can entrust.

8. People Who Know How to Shepherd

Pastoral ministry is not merely activity, but shared life.

It includes healing relationships, listening to souls, pastoral companionship, integrating psychological and spiritual care, prioritizing the weak, and turning small groups into life communities rather than small classrooms.

True leaders know how to walk with people through valleys.

9. Wise People

The environment will remain complex: false and true information are difficult to distinguish, emotions spread quickly, public opinion is sensitive, and internal church differences increase.

Leaders need spiritual wisdom: when to speak and when not to speak, when to move forward and when to be still, when to protect the sheep and when to teach them.

Wisdom is a spiritual gift higher than knowledge.

10. People with Calling

Those who can stand are people with a sense of calling.

They do not become silent because of pressure, retreat because of uncertainty, lose their way in complexity, abandon calling because of loneliness, or give up the flock because of weariness.

Calling is the final strength of a leader. When every external honor is removed, what remains is the prayer: "Lord, I am willing."

11. People Willing to Be Formed

The road ahead will not be easy, but it can become soil for forming leaders.

Leaders must be willing to experience brokenness, refining, misunderstanding, weakness, waiting, and hope.

Brokenness is not failure. It is the making of a larger vessel.

12. People of Love

The most influential leaders are not always the best speakers, but those who love most deeply.

People today fear rejection, denial, control, abandonment, and labels.

The greatest power of a leader is love: the ability to embrace, accompany, receive, wait, heal, and make people feel they have come home.

Capable leaders may attract people, but loving leaders can change people.

Conclusion: The Road Belongs to Deep, Warm, Rooted, Loving People

The leaders Chinese churches need may not be the best marketers, event organizers, resource gatherers, or title holders.

The road belongs to people with depth, roots, love, calling, grace, steadiness, companionship, and the ability to weep and pray.

The church needs such pastors. This generation needs such people.

May God prepare and raise them up, perhaps among us.

第十九篇：在焦虑时代牧养人心



“教会如何成为真正的避风港”

有些人来到教会时，脸上带着笑，心里却已经很累。

他可能刚刚经历一周的职场压力，可能正在为孩子担忧，可能为经济、婚姻、身份、健康或未来感到不安。

焦虑不一定大声出现，它常常像一层看不见的雾，慢慢压在人的心上。

在这种时代背景下，教会不是旁观者，而是牧养者、陪伴者、安慰者，应该成为真正的避风港。

避风港不是一个常用的神学术语，却很贴近圣经给教会的使命：困苦的、疲乏的、流离的、伤心的、害怕的、迷惘的，都可以在这里得安息。

教会要如何在焦虑时代牧养人心？以下六个维度，是时代给教会的呼召。

一、以倾听开始牧养

焦虑时代最大的痛，是没有人听。

人们在网络上喊，在社交中笑，在心里哭，却缺少一个真正可以倾诉的地方。

许多教会的问题，是太快给答案，太快讲真理，太快做评判，却太少聆听。

一个真正能治愈焦虑的教会，会听人的倾诉，而不是立刻告诉他该怎么做；听人的痛，而不是只说“要坚强”；听人的困惑，而不是马上说“你缺乏信心”；听人的故事，而不是先检查他的属灵表现。

倾听，是疗愈的起点。它让人感觉到：“我被看见了，我不是孤单的。”

在这样的空间里，焦虑才有机会慢慢松开。

二、用福音，而不是鸡汤，牧养受伤的灵魂

焦虑时代，人最怕的不是问题本身，而是找不到意义。

许多心理困境的深层，不只是事件本身，而是心里缺少一个稳固的价值支点。

焦虑不告诉你你从哪里来，但福音告诉你你是谁。忧虑不告诉你明天如何，但福音告诉你谁掌管明天。世界说：“靠自己撑住。”福音说：“你不必独自撑住，神与你同在。”

鸡汤只能安慰几秒钟，福音却能改变人的生命方向。

健康的教会不是积极思考训练班，而是以福音为根的灵魂诊所。

三、在真实中牧养，而不是期待完美

焦虑时代最怕完美主义。

有些教会无形中强化这种压力：要属灵、要喜乐、要坚强、要祷告多、要每次聚会都热情、要信心从不摇摆、要生活井然有序。

但真实的人生并不是这样。

焦虑时代的牧养，要告诉人：基督徒可以软弱，可以悲伤，可以害怕，可以陷入低谷，可以哭，也可以需要帮助。

耶稣从未要求完美的人来到祂面前，祂接纳破碎的人。

教会也必须如此。一个能让人做真实自己的教会，才可能医治人心。

四、建立同伴关系

焦虑的根本放大器，是孤独。

圣经从不让人独自面对风浪。摩西有亚伦和户珥，大卫有约拿单，保罗有提摩太，初代教会有团契，耶稣也差门徒两个人一同出去。

健康的教会要重建关系结构：双人同行、小组支持、生命敞开、实际帮助、情绪陪伴和灵里守望。

当一个人在焦虑中知道“我不是一个人，我有人同行”，他就已经得到了很大的力量。

五、在教会文化中注入恩典

焦虑时代的人最怕被评价、失败、否定。

许多人的焦虑并非只来自事件，也来自自我价值的不稳定。

若教会只强调做得更好、服事更多、表现更属灵、更像标准答案，教会就可能变成压力制造机。

真正避风港式的教会，会让人感受到：你不需要表演，你可以慢慢来，你可以从破碎开始，神爱你不是因为你做对了，而是因为你是祂所爱的孩子。我们接纳你，即便你仍在挣扎；我们不会轻易离开你。

恩典，是焦虑最强的解药之一。

六、用属灵节奏取代焦虑节奏

焦虑时代的节奏是快、乱、杂、高压和不断刺激。

教会要帮助信徒建立缓、稳、深、有根、有节奏的灵性结构。

例如稳定的祷告节奏、有节奏的读经、安静操练、灵修默想、每周一次的安息更新、小组陪伴、心灵对话和有计划的属灵成长路径。

外在环境不一定立刻改变，但内在节奏可以改变人如何面对环境。

当一个人的属灵节奏稳定，他的情绪就不容易被外界牵走。

结语：让教会成为风暴中的灯塔

焦虑时代对教会的要求，不是更多活动，而是更多陪伴；不是更强组织，而是更深生命；不是更响亮的声音，而是更温柔的力量。

教会不是逃避压力的地方，而是人在面对压力时重新得力的地方。

愿新时代的教会成为痛苦者的家、孤独者的港湾、焦虑者的安息、破碎者的医院、软弱者的盾牌、寻找意义者的灯塔。

世界需要的不是更多声音，而是更多爱；不是更多指责，而是更多陪伴；不是更多教训，而是更多恩典。

愿神让我们成为这样的教会：风暴未必立刻平息，但船已经稳；时代仍然嘈杂，但心已经有安息。



Pastoring Hearts in an Age of Anxiety How the Church Can Become a True Harbor

Some people come to church with smiles on their faces, while their hearts are already exhausted.

They may have just endured a week of workplace pressure. They may be worried about their children. They may be carrying anxiety about finances, marriage, identity, health, or the future. Anxiety does not always appear loudly. It often comes like an unseen fog, slowly pressing upon the heart.

In a world like this, the church is not a spectator. It is called to shepherd, accompany, and comfort. It should become a true harbor.

Harbor may not be a formal theological term, but it reflects the mission Scripture gives to the church: the burdened, weary, wandering, grieving, afraid, and confused may find rest here.

How can the church shepherd anxious hearts? The following six dimensions are part of the church's calling.

1. Begin Pastoral Care with Listening

One of the deepest pains of anxiety is the sense that no one is listening.

People shout online, smile socially, and cry inwardly, yet lack a place where they can truly speak.

Many churches give answers too quickly, speak truth too quickly, judge too quickly, and listen too little.

A church that helps heal anxiety listens before telling people what to do. It hears pain before saying, “Be strong.” It hears confusion before saying, “You lack faith.” It listens to the story before checking spiritual performance.

Listening is the beginning of healing. It tells people, “I am seen. I am not alone.”

In such a space, anxiety can begin to loosen.

2. Shepherd Wounded Souls with the Gospel, Not Sentimental Advice

What anxious people often fear most is not only the problem itself, but meaninglessness.

Many psychological struggles are rooted not only in events, but in the absence of a stable center of value.

Anxiety does not tell you where you come from, but the gospel tells you who you are. Worry does not tell you what tomorrow holds, but the gospel tells you who holds tomorrow. The world says, “Hold yourself together.” The gospel says, “You do not have to hold yourself together alone. God is with you.”

Sentimental advice comforts for a few seconds. The gospel reorients a life.

A healthy church is not a positive-thinking center. It is a clinic of the soul rooted in the gospel.

3. Shepherd in Reality, Not Perfection

Anxious hearts are especially wounded by perfectionism.

Some churches unintentionally intensify this pressure: be spiritual, be joyful, be strong, pray more, be enthusiastic at every gathering, never waver in faith, keep life orderly.

But real life is not like that.

Pastoral care must tell people that Christians can be weak, sad, afraid, low, tearful, and in need of help.

Jesus never demanded that perfect people come to Him. He received the broken.

The church must do the same.

A church where people can be real is a church where hearts can be healed.

4. Build Companionship

Loneliness is one of the great amplifiers of anxiety.

Scripture does not leave people alone in storms. Moses had Aaron and Hur. David had Jonathan. Paul had Timothy. The early church had fellowship. Jesus sent His disciples out two by two.

A healthy church rebuilds relational structures: walking in pairs, small-group support, open lives, practical help, emotional companionship, and spiritual watchfulness.

When a person in anxiety knows, “I am not alone; someone is walking with me,” great strength has already been given.

5. Fill the Church Culture with Grace

Anxious people often fear judgment, failure, and rejection.

Much anxiety comes not only from events, but from unstable self-worth.

If the church only says, “Do better, serve more, appear more spiritual, fit the standard,” it may become a machine that produces pressure.

A harbor-like church communicates: you do not need to perform; you may grow slowly; you may begin from brokenness; God loves you not because you have done everything right, but because you are His beloved child. We receive you even while you struggle. We will not easily leave you.

Grace is one of the strongest medicines for anxiety.

6. Replace Anxious Rhythms with Spiritual Rhythms

The rhythm around us is fast, scattered, noisy, pressured, and overstimulated.

The church must help believers build spiritual structures that are slow, steady, deep, rooted, and rhythmic.

This may include stable rhythms of prayer, Scripture reading, silence, devotion and meditation, weekly rest, small-group companionship, conversations of the heart, and intentional pathways of spiritual growth.

The outer environment may not change immediately, but inner rhythm changes how people face the environment.

When a person's spiritual rhythm becomes steady, emotions are less easily pulled away by the world.

Conclusion: Let the Church Become a Lighthouse in the Storm

An anxious world does not need the church to offer more activities as much as more companionship, stronger organization as much as deeper life, or louder voices as much as gentler strength.

The church is not a place to escape pressure, but a place where people regain strength to face pressure.

May the church become a home for the hurting, a harbor for the lonely, rest for the anxious, a hospital for the broken, a shield for the weak, and a lighthouse for those searching for meaning.

The world needs not more noise, but more love; not more accusation, but more companionship; not more lectures, but more grace.

May God make us such a church: the storm may not have stopped, but the boat is steady; the world may still be noisy, but the heart has found rest.

第二十篇：当教会进入新时代



“中国教会的挑战与机会”

许多牧者都有类似的感受：过去熟悉的方法还没有完全失效，却已经不再足够；新的牧养格局正在出现，却还没有完全成形。

教会像站在十字路口，一边是压力，一边是机会；一边是危机，一边是盼望。

我们需要从牧养、文化、社会 and 属灵的角度，重新梳理中国教会当前面对的主要挑战，也看见其中隐藏的机会。

愿这成为时代中的提醒、鼓励与引导。

一、十个挑战

第一，社会快速变化，信徒的属灵结构不够稳定。

现代人的压力巨大：事业、家庭、孩子教育、人际关系、经济焦虑，都在不断挤压人的内心。许多信徒的信仰结构并不稳固，容易被现实压垮，也容易被文化裹挟。

第二，年轻人文化断层与流失。

年轻人更独立、更多元、更敏感，也更孤独。他们需要新的牧养方式、语言系统和属灵养分。但许多教会仍停留在原来的模式里，使年轻人找不到归属感。

第三，牧者压力巨大，却缺乏支持系统。

牧者承担灵命牧养、行政管理、家庭压力、心理负担和外部挑战，却往往最孤独、最疲惫、也最缺乏支持。

第四，神学根基薄弱，信徒分辨力不足。

资讯时代里，各种看似属灵的内容满天飞：鸡汤、励志、情绪化表达、断章取义、伪福音。若没有神学根基，信徒容易被情绪带走，而不是被真理带领。

第五，教会文化与现代社会脱节。

职场人、留学生、单亲家庭、文化多元背景者、跨文化婚姻、心理创伤者，都提出新的牧养需要。许多教会还缺乏充分准备和工具。

第六，门徒训练弱化，信徒成长断层。

许多教会重聚会，却轻生命；重人数，却轻根基；重活动，却轻门徒形成。结果是信徒多，门徒少；热情多，根基浅。

第七，城市化与流动性带来挑战。

移动时代让教会稳定性变弱，连接性变弱，持续牧养变难，群体认同感降低。城市更新的速度，常常超过教会牧养结构更新的速度。

第八，家庭问题加剧，对教会提出新的需要。

婚姻破裂、代沟冲突、孩子心理健康、教育压力，都已经进入牧养现场。但许多教会仍缺乏系统化的家庭事工。

第九，教会内部多元观点产生张力。

代际差异、神学差异、风格差异、敬拜形式差异、管理方式差异，都可能成为教会内部的压力来源。

第十，时代整体的不确定性。

经济、就业、社会心理、文化冲突，让整个社会的稳定性下降。不确定性会直接影响信徒的情绪、生活与信仰。

二、十个机会

看似挑战重重，但危机往往也是更新的契机。破碎之处，常常就是光照进来的窗口。

第一，信徒更渴望真实、深度、健康的属灵生命。

现代人比过去更清楚地知道，空洞的信仰不能支持生活，浅层的灵性不能面对压力。这是呼唤深度牧养的时代。

第二，年轻人渴望意义、价值与归属。

年轻人不是天然拒绝信仰，他们拒绝的是表面的属灵。他们渴望真诚的群体、可对话的牧养、有根基的真理和有温度的爱。教会若愿意调整，就会看见新一代复兴的可能。

第三，牧者压力也促使教会建立更健康的支持系统。

教会会逐渐明白：牧者不是超人，牧者也需要被牧养。健康牧者，才能建立健康教会。

第四，神学教育的需求激增。

许多信徒开始更认真读经、查经、学习神学、参加课程和系统化装备。对真理的渴求，是宝贵的属灵现象。

第五，心理学与牧养结合成为趋势。

在心理危机高发时代，基督教辅导、灵命修复、情绪牧养，会成为未来教会重要方向。

第六，门徒训练将成为新的共识。

教会开始意识到，没有门徒训练，就没有真正的教会。下一波复兴，不会只靠活动，而要靠生命带生命的深度同行。

第七，线上线下结合，让教会可以触及更多人。

线上平台使福音可以进入外地、海外、异地职场、行动受限者，也能接触那些暂时不敢走进教会却愿意先线上观察的人。

第八，家庭危机让教会在社会中更具价值。

社会的破碎，使教会有机会成为情绪避风港、婚姻重建场、家庭支持系统和心灵复健中心。

危机越大，牧养的门也越大。

第九，多元文化让教会更开放、更包容。

社会越多元、流动、复杂，教会越需要学习灵活、开放、跨文化、跨地域、跨群体。这会让教会更接近圣经中万民教会的样式。

第十，不确定性会让更多人寻找永恒。

时代越动荡，人越寻找稳固根基；社会越迷茫，人越寻找永恒意义；世界越不确定，福音越显得宝贵。

不确定性本身，也可能成为宣教土壤。

三、结语：最艰难的时代，也可能是神动工的时代

中国教会正在走入关键时期。

这是压力与机会并存的时代，也是神要更新祂教会的时代。

未来中国教会的力量，不在外在资源、场地规模或活动多少，而在信徒生命的深度、牧者团队的健康、真理教导的扎实、门徒训练的持续、团契关系的真实、爱的文化是否根深蒂固，以及对社会的温柔影响、对时代的智慧回应。

愿中国教会不惧挑战，抓住机会，在新时代成为真正的光与盐。

愿神让祂的教会更深、更稳、更柔、更强，更爱、更真、更自由、更有盼望。

这是新的起点，不是结束；是复兴的黎明，不是衰退的夜晚。



The Church in a New Era

Challenges and Opportunities for the Chinese Church

Many pastors share a similar feeling: familiar methods have not completely failed, but they are no longer sufficient. New patterns of ministry are emerging, but they have not yet fully taken shape. The church stands at a crossroads, facing pressure and opportunity, crisis and hope.

We need to examine the current challenges and hidden opportunities of the Chinese church from pastoral, cultural, social, and spiritual perspectives.

May this become a reminder, encouragement, and guide for this moment.

1. Ten Challenges

First, society is changing rapidly, while the spiritual structure of many believers is not stable enough.

Modern life brings enormous pressure: career, family, children's education, relationships, and economic anxiety. Many believers

do not have a stable structure of faith and are easily crushed by reality or carried along by culture.

Second, there is a cultural gap and loss among young people.

Young people are more independent, plural, sensitive, and lonely.

They need new forms of pastoral care, new language, and spiritual nourishment. Many churches remain in old patterns, leaving young people without a sense of belonging.

Third, pastors carry heavy pressure but often lack support systems.

Pastors bear spiritual care, administration, family pressure, emotional burdens, and external challenges. Yet they are often among the loneliest, most tired, and least supported people.

Fourth, theological foundations are weak, and discernment is insufficient.

In the information age, many things appear spiritual: sentimental inspiration, emotional expression, verses taken out of context, and false gospels. Without theological grounding, believers are easily led by emotion rather than truth.

Fifth, church culture can become disconnected from modern society.

Professionals, international students, single-parent families, people from diverse cultural backgrounds, cross-cultural marriages, and those with psychological wounds all bring new pastoral needs. Many churches are not yet prepared with sufficient tools.

Sixth, discipleship is weakened, and spiritual growth is fragmented.

Many churches emphasize meetings over life, numbers over foundation, and activities over disciple formation. The result is many believers, but fewer disciples; much enthusiasm, but shallow roots.

Seventh, urbanization and mobility create new challenges.

In a mobile age, church stability weakens, connection weakens, long-term pastoral care becomes harder, and group identity

declines. The speed of urban change often exceeds the speed of pastoral adaptation.

Eighth, family problems are increasing and demanding new church responses.

Marital breakdown, generational conflict, children's mental health, and educational pressure have all entered the field of pastoral care. Many churches still lack systematic family ministry.

Ninth, internal diversity creates tension within the church.

Generational, theological, stylistic, worship, and governance differences can all become sources of internal pressure.

Tenth, uncertainty has become a defining reality.

Economics, employment, social psychology, and cultural conflict reduce social stability. Uncertainty directly affects believers' emotions, lives, and faith.

2. Ten Opportunities

The challenges are many, but crisis often becomes the doorway to renewal. Broken places are often where light enters.

First, believers long for real, deep, healthy spiritual life.

Modern people know more clearly than before that empty faith cannot sustain life, and shallow spirituality cannot withstand pressure. This moment calls for deeper pastoral care.

Second, young people long for meaning, value, and belonging.

Young people do not necessarily reject faith. They reject superficial spirituality. They long for sincere community, pastoral care that can dialogue, rooted truth, and warm love. If the church is willing to adjust, a new generation of renewal may come.

Third, pastoral pressure can push the church to build healthier support systems.

The church will gradually understand that pastors are not superheroes, and pastors also need to be pastored. Healthy pastors are needed to build healthy churches.

Fourth, the demand for theological education is increasing.

Many believers are becoming more serious about Scripture, Bible study, theology, courses, and systematic formation. Hunger for truth is a precious spiritual sign.

Fifth, the integration of psychology and pastoral care is becoming important.

Amid widespread psychological strain, Christian counseling, spiritual restoration, and emotional pastoral care will become important directions for the church.

Sixth, discipleship will become a new consensus.

The church is beginning to realize that without discipleship, there is no true church. The next renewal will not come only through activities, but through deep life-on-life accompaniment. Seventh, online and offline integration can help the church reach more people.

Online platforms allow the gospel to reach other regions, overseas communities, remote workers, people with limited mobility, and those who may not yet dare to enter a church but are willing to observe online.

Eighth, family crisis gives the church greater value in society. As society becomes more broken, the church has the opportunity to become an emotional harbor, a place of marital rebuilding, a family support system, and a center of soul restoration.

The greater the crisis, the wider the pastoral door.

Ninth, cultural plurality can make the church more open and gracious.

As society becomes more plural, mobile, and complex, the church must become more flexible, open, cross-cultural, cross-regional, and able to serve across groups. This can make the church look more like the biblical vision of a church for all nations.

Tenth, uncertainty will cause more people to seek eternity.

The more unstable life becomes, the more people seek a firm foundation. The more confused society becomes, the more people seek eternal meaning. The more uncertain the world becomes, the more precious the gospel becomes.

Uncertainty itself may become missionary soil.

3. Conclusion: A Difficult Season May Become a Season of God's Work

The Chinese church is entering a critical period.

It is a season of pressure and opportunity, and also a season in which God may renew His church.

The strength of Chinese churches will not lie mainly in external resources, building size, or number of activities. It will lie in the depth of believers' lives, the health of pastoral teams, solid teaching of truth, sustained discipleship, authentic fellowship, deeply rooted love, gentle influence on society, and wise response to the surrounding world.

May Chinese churches not fear the challenges, but receive the opportunities and become true salt and light.

May God make His church deeper, steadier, gentler, stronger, more loving, more truthful, freer, and more hopeful.

This can be a new beginning, not an ending; the dawn of renewal, not the night of decline.

第二十一篇：当讲道成为危险



“一个牧者的内心告白”

有时候我会想，如果有一天我的晚辈问我：“牧师，你讲道的时候怕不怕？”

我可能会沉默很久。

因为对我来说，讲道从来不是一份普通工作，也不只是职责，而是一种无法逃避的呼召。那是一种“若不说出来，骨头里就像有火”的感觉。

可是在某些岁月里，讲道确实会成为一件需要勇气的事。

这是一篇写给自己，也写给每一个在风雨中仍坚持传讲真理之人的牧者告白。

一、当讲道需要勇气，才明白呼召的重量

在很多人眼里，讲道是一种权利：站上讲台，拿起麦克风，面对会众。但经历过风雨的人才知道，讲道有时候不是权利，而是冒险。

曾经我也以为，呼召就是热情、感动、愿意付出。后来才明白，真正的呼召不是“想讲”，而是“不能不讲”。

热情可以让人坚持几年，呼召却能让人撑过十年、二十年，甚至一生。

当你知道有些话可能被误解，有些信息可能带来压力，有些真理可能让自己付代价，却仍然说：“主啊，我在这里。”那就是呼召真实的重量。

二、有些夜晚，我也会问：值得吗？

坦白说，我不是没有软弱的人。夜深人静的时候，我也会问：“值得吗？为什么还要继续坚持？如果沉默，会不会更安全？如果退后，是不是可以更平静？”

这些问题不是怀疑信仰，而是一个牧者真实的挣扎。

有一次，一位弟兄提醒我：“牧师，你要小心一点。”我点点头，心里却浮现出另一句话：

“我若说，我不再提耶和華，也不再奉他的名讲论，我便心里觉得似乎有烧着的火闭塞在我骨中。”（耶利米书 20:9，和合本）

讲道不是不怕，而是尽管害怕，仍然走上去。

三、讲道的危险不只在内容，也在真实

有人或许会问：“只要不讲复杂的事，不就安全了吗？”

但真正让人不安的，常常不只是某个议题，而是真实本身。

真实会让人不舒服，会让人面对自己，会让人卸下面具，也会让人不得不回到神面前。

有时候，最有力量的讲道不是说了多么惊人的话，而是让沉睡的人醒过来。

牧者若不能真实，讲道就会变成演讲；教会会变成活动；生命会变成节目。我不能这样活。

四、我讲道，不是因为强，而是因为羊需要粮

每个牧者都知道，羊是饿的。他们需要真理的粮、安慰的水、盼望的光、方向的路，也需要生命的牧养。

如果我因为害怕就不讲，谁来喂养他们？

世界每天都在喂养人，用焦虑、欲望、比较和愤怒。如果教会沉默，羊群将在哪里得生命？

我讲道，不是因为勇敢，而是因为爱。

爱比害怕更大。

五、有代价的讲道，也可能是神的保护

这句话听起来矛盾，却是我深刻体会的事实。

如果讲道永远轻松、顺利、没有压力，我或许会变得骄傲、自信、依赖自己。

但因为讲道有代价，我才学会在讲道前更多祷告，在准备时更谦卑，在信息中更谨慎，在台下更隐藏自己，也在神面前更深依靠。

压力有时不是神的惩罚，而是神的保护，保护我不忘记：不是靠势力，不是靠才能，乃是靠神的灵。

六、讲道的力量不在麦克风，而在眼泪里

讲道有很多形式。有时是牧者在讲台上，有时是车里一段分享，有时是餐桌上的一句话，有时是陪伴一个伤心的灵魂。

我讲过很多次道，但最让我难忘的，是那些听完信息后决定放下怨恨的人，本想放弃却被一句话挽回的人，在黑暗中重新找到盼望的人，在破碎婚姻中愿意再努力一次的人，在病痛中仍然说“神是好的”的弟兄姊妹。

那不是我能做到的。那是神透过软弱的人所做的。

讲道中的代价，比不上生命被神更新时的荣耀。

七、我的呼召不只是讲道，而是活出福音

我越经历，越明白：讲道不是一个动作，而是一种存在。

神呼召牧者，不只是传递内容，也是在生活中成为信息。

有人听见你说话，也有人看见你生活。有些道是在台上讲的，更多的道是在台下活出来的。

牧者的身份不是“说话的人”，而是“活出福音的人”。

当讲道变得艰难时，也是在提醒我：不要只是讲道，要成为道的见证。

八、结语：我仍然说，我在这里

有人问我：“你后悔吗？如果能重来一次，你还会继续讲道吗？”

我的答案仍然是：我会。因为这是我一生的呼召。

压力不能沉默呼召，恐惧不能吞没爱，危险也不能使真理失去重量。

讲道不是我主动选择的一份职业，而是我回应的一生托付。

这是一个牧者的告白：我愿继续传讲，继续学习，继续靠着恩典站立。无论代价如何，因为这也是我活着的意义之一。



When Preaching Becomes Dangerous A Pastor's Confession

Sometimes I wonder what I would say if one of my children asked me, “Dad, are you ever afraid when you preach?”

I might be silent for a long time.

For me, preaching has never been merely a job or a duty. It is a calling I cannot escape, something like fire in the bones when it is held back.

In certain seasons, preaching can become something that requires courage.

This is a confession written for myself and for every person who continues to speak truth in the wind and rain.

1. When Preaching Requires Courage

Many people see preaching as a privilege: standing behind a pulpit, holding a microphone, speaking to a congregation.

But those who have walked through storms know that preaching is sometimes not a privilege, but a risk.

I once thought calling meant passion, inspiration, and willingness to serve. Later I learned that true calling is not simply wanting to speak. It is being unable not to speak.

Passion may sustain a person for a few years. Calling can carry a person for ten years, twenty years, or a lifetime.

When you know certain words may be misunderstood, certain messages may bring pressure, and certain truths may cost you

something, yet you still say, “Lord, I am here,” you begin to feel the weight of calling.

2. Some Nights I Ask, Is It Worth It?

I am not a person without weakness.

Late at night, I sometimes ask, “Is it worth it? Why keep going? Would silence be safer? Would stepping back make life quieter?” These questions are not unbelief. They are the honest struggle of a pastor.

Once, a brother reminded me, “Pastor, please be careful.” I nodded, but another sentence rose within me:

“His word is in my heart like a fire, a fire shut up in my bones.”
(Jeremiah 20:9, NIV)

Preaching is not the absence of fear. It is walking up anyway, even with fear present.

3. The Risk of Preaching Is Not Only Content, but Truthfulness

Someone may ask, “If you avoid complicated topics, will preaching not be safer?”

But what unsettles people is often not merely a topic. It is truthfulness itself.

Truthfulness makes people uncomfortable. It helps people face themselves. It removes masks. It brings people back before God. Sometimes the most powerful sermon is not the one that says something shocking, but the one that awakens those who are asleep.

If a pastor cannot be truthful, preaching becomes public speaking, church becomes activity, and life becomes performance.

I cannot live that way.

4. I Preach Because the Sheep Need Food

Every pastor knows that sheep are hungry.

They need the bread of truth, the water of comfort, the light of hope, the path of direction, and the care of life.

If fear keeps me silent, who will feed them?

The world feeds people every day with anxiety, desire, comparison, and anger. If the church becomes silent, where will the flock receive life?

I preach not because I am brave, but because I love.

Love is greater than fear.

5. Costly Preaching Can Also Be God's Protection

This sounds contradictory, but I have experienced it deeply.

If preaching were always easy, smooth, and pressure-free, I might become proud, self-confident, and dependent on myself.

Because preaching carries cost, I have learned to pray more before preaching, become humbler in preparation, speak more carefully, hide myself more offstage, and depend more deeply on God.

Pressure is not always punishment. Sometimes it is protection, keeping me from forgetting that it is not by might nor by power, but by the Spirit of God.

6. The Power of Preaching Is Not in the Microphone

Preaching takes many forms. Sometimes it is a pastor in the pulpit. Sometimes it is a conversation in the car, a sentence at the table, or companionship with a wounded soul.

I have preached many sermons, but what I remember most are the lives God touched: people who chose to release resentment, people who were pulled back from despair by a sentence, people who found hope in darkness, people in broken marriages willing to try again, and brothers and sisters who still said, "God is good" in sickness.

I did not do that.

God did that through a weak person.

The cost of preaching cannot compare with the glory of seeing life renewed by God.

7. My Calling Is Not Only to Preach, but to Live the Gospel

The more I experience, the more I understand that preaching is not merely an action. It is a way of being.

God calls pastors not only to deliver content, but to become witnesses to the message.

Some people hear what you say. Others watch how you live. Some sermons are preached on the platform. Many more are lived off the platform.

A pastor is not merely a speaker, but a person called to embody the gospel.

When preaching becomes difficult, I am reminded: do not only preach the message; become a witness to it.

8. Conclusion: I Am Still Here

If someone asked me, “Do you regret it? If you could begin again, would you still preach?” my answer would still be yes.

This is the calling of my life.

Pressure cannot silence calling. Fear cannot swallow love.

Difficulty cannot make truth lose its weight.

Preaching is not a career I chose for myself. It is a lifelong entrustment I have answered.

This is a pastor’s confession: I will continue to speak, continue to learn, and continue to stand by grace. Whatever the cost, this is part of why I am alive.

第二十二篇：被呼召的一代



“在新时代中活出勇敢与温柔”

基督徒常常会问：“我们这一代人，到底该怎样活？”

在压力里，怎样既坚持真理，又保持温柔？怎样不退缩、不激烈，而是活出呼召？

这是重要的问题。

今天的世界，比过去任何时候都更需要一群人：既有勇敢的心，又有温柔的灵；既在真理上坚定，又在关系里温和。

也许，这就是被呼召的一代。

一、时代最缺的不是能力，而是方向

我们生活在资讯爆炸、观点撕裂、节奏紧张的时代。

人很忙，却不知道为什么忙；人很吵，却缺少倾听；人看起来很强，却内心脆弱；信息很多，方向很少。

在这样的时代里，基督徒的呼召不是成为更强硬的人，不是成为更会争夺话语权的人，也不是成为更大声的人。

而是成为有方向的人，知道生命为什么而活；有定力的人，不被潮流来回冲击；有盼望的人，在黑暗里仍然看见光；有爱的人，在冲突中仍然温柔；有勇气的人，在压力中仍然站立。

新时代基督徒最宝贵的身份，不是时代的回声，而是神在时代中的见证。

二、勇敢不是发怒，而是不退缩

世界常常误解勇敢，以为勇敢就是强硬、冲动、激进、对抗。

但圣经里的勇敢，是彼得在风浪中迈出那一步，是但以理在危险中仍然祷告，是以斯帖在危机中说“我若死就死吧”，也是使徒们在逼迫中仍然传道。

圣经中的勇敢，是一种不退缩的力量。

它不是攻击别人，而是不放弃呼召。

勇敢不是声音变大，而是在真理上站稳；不是愤怒，而是在困难中仍选择良善；不是鲁莽，而是清醒地坚持正确的事。

勇敢，是在黑暗中仍然点灯。

三、温柔不是软弱，而是力量被驯服

很多人以为温柔是妥协、让步、胆怯、不反抗。

但圣经中的温柔，是摩西的谦和，是主耶稣在十字架上仍然代求，是保罗劝勉时如父如母的心，也是圣灵果子中的温柔。

温柔不是没有力量。

温柔是有力量却不滥用，有权柄却不压人，能反击却选择饶恕，能发怒却选择忍耐。

温柔，是为了成全别人的生命而克制自己的力量。

时代有时很粗暴，但神的儿女却以温柔得胜。因为温柔比强硬更能改变人心。

温柔，是有方向的力量。

四、勇敢加温柔，是基督徒的属灵形象

勇敢没有温柔，会变成伤人；温柔没有勇敢，会变成退缩。

但勇敢加温柔，就显出基督的样式。

祂说话温柔，却敢责备虚伪；祂对罪人慈爱，却从不妥协真理；祂安慰伤心的人，却坚定地走向十字架；祂柔和谦卑，却拥有最大的权柄。

祂让我们看见：真正的力量，是柔和的力量；真正的勇敢，是不吼叫的勇敢。

未来的教会，需要的正是这样一群人。

五、被呼召的一代，需要三种操练

第一，祷告。

祷告不是逃避，祷告是力量的源头。祷告使我们不因愤怒做决定，不因恐惧退缩，不因压力崩溃，也不因人群摇摆。

祷告让勇敢变得纯净，也让温柔变得稳定。

第二，真道。

真正的勇敢来源于真理，不是冲动；真正的温柔来自认识神，不只是性格好。

真道帮助我们在困惑中有方向，在动荡中有根基，在冲突中有智慧。

没有真理，勇敢会走偏；没有真理，温柔会变成讨好。

真道让我们成为有分辨的人。

第三，爱。

爱，是圣经中永不失败的力量。

爱使勇敢不变得尖锐，也使温柔不变得软弱。

有爱的勇敢会保护人，有爱的温柔会吸引人，有爱的生命会改变人。

爱，是新时代基督徒最大的见证。

六、结语：愿这一代成为光与盐

我们这一代人站在历史的转折处。社会在变，人心在变，文化在变，世界也在变。

但神的呼召没有变：做光，做盐；做勇敢的人，做温柔的人；做真理的人，做有爱的人；做时代的祝福，而不是时代的回声。

愿我们这一代被呼召的人，在嘈杂中保持清醒，在混乱中保持温柔，在艰难中保持勇敢，在黑暗中保持盼望。

愿我们成为勇敢而温柔的一代。

因为我们跟随的主，正是那位勇敢而温柔的君王。



A Generation Called Living with Courage and Gentleness Today

Christians often ask, “How should our generation live?”

Under pressure, how do we hold to truth and remain gentle?

How do we avoid both retreat and harshness, and instead live out our calling?

These are important questions.

The world today needs people who possess both courageous hearts and gentle spirits, people who are firm in truth and tender in relationships.

Perhaps this is what it means to be a generation called.

1. What This Age Lacks Most Is Direction

We live in an age of information overload, divided opinions, and tense rhythms.

People are busy but often do not know why. People are loud but rarely listen. People appear strong but are inwardly fragile.

There is much information, but little direction.

The Christian calling today is not to become harsher, louder, or more eager to seize influence.

It is to become people with direction, knowing why we live; people with steadiness, not tossed by every trend; people with hope, still seeing light in darkness; people with love, still gentle in conflict; people with courage, still standing under pressure.

The most precious identity of Christians is not to echo the times, but to bear witness to God within them.

2. Courage Is Not Anger, but Refusal to Retreat

The world often misunderstands courage as hardness, impulsiveness, aggression, or confrontation.

But biblical courage is Peter stepping onto the water, Daniel praying in danger, Esther saying, “If I perish, I perish,” and the apostles continuing to preach under pressure.

Biblical courage is the strength that refuses to retreat.

It does not attack others. It refuses to abandon calling.

Courage is not a louder voice, but a steadier stand in truth. It is not anger, but choosing goodness in difficulty. It is not recklessness, but sober faithfulness to what is right.

Courage is lighting a lamp in the dark.

3. Gentleness Is Not Weakness, but Strength Under God

Many people think gentleness means compromise, passivity, fear, or lack of resistance.

But biblical gentleness is the meekness of Moses, the prayer of Jesus from the cross, the fatherly and motherly heart of Paul, and the fruit of the Spirit.

Gentleness is not the absence of strength.

Gentleness has strength but does not abuse it, authority but does not crush others, the ability to strike back but chooses forgiveness, the ability to be angry but chooses patience.

Gentleness is strength restrained for the sake of another person's life.

The world may be harsh, but God's children overcome through gentleness. Gentleness can change hearts more deeply than hardness.

Gentleness is strength with direction.

4. Courage Plus Gentleness Is the Christian Shape

Courage without gentleness wounds people. Gentleness without courage becomes retreat.

But courage joined with gentleness reveals the likeness of Christ. Jesus spoke gently, yet rebuked hypocrisy. He loved sinners, yet never compromised truth. He comforted the grieving, yet walked firmly toward the cross. He was gentle and humble, yet held all authority.

He shows us that true strength is gentle strength, and true courage does not need to shout.

This is the kind of people the church needs.

5. Three Practices for a Generation Called

First, prayer.

Prayer is not escape. It is the source of strength. Prayer keeps us from making decisions out of anger, retreating out of fear, collapsing under pressure, or being swayed by the crowd.

Prayer purifies courage and stabilizes gentleness.

Second, the Word.

True courage comes from truth, not impulse. True gentleness comes from knowing God, not merely having a nice personality. The Word gives direction in confusion, roots in upheaval, and wisdom in conflict.

Without truth, courage goes astray. Without truth, gentleness becomes people-pleasing.

The Word makes us people of discernment.

Third, love.

Love is the power that never fails.

Love keeps courage from becoming sharp and keeps gentleness from becoming weak.

Courage with love protects people. Gentleness with love draws people. A life of love changes people.

Love is the greatest witness Christians can offer.

6. Conclusion: May This Generation Become Salt and Light

Our generation stands at a turning point. Society is changing, hearts are changing, culture is changing, and the world is changing.

But God's calling has not changed: be light, be salt; be courageous, be gentle; be people of truth, be people of love; be a blessing to the world, not merely its echo.

May those called in this generation remain clear in noise, gentle in confusion, courageous in hardship, and hopeful in darkness.

May we become a courageous and gentle generation.

For the Lord we follow is the courageous and gentle King.

第二十三篇：当教会面对苦难



“如何在试炼中保持清醒、纯净与盼望”

有时候，一间教会最真实的样子，不是在顺利时显出来，而是在压力中显出来。

当误解、内部张力、外在压力或文化冲击临到时，许多平时被掩盖的问题会浮现，许多隐藏的力量也会被显明。

关键的问题是：当教会身处试炼中，怎样保持清醒？怎样保持纯净？怎样仍然怀有盼望？

一、保持清醒：看见苦难背后的属灵意义

苦难最大的危险，不只是痛苦本身，而是让人迷失方向。

当环境动荡时，人容易问：“为什么发生在我们身上？是不是神不再与我们同在？前面还有没有路？”

但圣经一直提醒我们：试炼不是被离弃，而是神塑造祂儿女的方式。

苦难让教会重新看见三件事。

第一，看见真实的人心。

顺境时，我们常看见的是表现；逆境时，显出来的才是真相。试炼会显出谁是有根的，谁只是有热情；谁是爱主的，谁只是依赖环境；谁愿意付代价，谁只是方便时跟随。

苦难像一面镜子，让教会看见真实属灵状况，不是为了羞辱，而是为了修复。

第二，知道教会的使命不是舒适，而是忠心。

教会若只能在顺境中运作，那就容易变成一个舒服的宗教俱乐部。

真正的教会，是在风雨中仍然坚持祷告、敬拜、彼此相爱、传福音、牧养和服事。

苦难提醒我们：使命比环境更重要。

第三，意识到苦难也是属灵争战的一部分。

彼得提醒我们：“务要谨守，警醒。因为你们的仇敌魔鬼，如同吼叫的狮子，遍地游行，寻找可吞吃的人。”（彼得前书 5:8，和合本）

遇见苦难，不代表信仰没有力量。有时正因为信仰真实，才会遇到抵挡。

清醒，就是不被环境牵着走，而是被真理牵着走。

二、保持纯净：在火中不失去属天本质

教会面对苦难最常见的危险，不一定是外在压力，而是内在扭曲。

若试炼使教会变得愤怒、仇恨、焦急、怀疑、彼此指责，甚至放弃温柔，那教会就失去了基督的样式。

成熟的教会在苦难中要守住三种纯净。

第一，信仰的纯净。

试炼中会有许多声音：怀疑、绝望、抱怨、愤怒。但教会要回到最根本的真理：神的信实不因环境改变。

我们的信仰不是建立在时代上，而是建立在永恒上。

第二，心灵的纯净。

苦难真正的危险，不只是外在打击，而是内心被苦毒污染。

一个苦毒的教会，比一个受压的教会更危险。

纯净是一种属灵力量：不报复，不怨恨，不苦毒，不退缩，也不放弃良善。

苦难若使我们失去爱，就是最大的失败；但若在苦难中仍守住柔软的心，就会成为有力的见证。

第三，使命的纯净。

苦难容易让教会偏离焦点：忙着处理问题，忘了牧养；忙着维持结构，忘了关怀；忙着应对危机，忘了传福音。

纯净的教会知道：使命永远比困难更重要。

三、保持盼望：让信心在夜里发光

盼望不是乐观情绪，而是属天视角。

它来自一个深刻的确信：即使我们看不见，神仍在掌权。

第一，看见苦难中的神迹，而不只看见苦难本身。

圣经从未承诺信徒免除苦难，却一直见证神在苦难中工作：以色列人在红海前看见水分开，但以理在狮子坑中经历神同在，保罗在监狱里写下有力量的书信，初代教会在压力中反而扩展福音。

苦难本身不是祝福，但神能使苦难成为祝福的器皿。

第二，相信历史向着神的国度前进。

无论时代如何动荡，历史不会失控。它不会停在黑暗、危险或混乱中，而终究朝向神的国度展开。

盼望，是对未来的确信，不是对当下的逃避。

第三，用永恒解释现在，而不是用现在解释永恒。

如果我们用现在解释永恒，很容易失望；若用永恒解释现在，就会产生力量。

永恒告诉我们：苦难不是结束，试炼不是终点，眼泪不是失败，痛苦不是神的缺席。

盼望有一种穿透力，让我们在黑夜中看见晨光。

四、结语：教会的力量在于胜过苦难

一个没有经历过试炼的教会，可能很热闹，却未必有根。

一个经历试炼仍然忠心的教会，才真正强大。

因为他们在苦难中学会清醒，不被环境吞没；学会纯净，不被苦毒污染；学会盼望，不被黑暗阻挡。

经历苦难不是教会的终点，而是教会的熬炼；不是教会的结局，而可能是教会的重生。

愿每一个身处试炼中的教会，都能听见主的应许：

“在世上你们有苦难；但你们可以放心，我已经胜了世界。”（约翰福音 16:33，和合本）



When the Church Faces Suffering Remaining Clear-Minded, Pure, and Hopeful in Trials

Sometimes the truest condition of a church is not revealed in ease, but under pressure.

When misunderstanding, internal tension, external pressure, or cultural conflict comes, many hidden problems rise to the surface, and many hidden strengths are also revealed.

The crucial question is this: when the church is in the midst of trial, how can it remain clear-minded? How can it remain pure? How can it still hold on to hope?

1. Remaining Clear-Minded

The greatest danger of suffering is not only pain itself, but the loss of direction.

When circumstances become unstable, people easily ask, “Why is this happening to us? Has God left us? Is there still a way forward?”

But Scripture reminds us that trials are not abandonment. They are part of the way God forms His children.

Suffering helps the church see three things again.

First, it reveals the true condition of the heart.

In comfort, we often see appearances. In adversity, reality becomes visible. Trials reveal who is rooted and who is merely enthusiastic, who loves the Lord and who depends on circumstances, who is willing to pay a price and who follows only when it is convenient.

Suffering is a mirror. It reveals the true spiritual condition of the church, not to shame it, but to heal it.

Second, suffering reminds us that the church’s mission is not comfort, but faithfulness.

If the church can only function in favorable circumstances, it easily becomes a comfortable religious club.

A true church continues in prayer, worship, mutual love, evangelism, shepherding, and service even in storms. Suffering reminds us that mission is greater than environment. Third, suffering reminds us that trials are also part of spiritual warfare.

Peter warns us:

“Be alert and of sober mind. Your enemy the devil prowls around like a roaring lion looking for someone to devour.”

(1 Peter 5:8, NIV)

Facing hardship does not mean faith is powerless. Sometimes resistance comes precisely because faith is real.

To remain clear-minded is to be led by truth rather than by circumstances.

2. Remaining Pure

The greatest danger for a church in suffering is not always external pressure, but internal distortion.

If trial makes the church angry, hateful, anxious, suspicious, accusing, or harsh, then the church begins to lose the likeness of Christ.

A mature church guards three kinds of purity in suffering.

First, purity of faith.

Many voices rise during trials: doubt, despair, complaint, anger.

But the church must return to the basic truth that God's faithfulness does not change with circumstances.

Our faith is not rooted in the age, but in eternity.

Second, purity of heart.

The real danger in suffering is not only being wounded outwardly, but being polluted inwardly by bitterness.

A bitter church is more dangerous than a pressured church.

Purity is a spiritual strength: refusing revenge, resentment, bitterness, retreat, and the abandonment of goodness.

If suffering causes us to lose love, that is our greatest defeat. But if we preserve tenderness in suffering, we become a powerful witness.

Third, purity of mission.

Suffering can easily pull the church away from its focus: managing problems while forgetting shepherding, maintaining structures while forgetting care, responding to crisis while forgetting the gospel.

A pure church knows that mission is always greater than difficulty.

3. Remaining Hopeful

Hope is not a mood of optimism. It is a heavenly perspective.

It comes from a deep confidence that God still reigns, even when we cannot see.

First, hope sees God's work in suffering, not only suffering itself. Scripture never promises that believers will avoid suffering, but it constantly testifies that God works within suffering: Israel saw the sea part at the Red Sea; Daniel experienced God's presence in the lions' den; Paul wrote powerful letters from prison; the early church saw the gospel spread under pressure.

Suffering itself is not a blessing, but God can make suffering a vessel of blessing.

Second, hope believes that history moves toward the kingdom of God.

No matter how unstable the age becomes, history is not out of control. It will not remain in darkness, danger, or chaos. It ultimately moves toward the kingdom of God.

Hope is confidence in the future, not escape from the present.

Third, hope interprets the present through eternity, not eternity through the present.

If we interpret eternity through the present, we easily fall into despair. If we interpret the present through eternity, strength rises.

Eternity tells us that suffering is not the end, trial is not the destination, tears are not failure, and pain is not the absence of God.

Hope has a penetrating power. It allows us to see dawn in the night.

4. Conclusion: The Church's Strength Is Overcoming Suffering

A church that has never experienced trial may be lively, but not necessarily rooted.

A church that remains faithful through trial is truly strong.

In suffering, such a church learns clarity, so it is not swallowed by circumstances; purity, so it is not polluted by bitterness; and hope, so it is not blocked by darkness.

Suffering is not the end of the church. It is refinement. It is not necessarily the conclusion of the church, but may become its rebirth.

May every church in trial hear the promise of the Lord:

“In this world you will have trouble. But take heart! I have overcome the world.” (John 16:33, NIV)

第二十四篇：一个健康的教会 长什么样？



“给未来中国教会的十个愿景”

有人问：“一间教会要怎样，才算健康？”

健康不是规模，不是热闹，不是活动多少，不是场地多大，不是预算多少，甚至也不是外界评价如何。

健康，是一种属灵生命的状态，是一群人被神的真理塑造、被爱连接、被使命驱动的样子。

它像一棵树，不在于枝叶是否一时繁茂，而在于根是否扎稳。

所以，比起先问“教会能不能更大”，我们更需要先问：“教会的生命是否真实、稳定、有爱、有根？”

以下十个愿景，或许可以成为未来中国教会的重要方向。

一、让人渴慕神，而不是惧怕规则

健康的教会不是靠制度制造恐惧，而是靠恩典吸引人、真理塑造人、爱挽回人。

在这样的教会里，人不是被要求敬拜，而是愿意敬拜；不是因为怕犯错而小心翼翼，而是因爱而追求圣洁；不是被控制的群体，而是被牧养的群体。

健康的教会，会让人说：“我想更认识神，因为我在这里遇见爱。”

二、以圣经为中心，而不是以人的意见为中心

当教会的讨论声音超过圣经的声音，教会就会偏离。

健康的教会，会重新回到根基：讲道以圣经为内容，而不是以社会情绪为中心；决策以圣经原则为导向，而不是以人情压力为导向；牧养以圣经真理为根，而不是以个人经验为根；敬拜以神为中心，而不是以表现为中心。

当圣经回到中心，教会方向自然会变得清晰。

三、讲台与生命一致

真正的健康，不只在讲台，也在生活。

健康的教会，会更看重牧者的生命、同工榜样和会众持续的成长。

教会不是听道俱乐部，而是行道共同体。

健康的教会不用靠刻意制造的属灵语气证明属灵，因为生命本身会发光。

四、有爱，而不只是有活动

教会需要明白：活动不能等同生命，忙碌不能等同复兴。

真正健康的教会，是有人愿意聆听你、陪伴你、为你祷告，也愿意接纳你软弱的部分。

爱，是教会所有能力的源头。

五、陪伴破碎的人，而不只接纳成功的人

真实的教会不应该像面试现场，而应该像急诊室。

健康的教会会学习接纳失败的人，陪伴痛苦的人，听见挣扎的声音，也不轻易论断伤心的人。

教会从来不是完美者的聚集，而是得医治者的群体。

健康的教会不是没有破碎，而是知道如何陪伴破碎。

六、多元而合一

华人教会会越来越多元：教育背景、地区、文化、年龄、生命经历都会更多样。

健康的教会不会要求所有人完全一样，不要求一样的性格、风格、偏好和表达。

真正的合一不是整齐划一，而是以基督为中心，在差异中彼此接纳。

这才是属灵成熟的标志。

七、愿意训练下一代

下一代的流失，不一定是他们不爱主，也可能是没有人教他们如何在这个时代保守信仰。

健康的教会会培养新一代讲道者、敬拜者、门训领袖、圣经教师，也培养属灵父母与属灵孩子。

健康的教会不只看今天，也愿意投资十年、二十年的门徒训练。

八、对社会产生温柔影响

教会不应退到角落里，也不应被环境吞没，而要成为安慰者、医治者、和平缔造者和良善的见证者。

健康的教会不是攻击世界，也不是被世界吸收，而是在世界中发光。

光是安静的，却能改变黑暗的质量。

九、懂得牧者也需要被牧养

健康的教会会明白，牧者不是超人，不是铁人，也不是永不疲倦的机器。

牧者也需要休息、倾诉、被看见、被安慰、被接纳、被爱。一个懂得照顾牧者的教会，才是真正健康的教会。

十、愿意改变，却不改变信仰

健康的教会会在不变与改变之间找到平衡。

不变的是福音、真理、呼召、教会的本质和对神的敬畏。

可以改变的是形式、方法、语言、工具、管理和文化策略。

健康的教会不会因为害怕变化而止步，也不会因为迎合环境而失去根基。

树根不变，树冠可以迎风生长。

结语：愿教会成为有生命、有力量、有爱的群体

一个健康的教会长什么样？

它不一定完美，不一定强大，也不一定声名远扬。

但它有根，有爱，有真理，有使命，有恩典，有盼望，有力量，有温度，有自由，也有顺服神的心。

愿华人教会成为这样一幅景象：在城市中安静发光，在黑暗中柔和照亮，在风浪中坚定站立。



What Does a Healthy Church Look Like? Ten Visions for the Future Chinese Church

Someone may ask, “What makes a church truly healthy?”

Health is not size, excitement, number of activities, building space, budget, or even public reputation.

Health is a spiritual condition. It is what happens when a people are shaped by God’s truth, connected by love, and driven by mission.

It is like a tree. The question is not whether the branches look impressive for a season, but whether the roots are deep.

Before asking whether a church can become larger, we may need to ask a deeper question: Is the life of the church real, steady, loving, and rooted?

The following ten visions may help point the way.

1. A Healthy Church Helps People Desire God

A healthy church does not create fear through rules. It draws people through grace, forms them through truth, and restores them through love.

In such a church, people do not worship merely because they are required to, but because they want to. They do not pursue holiness because they are afraid of mistakes, but because they are loved. They are not a controlled crowd, but a shepherded people.

A healthy church makes people say, “I want to know God more because I have encountered love here.”

2. A Healthy Church Centers on Scripture

When the voices of human opinion become louder than the voice of Scripture, the church begins to drift.

A healthy church returns to the foundation: preaching rooted in Scripture rather than social emotion, decisions guided by biblical principles rather than social pressure, pastoral care grounded in biblical truth rather than personal experience, and worship centered on God rather than performance.

When Scripture returns to the center, the church’s direction becomes clear.

3. A Healthy Church Aligns Pulpit and Life

True health is not only seen in the pulpit. It is seen in daily life.

A healthy church values the life of pastors, the example of co-workers, and the steady growth of the congregation.

The church is not a sermon-listening club. It is a community that practices the Word.

A healthy church does not need artificial spiritual language to prove its spirituality. Life itself shines.

4. A Healthy Church Has Love, Not Only Activities

The church needs to understand that activities are not the same as life, and busyness is not the same as renewal.

A truly healthy church is a place where someone is willing to listen to you, accompany you, pray for you, and receive the weak parts of your life.

Love is the source of all the church’s strength.

5. A Healthy Church Accompanies the Broken

A real church should not feel like an interview room. It should feel more like an emergency room.

A healthy church will learn to receive those who have failed, accompany those in pain, hear the voices of struggle, and avoid quick judgment toward the wounded.

The church has never been a gathering of perfect people. It is a community of those being healed.

A healthy church is not one without brokenness. It is one that knows how to accompany the broken.

6. A Healthy Church Is Diverse and United

Chinese churches will become increasingly diverse in education, region, culture, age, and life experience.

A healthy church does not require everyone to be the same in personality, style, preference, or expression.

True unity is not uniformity. It is mutual acceptance in difference, with Christ at the center.

That is a mark of spiritual maturity.

7. A Healthy Church Trains the Next Generation

The loss of the next generation does not always mean they do not love the Lord. It may mean no one has taught them how to keep faith in the world they actually inhabit.

A healthy church will raise up a new generation of preachers, worshipers, discipleship leaders, Bible teachers, spiritual fathers, spiritual mothers, and spiritual children.

A healthy church does not look only at today. It invests in discipleship for the next ten or twenty years.

8. A Healthy Church Gently Influences Society

The church should not withdraw into a corner, nor be swallowed by its environment. It should become a comforter, healer, peacemaker, and witness of goodness.

A healthy church neither attacks the world nor is absorbed by it. It shines within the world.

Light is quiet, but it changes the quality of darkness.

9. A Healthy Church Knows Pastors Need Pastoring

A healthy church will understand that pastors are not superheroes, iron people, or machines that never grow tired.

Pastors also need rest, space to speak, to be seen, comforted, received, and loved.

A church that knows how to care for its pastors is a truly healthy church.

10. A Healthy Church Is Willing to Change Without Changing the Faith

A healthy church finds the balance between what must not change and what can change.

The gospel, truth, calling, the nature of the church, and reverence for God must not change.

Forms, methods, language, tools, administration, and cultural approaches can change.

A healthy church does not stop because it fears change, nor does it lose its roots in order to please its environment.

The root does not change, but the crown of the tree can grow with the wind.

Conclusion: A People with Life, Strength, and Love

What does a healthy church look like?

It is not necessarily perfect, powerful, or famous.

But it has roots, love, truth, mission, grace, hope, strength, warmth, freedom, and a heart that submits to God.

May Chinese churches become such a picture: quietly shining in the city, gently illuminating the darkness, and standing firmly in the storm.

第二十五篇：当信仰被削弱时



“教会如何重新找回力量”

一盏灯变暗的时候，最需要的不是责备那盏灯，而是重新检查连接。

信仰群体也是如此。有时它明亮，有时它疲乏；有时像火焰燃烧，有时只剩余烬闪烁。

教会偶尔会经历一种隐秘的削弱。它不一定首先来自外部的震动，而常常来自内部慢慢产生的疲乏、混乱、冷淡与力不从心。

那么，当信仰被削弱时，教会应如何重新找回力量？

这不是一篇简单的方法论，而是从属灵、牧养、文化与现实角度所作的一次反思。

一、先承认：信仰是真的会失力

许多人以为信仰应该永远充满力量，但圣经从不这样描述。

以利时代，圣经说：“当那些日子，耶和华的言语稀少，不常有默示。”（撒母耳记上 3:1，和合本）

先知书中也多次描述属灵衰退的时期。启示录中，主更直接指出七个教会各自的问题：冷淡、妥协、自满、失去起初的爱、外表活着里面却死了。

信仰失力并不等于失败，而是一个真实的属灵现象，也是一个需要认真面对的信号。

当信仰被削弱，不是神离开了教会，而是教会需要重新回到神面前。

就像灯光变暗，并不证明电不存在，只是提醒我们需要恢复连接。

二、教会真正的削弱，不是人数减少，而是使命淡化

当我们说教会被削弱时，往往先想到人少了、奉献减少了、活动停了、气氛冷了、年轻人不来了。

但这些都不是根本。

教会真正的削弱，根源在于使命被遗忘，身份被模糊，呼召被淡化。

真正让信仰失去力量的，是用结构取代生命，用活动取代祷告，用功能取代关系，用传统取代真道，用表面热闹取代内在复兴。

当教会失去“为什么存在”的答案，就会疲乏、漂流、分心，最终变得软弱。

因此，恢复力量的第一步不是扩张，而是回到最初的呼召。

三、重新得力的第一步：回到祷告

教会重新得力，不是先回到策略，不是先回到行政，也不是先回到会议。

圣经没有说：“你们要开会，力量就必更新。”也没有说：“你们要优化结构，必如鹰展翅上腾。”

圣经说：“但那等候耶和华的，必重新得力。”（以赛亚书40:31，和合本）

这种力量，不是组织制造出来的，而是在祷告中领受的。

每一次教会的复兴，从五旬节到后来许多属灵更新，无一不是从祷告开始。

当祷告变成装饰，群体就会失去能力。

当祷告恢复中心位置，能力就会重新涌出。

四、重新得力的第二步：恢复真道的中心地位

许多教会疲乏，是因为讲道变浅，信息娱乐化，真理被边缘化，圣经变成附属材料，神学被淡化。

当真道的分量被减少，信仰的力度一定会下降。

信仰群体不是靠内容生产留住人，而是靠真理喂养塑造人。

恢复力量，需要让群体重新成为讲圣经的地方、学真理的地方、生命被光照的地方、良心被唤醒的地方。

真理不是教会的装饰品，而是真正的根基。

五、重新得力的第三步：恢复真正的团契

许多群体的问题，不是没有人，而是有一群孤独的人。

外表热闹，心里却孤单；有活动，却没有关系；有聚会，却缺少彼此担待。

恢复力量的群体，一定关心真实生命。

它问的不是“你来做什么”，而是“你过得怎么样”。

当人被真正看见、接纳和同行，温度就会回来，力量也会增长。

六、重新得力的第四步：重新点燃使命感

使命，是信仰群体最核心的动力。

一个失去使命的群体，一定会失去激情、方向与力量。

使命不是做更多事情，而是做正确的事情。

一个教会若只问：活动够不够？人数多不多？预算够不够？就会越来越疲乏。

但若开始问：我们今天帮助了谁？安慰了谁？祝福了谁？让谁看见基督？力量就会重新回到教会。

使命会带来动力，动力会带来更新。

七、重新得力的第五步：让爱重新成为教会文化

最强大的信仰群体，从来不是最有制度的，而是最有爱的。

爱不是软弱，爱是力量的来源。

当一个群体充满彼此尊重、接纳与耐心、鼓励与支持、倾听与理解，以及愿意为对方付出的心，生命力就会回来。

因为那里有人愿意来，愿意留，也愿意成长。

人的心渴望爱，而爱，是教会最不能失去的东西。

八、结语：教会的力量来自生命

一个信仰群体失去力量，不一定是灾难，也可能是呼唤：呼唤教会重新回到源头。

教会重新得力，不在于变大、变强、变潮、变忙，而在于回到祷告、真道、关系、使命和爱。

当教会这样回转，信仰就会被重新点燃。

不靠制度，不靠环境，不靠机会，而是靠来自神的更新。

灯若黯淡，可以重新点亮。

教会若疲乏，可以重新得力。

因为生命本身，就有更新的能力。



When Faith Grows Weak

How the Church Can Recover Its Strength

When a lamp grows dim, the first need is not to blame the lamp, but to check the connection.

A faith community is similar. Sometimes it shines brightly; sometimes it grows weary. Sometimes faith burns like fire; sometimes it glows only like embers.

The church sometimes experiences a hidden weakening. It does not always begin with external pressure. Often it begins within: fatigue, confusion, coldness, and a quiet loss of strength.

So when faith grows weak, how can the church recover its strength?

This is not a simple method. It is a spiritual, pastoral, cultural, and practical reflection.

1. First, Admit That Faith Can Lose Strength

Many people assume that faith should always be full of strength, but Scripture does not describe it that way.

In the days of Eli, Scripture says:

“In those days the word of the LORD was rare; there were not many visions.” (1 Samuel 3:1, NIV)

The prophets also described seasons of spiritual decline. In Revelation, the Lord directly addressed the problems of the seven churches: coldness, compromise, self-satisfaction, loss of first love, and the appearance of life while being inwardly dead.

Faith losing strength is not necessarily failure. It is a real spiritual condition and a signal that must be taken seriously.

When faith grows weak, it does not mean God has left the church. It means the church must return to Him.

When a lamp grows dim, it does not mean electricity no longer exists. It means the connection must be restored.

2. The Church Is Not Weakened First by Smaller Numbers, but by a Diminished Mission

When we say a church has become weak, we often think first of smaller attendance, decreased giving, fewer activities, a colder atmosphere, or young people leaving.

But these are not the root.

The true weakening of the church begins when mission is forgotten, identity becomes unclear, and calling fades.

Faith loses strength when structure replaces life, activity replaces prayer, function replaces relationship, tradition replaces truth, and outward busyness replaces inward renewal.

When the church loses the answer to why it exists, it becomes tired, distracted, drifting, and weak.

The first step toward renewed strength is not expansion. It is returning to the original calling.

3. The First Step: Return to Prayer

The church does not regain strength first by returning to strategy, administration, or meetings.

Scripture does not say, “Those who hold more meetings will renew their strength.” It does not say, “Those who optimize their structures will soar on wings like eagles.”

Scripture says: “Those who hope in the LORD will renew their strength.” (Isaiah 40:31, NIV)

The church’s strength is not produced by organization. It is received through prayer.

Every true renewal of the church, from Pentecost onward, has begun with prayer.

When prayer becomes decoration, the church loses power.

When prayer returns to the center, strength begins to flow again.

4. The Second Step: Restore the Word to the Center

Many churches grow weary because preaching becomes shallow, messages become entertainment, truth moves to the margins, Scripture becomes secondary, and theology becomes thin.

When the weight of the Word is reduced, the strength of faith declines.

The church does not keep people through content production. It forms people through the nourishment of truth.

To recover strength, the church must again become a place where Scripture is preached, truth is learned, life is exposed to light, and conscience is awakened.

Truth is not decoration. It is the foundation.

5. The Third Step: Recover True Fellowship

The problem in many churches is not that there are no people, but that there are many lonely people.

Outwardly there may be activity, but inwardly there is isolation.

There are meetings, but little burden-bearing. There are programs, but few relationships.

A church that recovers strength must care about real lives.

It does not ask only, “What are you here to do?” It asks, “How are you really doing?”

When people are truly seen, received, and accompanied, warmth returns to the church, and strength begins to grow.

6. The Fourth Step: Rekindle Mission

Mission is the central energy of the church.

A church that loses mission will lose passion, direction, and strength.

Mission does not mean doing more things. It means doing the right things.

If a church asks only whether there are enough activities, enough people, or enough money, it will become tired.

But if it begins to ask, "Whom did we help today? Whom did we comfort? Whom did we bless? Who saw Christ through us?" strength will return.

Mission brings movement. Movement brings renewal.

7. The Fifth Step: Let Love Become the Culture Again

The strongest church is not always the most organized church. It is the church most filled with love.

Love is not weakness. Love is the source of strength.

When a church is filled with mutual respect, patience, encouragement, support, listening, understanding, and willingness to give for one another, life returns.

People are willing to come, stay, and grow where love is real. The human heart longs for love, and love is the one thing the church must never lose.

8. Conclusion: The Church's Strength Comes from Life

When a faith community loses strength, it is not necessarily a disaster. It may be a call: a call for the church to return to the source.

The church does not regain strength by becoming bigger, stronger, trendier, or busier.

It regains strength by returning to prayer, the Word, relationships, mission, and love.

When the church returns in this way, faith is rekindled.

Not by systems, circumstances, or opportunities, but by renewal from God.

A dim lamp can be lit again.

A weary church can regain strength.

Life itself carries the power of renewal.

第六辑：使命现场与领袖警醒

第二十六篇：又是一年一度的 年议会



“在制度、传承与活的信心中继续学习”

每年夏天，我都会带着期待的心情参加一次特别的聚会：年议会。

转眼之间，又一次年议会结束了。回到家中，翻看会议资料，回想这几天所经历的人、事和讨论，心中充满感恩，也有许多新的思考。

对于许多在美国成长的牧者来说，年议会或许是一件再熟悉不过的事情；但对于像我这样成长于另一种文化背景的人而言，每一次参加年议会，都是一次新的学习，也是一次视野的扩展。

一、从陌生到逐渐理解

记得刚来美国时，我对“年议会”几乎没有概念。

我知道教会有牧师、有长老、有会友，也知道教会需要管理和决策，但对于一个由众多教会组成、拥有完整制度和运作程序的体系，我几乎一无所知。

第一次参加年议会时，我更多是在观察。

观察大家如何发言。

观察各种提案如何形成。

观察会议如何进行。

观察代表们如何表达意见。

观察不同观点之间如何彼此尊重。

那时我最大的感受就是：原来一个群体可以通过这样公开、透明、有秩序的方式，共同辨识前方的方向。

如今几年过去了，我仍然觉得自己是一个学习者。

每一次参加年议会，都像上了一门新的课程。

每一年都有新的发现，也有新的领悟。

二、学习一种制度

那次年议会给我最大的感受之一，就是再次看见制度的重要性。

很多时候，人们容易关注结果，却忽略了过程。

然而，一个健康的群体，往往不是因为每一次决定都完全正确，而是因为它拥有一套能够不断修正、不断完善、不断成长的制度。

在会议中，我看到：

每一个提案都有讨论。

每一个议题都有程序。

每一个决定都有记录。

每一个声音都有机会被听见。

即使意见不同，也能在彼此尊重中寻找共识。

这种过程本身，就是一种宝贵的学习。

它提醒我：真正重要的不只是“做什么”，更是“如何做”。

三、从教会看见更广阔的启发

参加年议会，也让我想到北美教会与社会传统中关于契约、责任和共同参与的一些脉络。

许多历史讨论都会提到，早期北美社会在建立公共秩序时，常常强调契约、责任和共同参与。

从五月花号上的《五月花公约》，到后来各种地方自治组织的发展，人们不断学习如何在共同价值之下建立秩序、承担责任、彼此监督。

当然，教会不是政治组织。

教会有自己独特的使命和属灵目标。

然而，当我参加年议会的时候，我仍然能够感受到一种共同参与、共同承担、共同守望的精神。

这种精神不仅帮助教会成长，也塑造了许多人对于责任和服务的理解。

四、最触动我的时刻

其中最让我感动的，是按立礼。

当几位候选人分享自己的生命故事时，我听见了许多不同的人生经历。

有人放下稳定职业回应呼召。

有人经历漫长等待。

有人走过艰难道路。

有人在多年寻求之后，终于确认自己的方向。

他们的故事虽然不同，却有一个共同点：愿意回应生命中的呼召。

当他们跪下接受按手时，我特别留意到一幕。

他们身后站着许多长老牧师。

那不仅是一种仪式，更是一种传承，一种责任，一种接力。

每一代人从前一代人手中接过托付，然后继续向前。

那一刻，我想到自己这些年所走过的道路，也想到未来仍然要继续学习、继续成长。

五、信心的功课

那次年议会的信息中，有一个主题特别留在我心里：活的信心。

讲员透过亚伯拉罕的一生提醒我们：信心并不是看见终点之后才出发，而是在看不见终点的时候，仍然愿意迈出脚步。

有时候，信心是前进。

有时候，信心是等待。

有时候，信心甚至是放手。

这些话让我深受触动。

因为在人生许多阶段，我们都希望尽快得到答案。

然而，神常常不是立刻给答案，而是在等待的过程中塑造我们。

信心不一定马上改变环境。

但信心会改变我们面对环境的方式。

六、感恩与成长

回顾那次年议会，我最大的感受仍然是感恩。

感谢有机会参与其中。

感谢能够继续学习。

感谢许多前辈牧者的榜样。

感谢那些默默服事的人。

感谢所有愿意为教会的生命与见证共同承担责任的人。

我越来越相信，成长不仅来自课堂。

成长也来自参与，来自观察，来自倾听，来自不断学习。

年议会正是这样一个学习的平台。

又一次年议会结束了。

但学习并没有结束，成长也没有结束。

愿我们始终保持谦卑受教的心。

愿我们珍惜每一次学习的机会。

愿我们在参与中成长，在服事中成熟，在同行中彼此建立。



Another Annual Conference

Learning Through Order, Continuity, and Living Faith

Another Annual Conference has come and gone.

Every summer, I attend this special gathering with a sense of expectation. Looking back on that conference, my heart is filled with gratitude. Each Annual Conference has its own themes,

discussions, and memorable moments, but each one also becomes a valuable learning experience for me.

For many pastors who grew up within the American church tradition, Annual Conference may feel familiar and routine. For someone like me, who came from a very different background, every conference remains an opportunity to learn, observe, and grow.

1. From Strangeness to Understanding

When I first arrived in the United States, I knew very little about how Annual Conferences functioned.

I understood local church ministry. I understood preaching, pastoral care, and discipleship. But the structure of a conference, the relationship between churches, and the process of shared leadership were all new to me.

My first conference felt like entering a new classroom.

I listened.

I observed.

I watched how motions were presented, how decisions were made, and how people with different perspectives could respectfully discuss important matters together.

Years later, I still feel like a student.

Every conference teaches me something new.

Every conference broadens my understanding.

Every conference reminds me that learning never ends.

2. The Value of Process

One of the strongest impressions I received at that conference was the importance of process.

People often focus on outcomes, but healthy organizations are built on healthy processes.

At the conference, I saw proposals carefully reviewed, discussions thoughtfully conducted, decisions recorded, and voices given space to be heard.

Even when people differed, they sought a way forward with respect.

That process itself is a valuable lesson.

It reminds me that what matters is not only what we do, but how we do it.

3. A Wider Lesson Through the Church

Participating in Annual Conference also gives me a deeper appreciation for some of the covenantal and participatory traditions that shaped churches and communities in North America.

Many historical discussions point out that early North American communities often emphasized covenant, responsibility, and shared participation. From the Mayflower Compact to local forms of self-governance, people learned to build order under shared values, assume responsibility, and hold one another accountable.

Of course, the church is not a political organization. The church has its own mission and spiritual calling.

Yet in Annual Conference, I still sense a spirit of shared participation, shared responsibility, and mutual watchfulness. This spirit helps the church grow and shapes how people understand responsibility and service.

4. The Moment That Moved Me Most

One of the most moving moments for me was the ordination service.

As several candidates shared their stories, I heard many different life journeys.

Some had left stable careers in response to God's call.

Some had walked through long seasons of waiting.

Some had passed through difficult roads.

Some had finally confirmed their direction after many years of seeking.

Their stories were different, but they shared one thing: a willingness to respond to calling.

When they knelt to receive the laying on of hands, I noticed the pastors and elders standing behind them.

It was more than a ceremony.

It was inheritance, responsibility, and continuity.

One generation receives the calling from the previous generation and carries it forward.

That moment made me think of my own journey, and of the learning and growth still ahead.

5. The Lesson of Faith

One theme from the conference stayed with me deeply: living faith.

Through the life of Abraham, the speaker reminded us that faith does not wait until the destination is visible before it begins.

Faith steps forward even when the end is not yet seen.

Sometimes faith means moving forward.

Sometimes faith means waiting.

Sometimes faith even means letting go.

These words touched me deeply.

In many seasons of life, we want answers quickly. But God often does not give answers immediately. Instead, He shapes us in the waiting.

Faith may not change the environment right away.

But faith changes the way we face the environment.

6. Gratitude and Growth

As I look back on that Annual Conference, my deepest feeling is gratitude.

Gratitude for the opportunity to participate.

Gratitude for continued learning.

Gratitude for the example of seasoned pastors and leaders.

Gratitude for those who serve quietly.

Gratitude for all who are willing to share responsibility for the church's life and witness.

I increasingly believe that growth does not come only from classrooms.

It also comes from participation, observation, listening, and lifelong learning.

Annual Conference continues to be one of those places where growth happens.

Another Annual Conference has come to an end.

But learning has not ended. Growth has not ended.

May we keep humble and teachable hearts.

May we treasure every opportunity to learn.

May we grow through participation, mature through service, and
build one another up as we walk together.

第二十七篇：在印第安纳 Gideons 牧者感恩晚宴的见证



“一粒芥菜种，也能被神使用”

2025 年 9 月 19 日晚上，我受邀参加 The Gideons International Indiana State Convention – Pastors Appreciation Banquet。

这是一个专为牧者和教会领袖预备的感恩晚宴。它的主题很清楚：推广福音，把神的话语带到更多人中间。

一、晚宴中的温暖与庄重

走进会场，首先映入眼帘的，是一张张满怀期待的面孔。

数百位牧者、同工与弟兄姐妹齐聚一堂。精致的餐桌，丰盛晚餐，都让人感受到主内家人的热情款待。

用餐之间，大家彼此寒暄，分享服事中的经历与挑战。

那不像一场冰冷的正式会议，倒更像一场心灵的家宴。

人在这样的场合中，会重新意识到：牧者并不是孤单地站在自己的工场上。原来在不同城市、不同教会、不同岗位上，还有许多人同样在为福音劳苦，也同样需要被鼓励、被扶持、被记念。

二、信息与见证的力量

聚会在诗歌赞美中开始。

当晚特别提到的经文，是马太福音 17 章 20 节：

“我实在告诉你们，你们若有信心，像一粒芥菜种，就是对这座山说：‘你从这边挪到那边。’它也必挪去；并且你们没有一件不能做的事了。”（马太福音 17:20，和合本）

这节经文贯穿整场聚会，也提醒每一位牧者：信心不一定一开始就很大，但真实的信心可以被神使用，成就超过人所能想象的事。

随后，一位见证人分享了自己生命被福音改变的经历。

他的分享让人动容，也再次提醒我们：神的话语有改变生命的能力。它超越人的语言、策略和计划，能够在最真实的人生处境中触摸人、翻转人、更新人。

三、Gideons 的使命

许多人对 The Gideons International 并不陌生。

这个机构最为人熟知的，可能是在全球许多酒店房间中摆放圣经。但他们的工作并不止于此。根据 Gideons 官方公开介绍，他们透过个人见证、分享福音和分发圣经，在许多国家和地区与众教会配搭服事，把神的话语带到不同人群中。

他们也将圣经或新约分发到医院、军队、监狱、学校、护理机构和其他许多场所。

特别让我感动的是，Gideons 不只是“发圣经”。

他们也呼召每一位基督徒，在日常生活中学习如何把普通对话自然带向属灵交流，让见证变得生活化。

福音不只发生在讲台上，也发生在餐桌旁、旅途中、工作场合里，以及一次看似平常的交谈中。

一句简单的话，若被神使用，也可能成为别人生命中的一粒种子。

四、姐妹同工的重要性

聚会中也特别提到 Auxiliary，也就是 Gideons 事工中的姐妹同工。

她们在祷告、支持、陪伴和见证上的忠心，是整个事工不可或缺的一部分。

神的国度不仅需要弟兄的坚毅，也需要姐妹的柔和、细致与持守。

许多时候，一个事工能长期走下去，不只是因为台前有人说话，也因为背后有人祷告；不只是因为有人出去分发圣经，也因为有人在安静处托住这份使命。

这也提醒我：在神的国里，没有一个忠心的角色是微小的。

五、我的感受与呼召

整场聚会让我强烈感受到：神的国度需要我们合一努力。

无论是在本地，还是在世界任何角落，神都呼召祂的子民，用祷告、用话语、用见证，去点燃更多人的生命。

我们教会虽然不大，但在这样的聚会中，我再次被提醒：规模大小不是关键，忠心才是关键。

若能与全球信徒同心合意，即使是一个小教会，也能在神更大的工作中有份。

在这个时代，把神的话语传给更多还没有听见的人，不只是某一个机构的使命，也是每一个信徒的呼召。

六、代祷事项

第一，为 The Gideons International 的事工祷告。愿他们在全球各地的 Scripture Blitz 和圣经分发事工中，被神继续使用，使更多人有机会接触神的话语。

第二，为我们本地教会祷告。愿主赐下异象，让我们在日常生活中勇敢、自然、智慧地分享信仰。

第三，为牧者和信徒同工祷告。愿我们在传扬福音的道路上，不惧挑战，靠主刚强。

七、结语

这一晚的聚会，不只是一顿美好的晚餐，更是一场信心的激励。

它提醒我：一粒芥菜种虽然微小，却可以在神手中被使用。

一个人、一间教会、一次聚会、一本圣经、一次简单的交谈，都可能成为神工作的起点。

愿我们都愿意成为那一粒种子，在神的手中，被埋下，被浇灌，被使用，并在合适的时候，结出丰盛的果子。



A Testimony from The Gideons International Indiana State Convention – Pastors Appreciation Banquet Even a Mustard Seed Can Be Used by God

On the evening of September 19, 2025, I was invited to attend The Gideons International Indiana State Convention – Pastors Appreciation Banquet.

This banquet was prepared especially for pastors and church leaders. Its theme was clear: to advance the gospel and bring the Word of God to more people.

1. Warmth and Reverence at the Banquet

When I entered the venue, the first thing I noticed was the many faces filled with expectation.

Hundreds of pastors, coworkers, and brothers and sisters had gathered together. The carefully prepared tables and generous meal reflected the warm hospitality of God's people.

During the meal, people greeted one another and shared experiences and challenges from ministry.

It did not feel like a cold formal meeting. It felt more like a family gathering for the soul.

In a setting like this, a pastor is reminded again that he does not stand alone in his own field. In different cities, churches, and places of service, many others are also laboring for the gospel. They too need encouragement, support, and remembrance.

2. The Power of Message and Testimony

The gathering began with songs of praise.

One Scripture that was highlighted that evening was Matthew 17:20:

“Truly I tell you, if you have faith as small as a mustard seed, you can say to this mountain, ‘Move from here to there,’ and it will move.” (Matthew 17:20, NIV)

This verse ran through the evening and reminded every pastor present that faith does not have to appear large at the beginning. Genuine faith, even when small, can be used by God to accomplish things beyond what we imagine.

Later, one speaker shared a testimony of how the gospel transformed his life.

His story was deeply moving. It reminded us again that the Word of God has power to change lives. It goes beyond human language, strategy, and planning. It reaches people in the realities of life, touching, turning, and renewing them.

3. The Mission of The Gideons

Many people are familiar with The Gideons International.

The ministry is perhaps best known for placing Bibles in hotel rooms around the world. Yet its work extends far beyond that.

According to public information from The Gideons, they share personal testimony, spread the gospel, and distribute Scriptures in partnership with churches in many places around the world.

They also place or distribute Scriptures in hospitals, military settings, prisons, schools, care facilities, and many other places. What moved me especially is that The Gideons do not merely “hand out Bibles.”

They also call Christians to learn how to turn ordinary conversations into spiritual conversations in daily life, so that testimony becomes part of ordinary living.

The gospel does not happen only from the pulpit. It also happens at the dinner table, on the road, in the workplace, and in a conversation that may appear ordinary.

A simple word, if used by God, can become a seed in someone's life.

4. The Importance of the Auxiliary

The gathering also highlighted the Auxiliary, the women who serve alongside The Gideons.

Their faithfulness in prayer, support, companionship, and witness is an essential part of the whole ministry.

The kingdom of God is served not only through the perseverance of brothers, but also through the gentleness, carefulness, and steadfastness of sisters.

Many times, a ministry continues not only because someone speaks in public, but because someone prays in hidden places. It continues not only because someone distributes Scripture, but because someone quietly supports the mission.

This reminded me again that in God's kingdom, no faithful role is small.

5. My Reflection and Calling

The whole evening impressed one truth deeply upon me: the kingdom of God needs us to labor together in unity.

Whether locally or in any corner of the world, God calls His people to use prayer, words, and testimony to ignite more lives.

Our church is not large. Yet at this gathering, I was reminded again that size is not the key. Faithfulness is.

If we stand in unity with believers around the world, even a small church can share in God's greater work.

In this generation, bringing God's Word to those who have not yet heard is not only the mission of one organization. It is the calling of every believer.

6. Prayer Requests

First, pray for the ministry of The Gideons International. May God continue to use their Scripture Blitz efforts and Scripture distribution around the world, so that more people may encounter the Word of God.

Second, pray for our local church. May the Lord give us vision, so that we may share our faith in daily life with courage, wisdom, and natural sincerity.

Third, pray for pastors and coworkers. May we not fear the challenges of gospel ministry, but remain strong in the Lord.

7. Conclusion

That evening was more than a beautiful dinner. It was an encouragement of faith.

It reminded me that a mustard seed may be small, but it can still be used by God.

One person, one church, one gathering, one Bible, one simple conversation may become the beginning of God's work.

May we all be willing to become that seed. In God's hand, may we be planted, watered, used, and, in due time, bear abundant fruit.

第二十八篇：基甸的失败：从卑微的勇士到失落的士师



“人的失败，往往不是在敌人面前，而是在胜利之后”

在《士师记》6至8章中，基甸的故事常常被人记住的，是他用三百人打败米甸人的英勇战绩。

那是一段充满神迹的历史：神使用微小的器皿彰显祂的大能，借着软弱的人施行拯救。

然而，如果我们继续读到第8章，就会看见一个令人唏嘘的转折：基甸从起初谦卑倚靠神的勇士，逐渐滑向报复、自高与败坏。

他的结局提醒我们：人的失败，往往不是在敌人面前，而是在胜利之后。

一、报复的开端：毗努伊勒的悲剧

基甸最明显的转折点，出现在他对疏割和毗努伊勒的报复上。

圣经记载，基甸追击米甸人的时候，经过疏割和毗努伊勒，请求这些以色列同胞提供食物支持。但他们拒绝帮助他。（参士师记 8:5-9）

于是基甸立下狠话：等他得胜回来，必用旷野的荆条和荆棘责打疏割人，也要拆毁毗努伊勒的楼。

等到战事告捷，基甸真的回来兑现了自己的话。

他惩罚了疏割人，也拆毁了毗努伊勒的楼，并且杀了那城里的人。（参士师记 8:16-17）

到这里，基甸已经不再只是那个起初战战兢兢、向神求印证的“打麦子的小人物”。

他开始尝到权柄与报复的滋味。

报复的种子一旦生根，就会开始腐蚀人的心。

二、虚假的谦辞：口里说不要作王，生活却像王

士师记 8 章 22 至 23 节记载，以色列人对基甸说：“你既救我们脱离米甸人的手，愿你和你的子孙管理我们。”

基甸回答说：“我不管理你们，我的儿子也不管理你们，惟有耶和華管理你们。”（士师记 8:23，和合本）

这句话听起来属灵而谦卑。

但若结合前后文来看，我们会发现，这句谦辞并不完全真实。

面对以法莲人的责难，基甸低声下气，用谦辞化解矛盾。（参士师记 8:1-3）

但面对疏割和毗努伊勒，他却毫不留情，严厉报复。（参士师记 8:16-17）

这让我们看见，他的处理方式并不完全出于公义，而常常受对象、处境和权力关系影响。

战后，他要求众人把掳来的金环给他，结果收集了一千七百舍客勒金子。（参士师记 8:24-26）

随后，他用这些金子制造了一件以弗得，并放在自己的城俄弗拉。

圣经说：“后来以色列人拜那以弗得行了邪淫；这就作了基甸和他全家的网罗。”（士师记 8:27，和合本）

以弗得原本与祭司职分有关，但基甸却把它放在自己的城里，结果使属灵器物变成了个人荣耀与民间崇拜的中心。

圣经又说，基甸有许多妻子，生了七十个儿子。（参士师记 8:30）

这是一种带有王权色彩的生活方式，与他口中“我不管理你们”的谦辞形成强烈反差。

他还为儿子取名亚比米勒。这个名字可以理解为“我父是王”。（参士师记 8:31）

嘴上说不作王，生活方式和家庭安排却显出他正在靠近王权。

三、胜利之后的滑落

基甸的失败，不在战场上，而在胜利之后。

在战场上，他小心翼翼地求神印证，深知自己的软弱。

在战场上，他不靠人数和武器，而靠神的同在。

但战后，他开始尝到权力、荣耀与群众拥戴的滋味，便逐渐放松警醒。

胜利之后，他没有带领百姓更深回归耶和華，反而因自己所造的以弗得，使百姓陷入偶像崇拜。

表面上谦卑，实际上却落入骄傲与私欲。

这正印证了圣经一再提醒我们的功课：人的失败，往往发生在属灵高峰之后。

大卫在战场上战胜歌利亚，却在王宫里跌倒。

所罗门早年求智慧，晚年却因奢华与偶像偏离。

基甸也是如此。

四、属灵的反思

基甸的故事给我们留下几个深刻提醒。

第一，胜利之后更要谨慎。

最大的试探，往往不是失败，而是成功。失败常使人谦卑，成功却容易使人骄傲。

第二，言行必须一致。

基甸口里说“我不作王”，生活中却逐渐活出王的样子。口头谦卑若与实际行为不符，就会变成一种属灵表演。

第三，不要滥用神圣的器物。

基甸制造以弗得，结果使百姓陷入偶像崇拜。属灵的事若被用来满足个人虚荣，就会带来极大的败坏。

第四，属灵领袖的家庭见证很重要。

基甸许多妻妾和七十个儿子的家庭结构，不但显出他生活方式的偏差，也为后来亚比米勒的悲剧埋下伏笔。

五、从基甸看我们自己

基甸的失败提醒我们：一个人的软弱，可能因环境被掩盖；但一个人的野心，往往会在成功后显露。

他起初是打麦子的小人物，却被神兴起为拯救者。

他曾因谦卑与信心成为神的器皿，却因报复、贪欲和权力而跌倒。

他口里说“耶和華作王”，但生活却似乎在说：“我父是王。”这正是人性的复杂。

我们也可能在成功后松懈，在拥有权力后迷失，在口头信仰与实际生活之间出现裂痕。

真正的提醒是：领袖必须不断回到神面前，谨慎自守，不让胜利成为失败的开端。

保罗说：

“所以，自己以为站得稳的，须要谨慎，免得跌倒。”（哥林多前书 10:12，和合本）

愿我们在基甸的失败中学会警醒，在胜利中仍然谦卑，在地上不为自己称王，而在心中单单高举耶和華為王。



Gideon's Failure

From Humble Warrior to a Judge Who Lost His Way

In Judges 6-8, Gideon is often remembered for his victory over the Midianites with only three hundred men.

It is a story full of divine power: God used a small vessel to display His greatness, and through a weak man He brought deliverance.

Yet if we continue reading into chapter 8, we discover a sobering turn. Gideon, who began as a humble warrior dependent on God, gradually moved toward revenge, self-exaltation, and corruption. His ending reminds us that human failure often does not happen before the enemy. It happens after victory.

1. The Beginning of Revenge: The Tragedy of Peniel

The most visible turning point in Gideon's life appears in his revenge against Sukkoth and Penuel.

As Gideon pursued the Midianites, he passed through Sukkoth and Penuel and asked these fellow Israelites for food. They refused to help him. (See Judges 8:5-9.)

Gideon then issued a harsh warning. When he returned in victory, he would punish the men of Sukkoth with desert thorns and briers, and he would tear down the tower of Penuel.

After the battle was won, Gideon returned and carried out his threat.

He punished the men of Sukkoth, tore down the tower of Penuel, and killed the men of the town. (See Judges 8:16-17.)

At this point, Gideon was no longer merely the frightened man threshing wheat in secret, asking God again and again for confirmation.

He had begun to taste the pull of authority and revenge.

Once the seed of revenge takes root, it begins to corrode the heart.

2. False Humility: Saying He Would Not Be King While Living Like One

Judges 8:22-23 records that the Israelites said to Gideon, "Rule over us—you, your son and your grandson—because you have saved us from the hand of Midian."

Gideon answered:

"I will not rule over you, nor will my son rule over you. The LORD will rule over you." (Judges 8:23, NIV)

That sentence sounds spiritual and humble.

But when we read it in context, we begin to see that the humility was not entirely true.

When the Ephraimites criticized him, Gideon answered gently and calmed the conflict. (See Judges 8:1-3.)

But toward Sukkoth and Penuel, he acted without mercy and took revenge. (See Judges 8:16-17.)

This shows that his response was not purely shaped by justice. It was affected by the person before him, the situation, and the balance of power.

After the battle, he asked the people to give him the gold earrings from the plunder. The total came to seventeen hundred shekels of gold. (See Judges 8:24-26.)

Then Gideon used the gold to make an ephod and placed it in his own town, Ophrah.

Scripture says, “All Israel prostituted themselves by worshiping it there, and it became a snare to Gideon and his family.” (Judges 8:27, NIV)

The ephod was associated with the priestly office, but Gideon placed it in his own town. A sacred object became a center of personal honor and popular devotion.

Scripture also says that Gideon had many wives and seventy sons. (See Judges 8:30.)

This way of life carried the marks of royal power. It stood in sharp contrast to his statement, “I will not rule over you.”

He also named his son Abimelek. The name can be understood to mean “my father is king.” (See Judges 8:31.)

His mouth said he would not be king, but his lifestyle and family arrangements moved toward kingship.

3. The Decline After Victory

Gideon’s failure did not happen on the battlefield. It happened after victory.

On the battlefield, he cautiously sought confirmation from God and knew his own weakness.

On the battlefield, he did not depend on numbers or weapons, but on the presence of God.

But after the battle, he tasted power, glory, and public approval. Slowly, he became less watchful.

After victory, he did not lead the people deeper into worship of the Lord. Instead, the ephod he made became a snare that led Israel into idolatry.

Outwardly, he sounded humble. Inwardly, he was being drawn toward pride and desire.

This confirms a lesson Scripture teaches again and again: human failure often comes after a spiritual high point.

David defeated Goliath on the battlefield, but later fell in the palace.

Solomon asked for wisdom in his early years, but in his later years was led astray by luxury and idols.

Gideon followed the same pattern.

4. Spiritual Reflections

Gideon's story leaves us with several serious warnings.

First, we must be more careful after victory.

The greatest temptation is often not failure, but success. Failure often humbles us. Success can easily make us proud.

Second, our words and life must agree.

Gideon said, "I will not be king," but his life gradually took on the shape of a king. Verbal humility that is contradicted by actual behavior becomes spiritual performance.

Third, sacred things must not be misused.

Gideon made an ephod, and it became a snare that led the people into idolatry. When spiritual things are used to satisfy personal vanity, they can bring deep corruption.

Fourth, the family witness of a spiritual leader matters.

Gideon's many wives and seventy sons revealed a distorted pattern of life and prepared the way for later tragedy.

5. Seeing Ourselves Through Gideon

Gideon's failure reminds us that weakness may be hidden by circumstances, but ambition often reveals itself after success.

He began as a small man threshing wheat, yet God raised him up as a deliverer.

He was once a vessel of God through humility and faith, yet he fell through revenge, greed, and power.

His mouth said, "The LORD will rule," but his life seemed to say, "My father is king."

This is the complexity of the human heart.

We too may become careless after success, lose our way after gaining authority, and allow a gap to open between the faith we confess and the life we actually live.

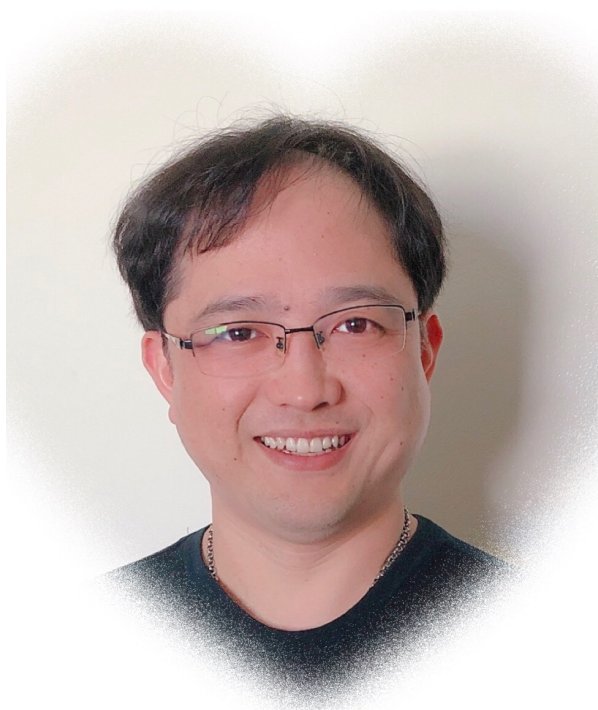
The true warning is this: leaders must continually return to God, remain watchful, and refuse to let victory become the beginning of failure.

Paul writes:

“So, if you think you are standing firm, be careful that you don’t fall!” (1 Corinthians 10:12, NIV)

May we learn vigilance from Gideon’s failure. May we remain humble in victory. May we refuse to crown ourselves on earth, and in our hearts exalt the Lord alone as King.

作者简介 · Author Bio



张崇助 (Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang)，牧师、作者、神学研究者。

早年毕业于上海华东神学院，获神学本科与圣乐本科。随后赴美深造，就读于美国 Ozark Christian College 旗下林肯神学院 (Lincoln Seminary)，获道学硕士 (Master of Divinity) 学位，主修圣经研究与教牧领导 (Biblical Studies and Pastoral Leadership)。

现就读于美国亚斯理神学院 (Asbury Theological Seminary) 教牧学博士 (Doctor of Ministry, D.Min.) 项目, 研究方向为 Preaching and Leading (讲道与领导)。

自 2001 年开始全职牧会, 长期从事讲道、教导、门徒训练与教会牧养工作。曾在中国多地服事, 现任美国印第安纳州印城第一华人循理会 (First Chinese Free Methodist Church of Indianapolis) 主任牧师。

除了牧会与教学之外, 张崇助热爱写作, 长期通过网络平台分享关于信仰、人生、家庭、苦难、盼望与跨文化经历的思考。

《删不掉的光》(The Light They Could Not Erase) 系列, 收录其近年来发表于微信公众号的大量原创随笔与灵修文章, 记录一个普通牧者在人生旅程中所经历的恩典、反思与成长。他深信: 真正改变生命的, 往往不是轰轰烈烈的时刻, 而是那些隐藏在平凡日子里的恩典之光。

Chongzhu “Paul” Zhang is a pastor, author, and theological researcher.

He graduated from East China Theological Seminary in Shanghai, earning undergraduate degrees in Theology and Sacred Music. He later pursued advanced theological studies in the United States at Lincoln Seminary of Ozark Christian College, where he received a Master of Divinity (M.Div.) with a concentration in Biblical Studies and Pastoral Leadership.

He is currently pursuing a Doctor of Ministry (D.Min.) degree at Asbury Theological Seminary, with a focus on Preaching and Leading.

Since entering full-time ministry in 2001, Pastor Zhang has devoted himself to preaching, teaching, discipleship, and pastoral leadership. After years of ministry in China, he now serves as Senior Pastor of the First Chinese Free Methodist Church of Indianapolis, Indiana.

In addition to ministry, he is a passionate writer who regularly reflects on faith, life, family, suffering, hope, and cross-cultural experiences. The Light They Could Not Erase series is a

collection of essays and devotional reflections originally published through his online writing ministry, preserving stories of grace, perseverance, and spiritual growth.

He believes that:

The moments that shape our lives most deeply are often not the extraordinary ones, but the quiet lights of grace found in ordinary days.